Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve

SEACAR Habitat Analyses

Last compiled on 10 June, 2026

Contents

Funding & Acknowledgements

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This report was funded in part, through a grant agreement from the Florida Department of Environmental Protection, Florida Coastal Management Program, by a grant provided by the Office for Coastal Management under the Coastal Zone Management Act of 1972, as amended, National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration. The views, statements, findings, conclusions and recommendations expressed herein are those of the author(s) and do not necessarily reflect the views of the State of Florida, NOAA or any of their sub agencies.

Published: 2026-06-10

Threshold Filtering

Threshold filters, following the guidance of Florida Department of Environmental Protection's (*FDEP*) Division of Environmental Assessment and Restoration (*DEAR*) are used to exclude specific results values from the SEACAR Analysis. Based on the threshold filters, Quality Assurance / Quality Control (*QAQC*) Flags are inserted into the *SEACAR_QAQCFlagCode* and *SEACAR_QAQC_Description* columns of the export data. The *Include* column indicates whether the *QAQC* Flag will also indicate that data are excluded from analysis. No data are excluded from the data export, but the analysis scripts can use the *Include* column to exclude data (1 to include, 0 to exclude).

Table 1: Continuous Water Quality threshold values

Parameter Name	*Units*	*Low Threshold*	*High Threshold*
Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin	ug/L	-	-
Dissolved Oxygen	mg/L	-0.000001	50
Dissolved Oxygen Saturation	%	-0.000001	500
Fluorescent Dissolved Organic Matter	QSE	-	-
Salinity	ppt	-0.000001	70
Specific Conductivity	mS/cm	-0.000001	200
Turbidity	NTU	-0.000001	4000
Water Temperature	Degrees C	-5.000000	45
pH	None	2.000000	14

Table 2: Discrete Water Quality threshold values

Parameter Name	*Units*	*Low Threshold*	*High Threshold*
Ammonia, Un-ionized (NH3)	mg/L	-	-
Ammonium (NH4)	mg/L	-	-

Parameter Name	*Units*	*Low Threshold*	*High Threshold*
Chlorophyll a, Corrected for Pheophytin	ug/L	-	-
Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin	ug/L	-	-
Colored Dissolved Organic Matter	PCU	-	-
Dissolved Oxygen	mg/L	-0.000001	25
Dissolved Oxygen Saturation	%	-0.000001	310
Fluorescent Dissolved Organic Matter	QSE	-	-
Light Extinction Coefficient	m^-1	-	-
NO2+3, Filtered	mg/L	-	-
Nitrate (NO3)	mg/L	-	-
Nitrite (NO2)	mg/L	-	-
Nitrogen, inorganic	mg/L	-	-
Nitrogen, organic	mg/L	-	-
Phosphate, Filtered (PO4)	mg/L	-	-
Salinity	ppt	-0.000001	70
Secchi Depth	m	0.000001	50
Specific Conductivity	mS/cm	0.005000	100
Total Ammonia (N)	mg/L	-	-
Total Kjeldahl Nitrogen	mg/L	-	-
Total Nitrogen	mg/L	-	-
Total Nitrogen	mg/L	-	-
Total Phosphorus	mg/L	-	-
Total Suspended Solids	mg/L	-	-
Turbidity	NTU	-	-
Water Temperature	Degrees C	3.000000	40
pH	None	2.000000	13

Table 3: Quality Assurance Flags inserted based on threshold checks listed in Table 1 and 2

SEACAR QAQC Description	*Include*	*SEACAR QAQCFlagCode*
Exceeds maximum threshold	0	2Q
Below minimum threshold	0	4Q
Within threshold tolerance	1	6Q
No defined thresholds for this parameter	1	7Q

Value Qualifiers

Value qualifier codes included within the data are used to exclude certain results from the analysis. The data are retained in the data export files, but the analysis uses the *Include* column to filter the results.

STORET and WIN value qualifier codes

Value qualifier codes from *STORET* and *WIN* data are examined with the database and used to populate the *Include* column in data exports.

Table 4: Value Qualifier codes excluded from analysis

Qualifier Source	*Value Qualifier*	*Include*	*MDL*	*Description*
STORET-WIN	H	0	0	Value based on field kit determination; results may not be accurate
STORET-WIN	J	0	0	Estimated value
STORET-WIN	V	0	0	Analyte was detected at or above method detection limit
STORET-WIN	Y	0	0	Lab analysis from an improperly preserved sample; data may be inaccurate

Discrete Water Quality Value Qualifiers

The following value qualifiers are highlighted in the Discrete Water Quality section of this report. An exception is made for **Program 476** - *Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network* and data flagged with Value Qualifier **H** are included for this program only.

H - Value based on field kit determiniation; results may not be accurate. This code shall be used if a field screening test (e.g., field gas chromatograph data, immunoassay, or vendor-supplied field kit) was used to generate the value and the field kit or method has not been recognized by the Department as equivalent to laboratory methods.

I - The reported value is greater than or equal to the laboratory method detection limit but less than the laboratory practical quantitation limit.

Q - Sample held beyond the accepted holding time. This code shall be used if the value is derived from a sample that was prepared or analyzed after the approved holding time restrictions for sample preparation or analysis.

S - Secchi disk visible to bottom of waterbody. The value reported is the depth of the waterbody at the location of the Secchi disk measurement.

U - Indicates that the compound was analyzed for but not detected. This symbol shall be used to indicate that the specified component was not detected. The value associated with the qualifier shall be the laboratory method detection limit. Unless requested by the client, less than the method detection limit values shall not be reported

Systemwide Monitoring Program (SWMP) value qualifier codes

Value qualifier codes from the *SWMP* continuous program are examined with the database and used to populate the *Include* column in data exports. *SWMP* Qualifier Codes are indicated by *QualifierSource=SWMP*.

Table 5: SWMP Value Qualifier codes

Qualifier Source	*Value Qualifier*	*Include*	*Description*
SWMP	-1	1	Optional parameter not collected
SWMP	-2	0	Missing data
SWMP	-3	0	Data rejected due to QA/QC
SWMP	-4	0	Outside low sensor range
SWMP	-5	0	Outside high sensor range
SWMP	0	1	Passed initial QA/QC checks
SWMP	1	0	Suspect data
SWMP	2	1	Reserved for future use
SWMP	3	1	Calculated data: non-vented depth/level sensor correction for changes in barometric pressure
SWMP	4	1	Historical: Pre-auto QA/QC
SWMP	5	1	Corrected data

Water Column

The water column habitat extends from the water's surface to the bottom sediments, and it's where fish, dolphins, crabs and people swim! So much life makes its home in the water column that the health of marine and coastal ecosystems, as well as human economies, depend on the condition of this vulnerable habitat. Local patterns of rainfall, temperature, winds and currents can rapidly change the condition of the water column, while global influences such as El Niño/La Niña, large-scale fluctuation in sea temperatures and climate change can have long-term effects. Inputs from the prosperity of our day-to-day lives including farming, mining and forestry, and emissions from power generation, automobiles and water treatment can also alter the health of the water column. Acting alone or together, each input can have complex and lasting effects on habitats and ecosystems.

SEACAR evaluates water column health with several essential parameters. These include nutrient surveys of nitrogen and phosphorus, and water quality assessments of salinity, dissolved oxygen, pH, and water temperature. Water clarity is evaluated with Secchi depth, turbidity, levels of chlorophyll a, total suspended solids, and colored dissolved organic matter. Additionally, the richness of nekton is indicated by the abundance of free-swimming fishes and macroinvertebrates like crabs and shrimps.

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Analysis

Indicators must have a minimum of five to ten years, depending on the habitat, of data within the geographic range of the analysis to be included in the analysis. Ten years of data are required for discrete parameters, and five years of data are required for continuous parameters. If there are insufficient years of data, the number of years of data available will be noted and labeled as "insufficient data to conduct analysis". Further, for the preferred Seasonal Kendall-Tau test, there must be data from at least two months in common across at least two consecutive years within the RCP managed area being analyzed. Values that pass both of these tests will be included in the analysis and be labeled as *Use_In_Analysis* = **TRUE**. Any that fail either test will be excluded from the analyses and labeled as *Use_In_Analysis* = **FALSE**. The points for all Water Column plots displayed in this section are monthly averages. Trend significance will be denoted as "Significant Trend" (when $p < 0.05$), or "Non-significant Trend" (when $p >= 0.05$). Any parameters with insufficient data to perform Seasonal Kendall-Tau test will have their monthly averages plotted without a corresponding trend line.

Water Quality - Discrete

The following files were used in the discrete analysis:

- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Chlorophyll_a_corrected_for_pheophytin-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Chlorophyll_a_uncorrected_for_pheophytin-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Colored_dissolved_organic_matter_CDOM-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Dissolved_Oxygen-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Dissolved_Oxygen_Saturation-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_pH-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Salinity-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Secchi_Depth-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Total_Nitrogen-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Total_Phosphorus-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Total_Suspended_Solids_TSS-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Turbidity-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Water_Temperature-2026-May-18.txt*

Chlorophyll a, Corrected for Pheophytin - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

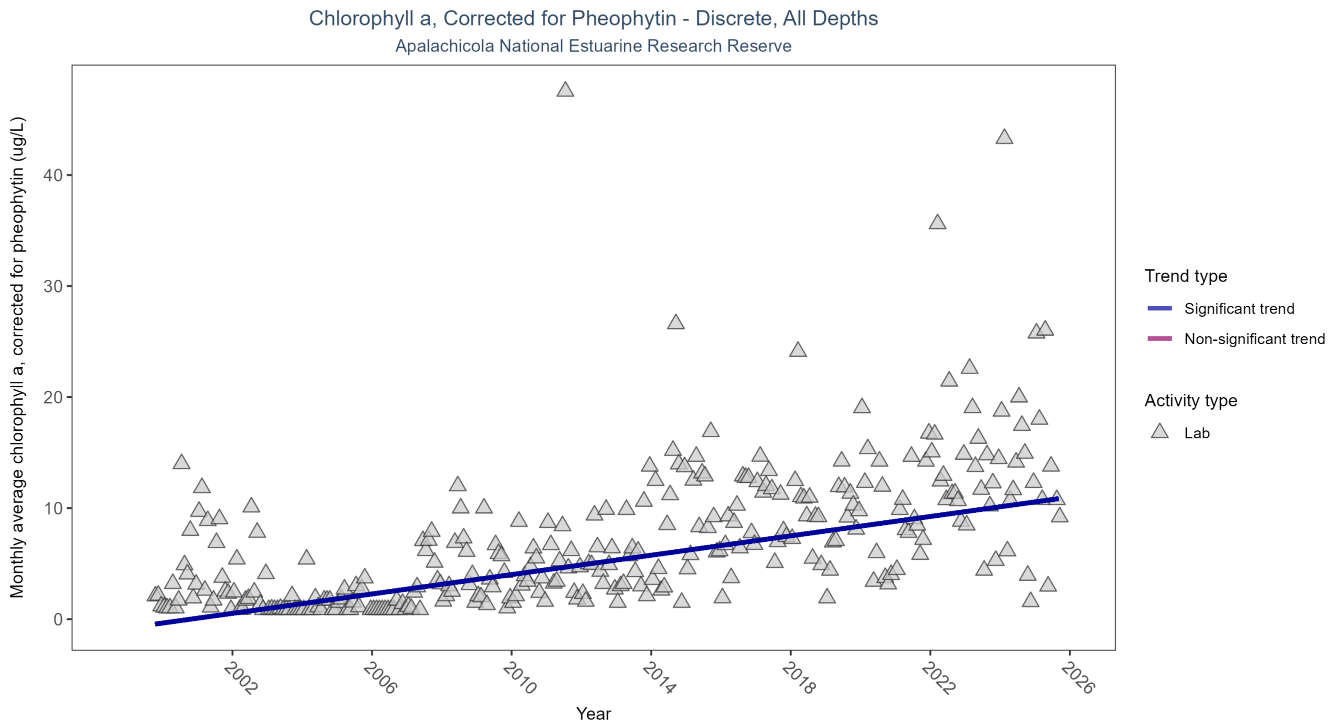

Figure 1: Scatter plot of monthly average levels of chlorophyll a, corrected for pheophytin, over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only laboratory-analyzed chlorophyll a (triangles) is included in the plot.

Table 6: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Chlorophyll a, Corrected for Pheophytin

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Lab	Increasing trend	3877	27	1999 - 2025	7.5	0.5168	-0.7871	0.4364	0

Monthly average chlorophyll a, corrected for pheophytin, increased by 0.44 µg/L per year, indicating a decrease in water clarity.

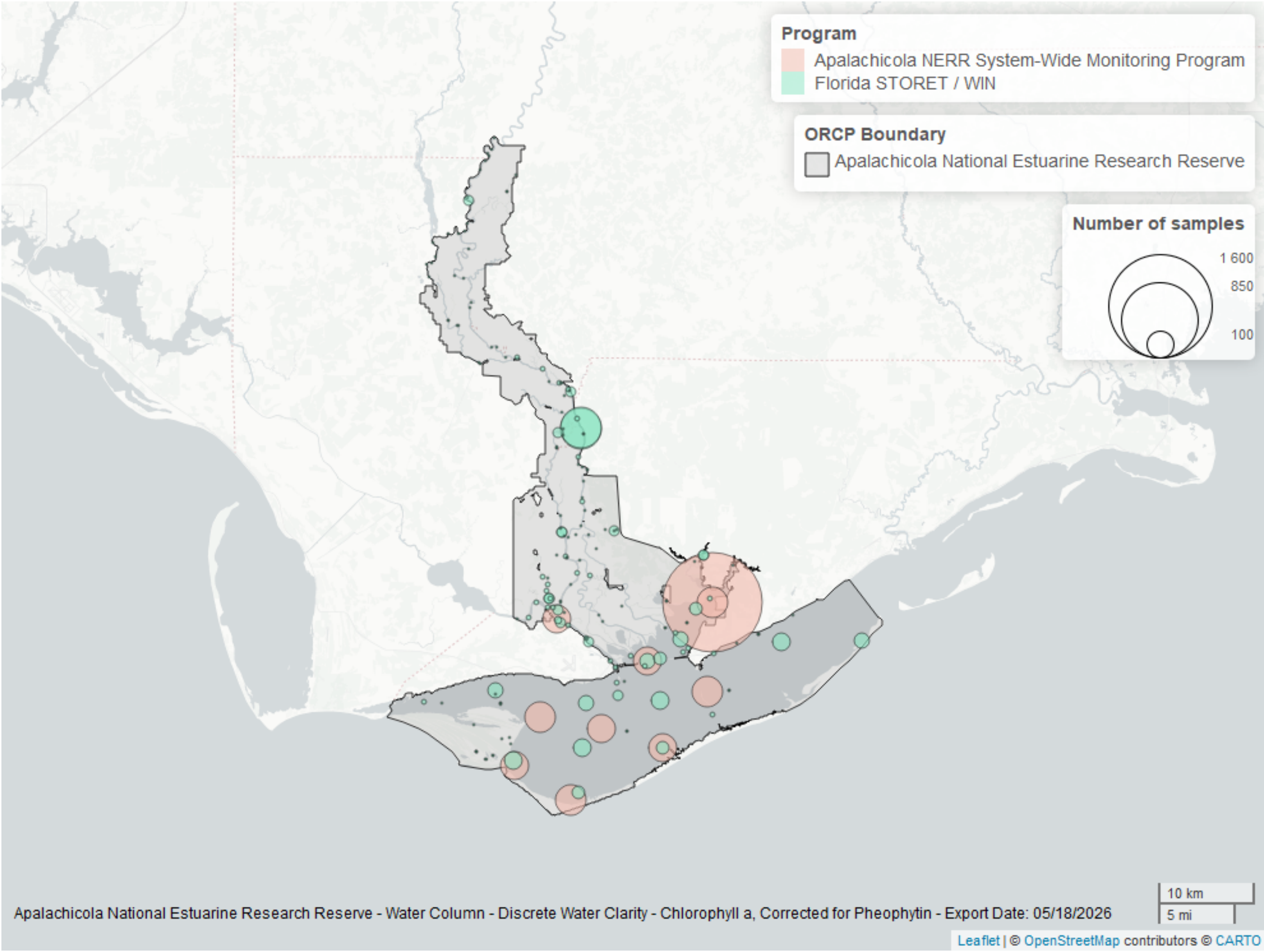

Figure 2: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 7: Programs contributing data for Chlorophyll a, Corrected for Pheophytin

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
355	2733	2013	2025
5002	1170	1999	2025

Program names:

355 - Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve System-Wide Monitoring Program[1]
5002 - Florida STORET / WIN[2]

Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

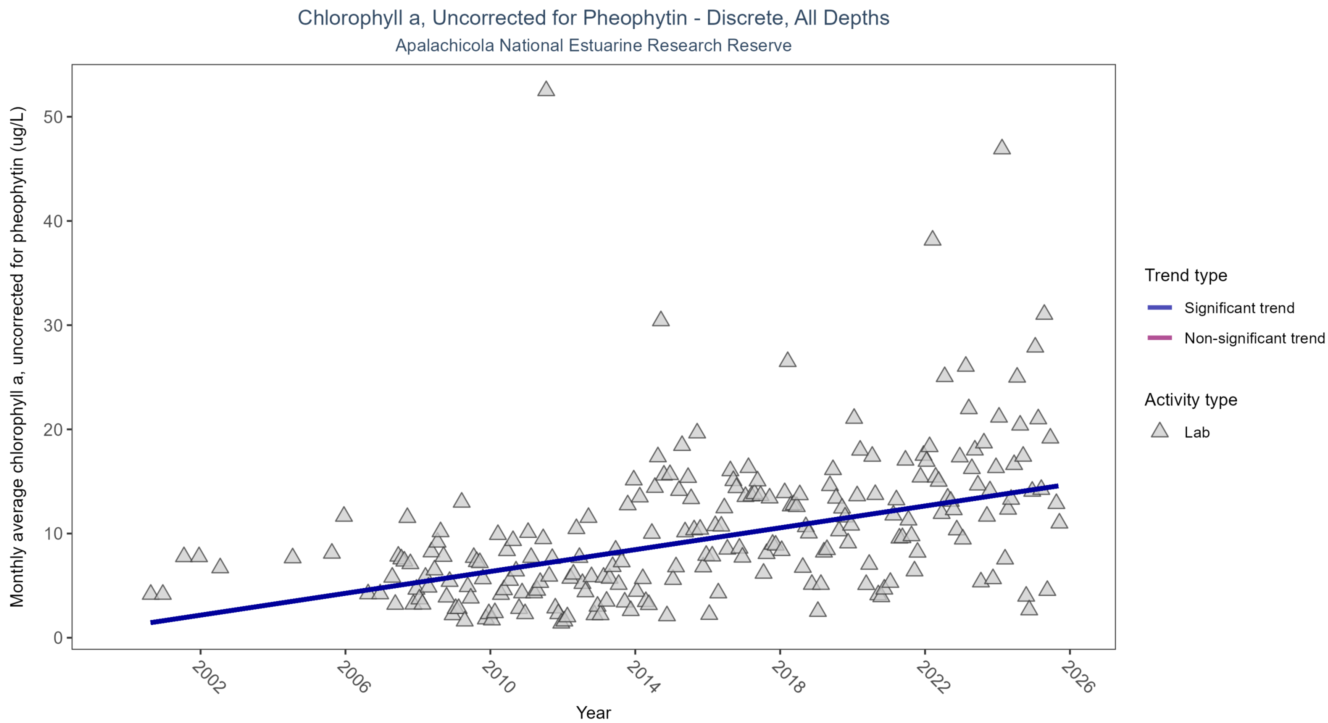

Figure 3: Scatter plot of monthly average levels of chlorophyll a, uncorrected for pheophytin, over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only laboratory-analyzed chlorophyll a (triangles) is included in the plot.

Table 8: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Lab	Increasing trend	3216	25	2000 - 2025	10	0.4126	1.1216	0.5238	0

Monthly average chlorophyll a, uncorrected for pheophytin, increased by 0.52 µg/L per year, indicating a decrease in water clarity.

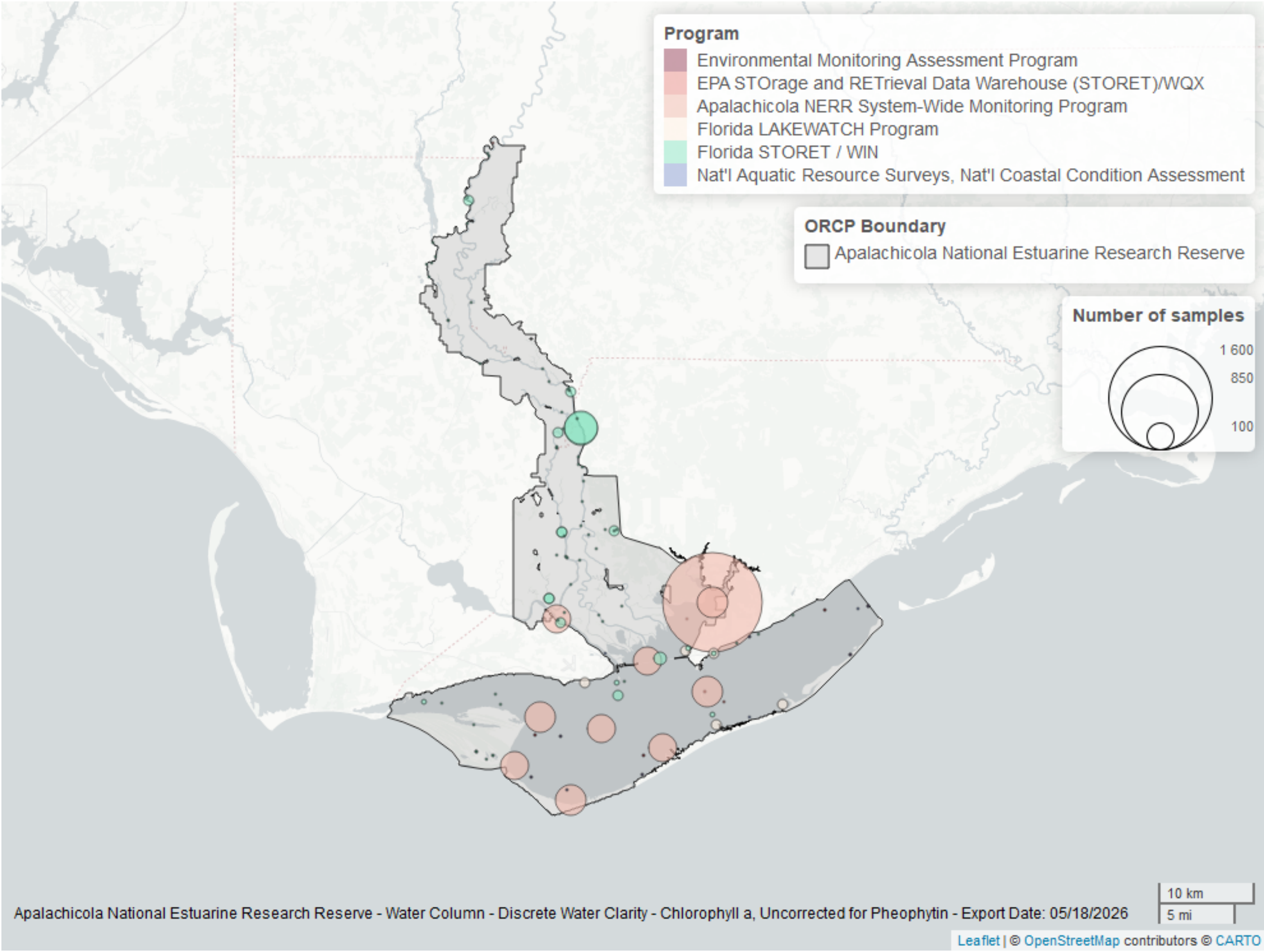

Figure 4: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 9: Programs contributing data for Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
355	2735	2013	2025
5002	390	2007	2025
514	85	2007	2008
103	17	2000	2019
118	10	2000	2010
115	6	2000	2004

Program names:

355 - Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve System-Wide Monitoring Program[1]
5002 - Florida STORET / WIN[2]
514 - Florida LAKEWATCH Program[3]
103 - EPA STOrage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX[4]
118 - National Aquatic Resource Surveys, National Coastal Condition Assessment[5]
115 - Environmental Monitoring Assessment Program[6]

Colored Dissolved Organic Matter - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

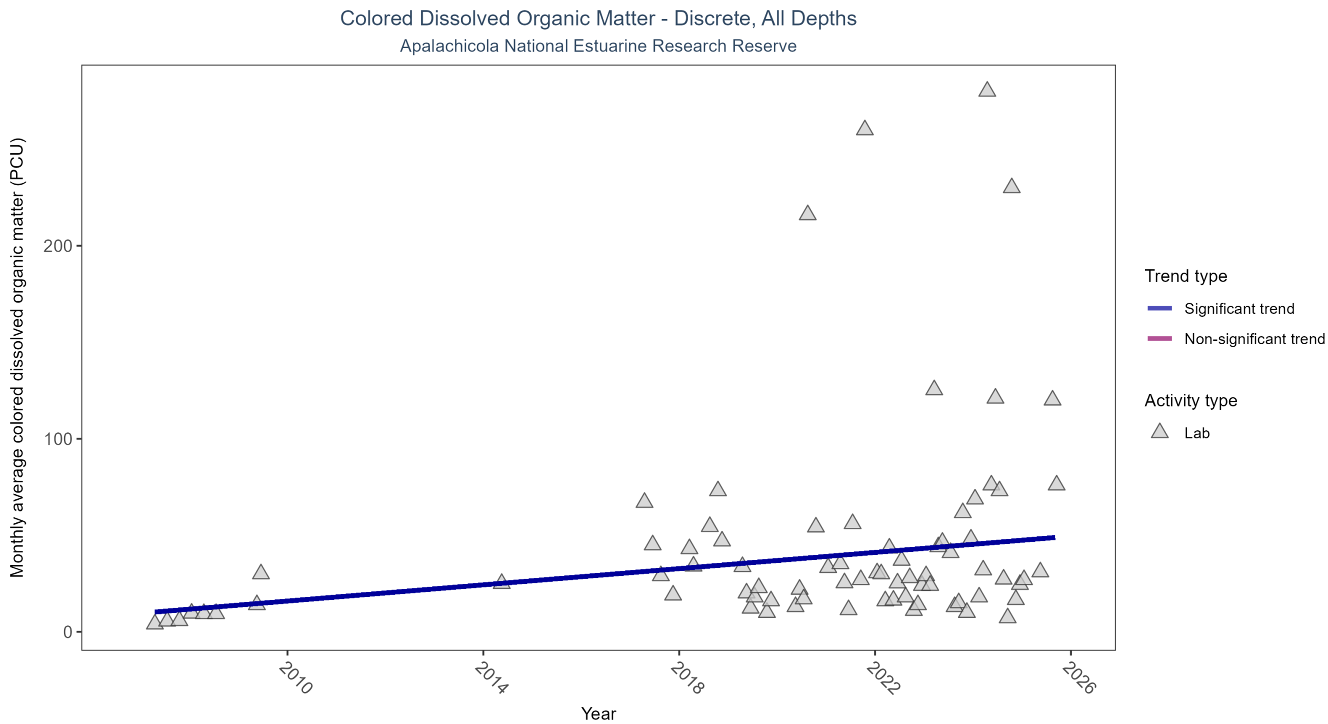

Figure 5: Scatter plot of monthly average colored dissolved organic matter (CDOM) over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only laboratory-analyzed CDOM (triangles) is included in the plot.

Table 10: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Colored Dissolved Organic Matter

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Lab	Increasing trend	183	13	2007 - 2025	23	0.205	9.6302	2.1	0.0036

Monthly average colored dissolved organic matter increased by 2.1 PCU per year, indicating a decrease in water clarity.

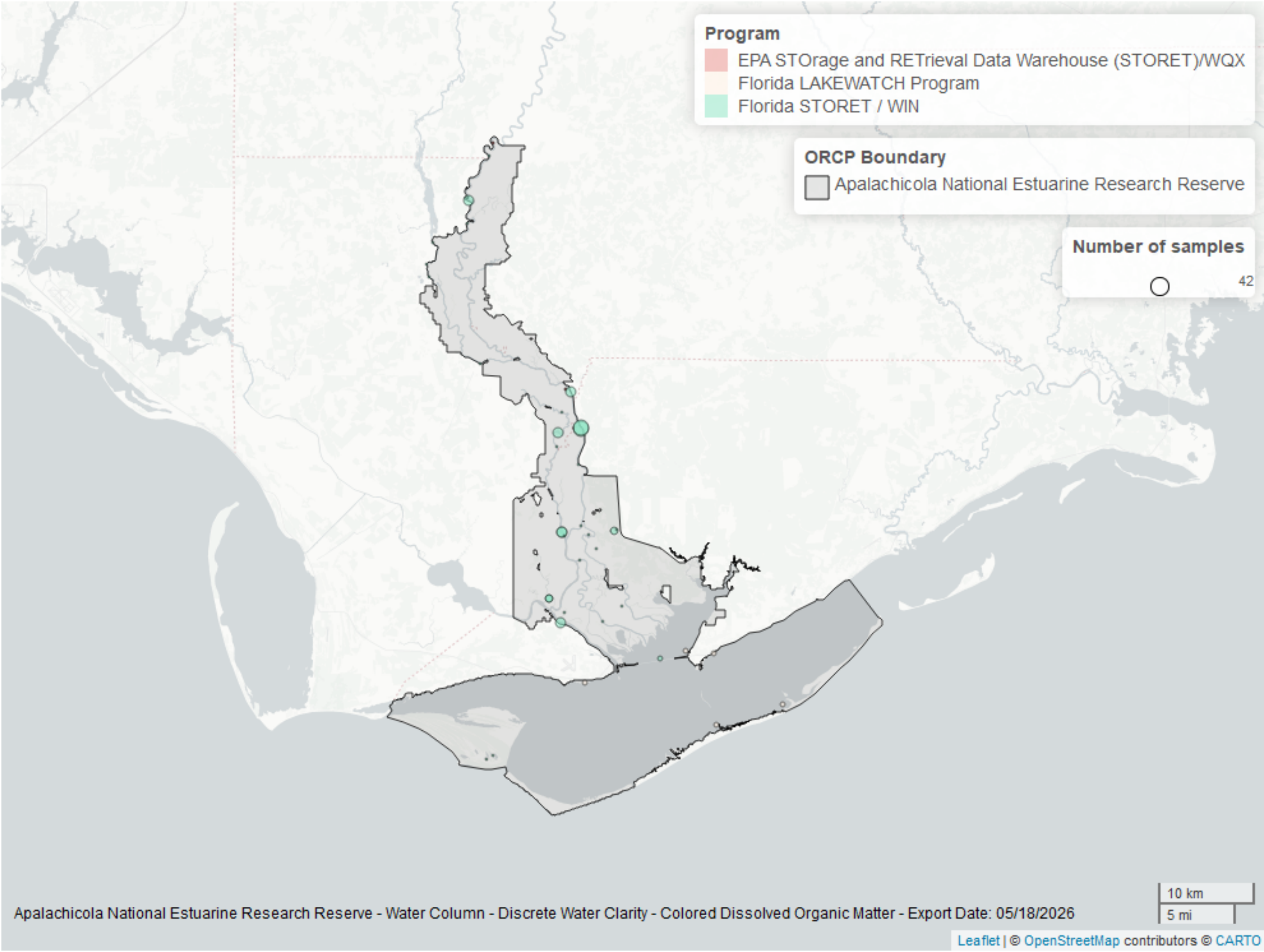

Figure 6: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 11: Programs contributing data for Colored Dissolved Organic Matter

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
5002	168	2017	2025
514	26	2007	2008
103	7	2009	2019

Program names:

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN[2]
514 - Florida LAKEWATCH Program[3]
103 - EPA STOrage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX[4]

Dissolved Oxygen - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

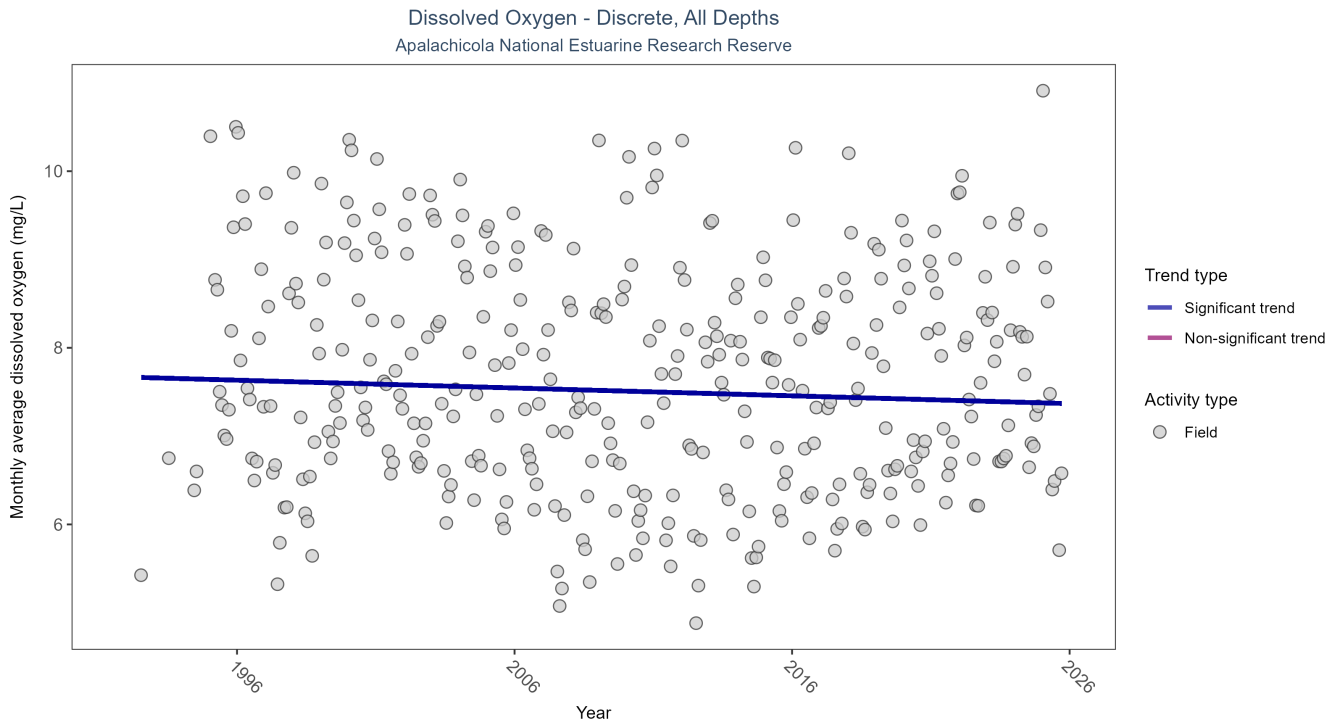

Figure 7: Scatter plot of monthly average dissolved oxygen over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only dissolved oxygen values measured in the field (circles) are included in the plot.

Table 12: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Dissolved Oxygen

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Field	Decreasing trend	82148	34	1992 - 2025	7.5	-0.0829	7.6687	-0.0088	0.0253

Monthly average dissolved oxygen decreased by 0.01 mg/L per year.

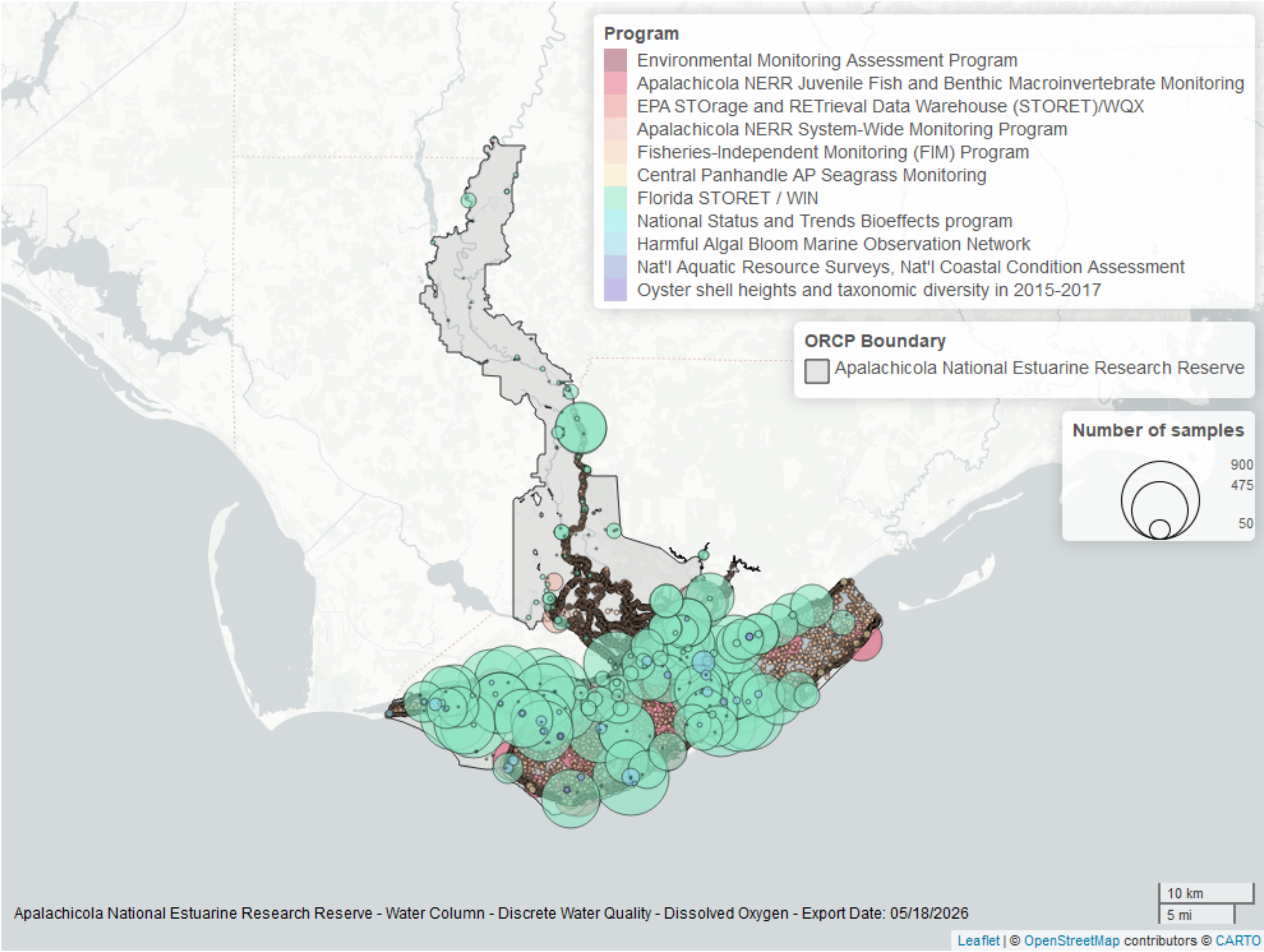

Figure 8: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 13: Programs contributing data for Dissolved Oxygen

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
69	43862	1998	2024
5002	32127	1995	2025
129	4082	2000	2025
355	2569	2011	2025
95	410	1995	2018
557	222	2006	2023
118	78	2000	2020
103	34	2014	2019
115	28	1992	2004
119	14	1994	1994
5071	4	2017	2017

Program names:

69 - Fisheries-Independent Monitoring (FIM) Program[7]

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN[2]
129 - Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve Juvenile Fish and Benthic Macroinvertebrate Monitoring[8]
355 - Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve System-Wide Monitoring Program[1]
95 - Harmful Algal Bloom Marine Observation Network[9]
557 - Central Panhandle Aquatic Preserves Seagrass Monitoring[10]
118 - National Aquatic Resource Surveys, National Coastal Condition Assessment[5]
103 - EPA STOrage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX[4]
115 - Environmental Monitoring Assessment Program[6]
119 - National Status and Trends Bioeffects program[11]
5071 - Oyster shell heights and taxonomic diversity in 2015-2017 among previously documented oiled and non-oiled reefs in Louisiana, Alabama, and the Florida panhandle[12]

Dissolved Oxygen Saturation - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

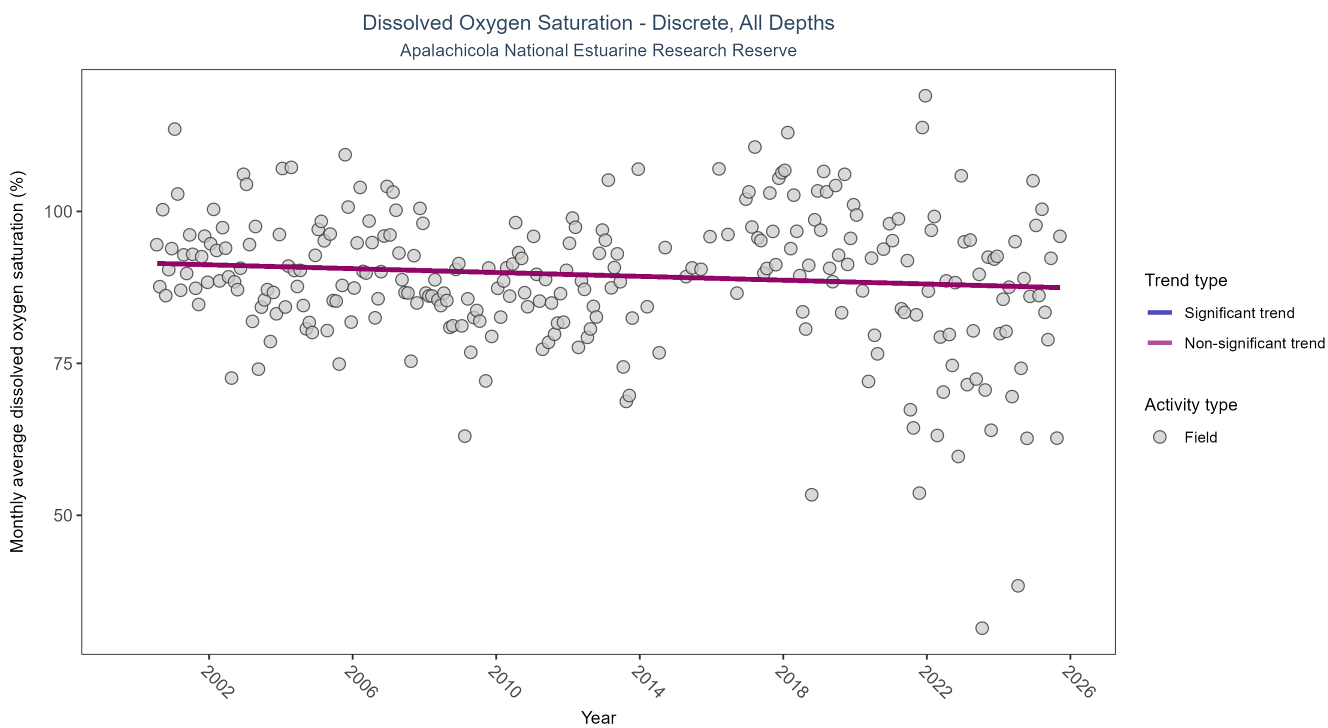

Figure 9: Scatter plot of monthly average dissolved oxygen saturation over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only dissolved oxygen saturation values measured in the field (circles) are included in the plot.

Table 14: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Dissolved Oxygen Saturation

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Field	No detectable trend	5833	26	2000 - 2025	91.4	-0.0907	91.5332	-0.1581	0.0515

Dissolved oxygen saturation showed no detectable trend between 2000 and 2025.

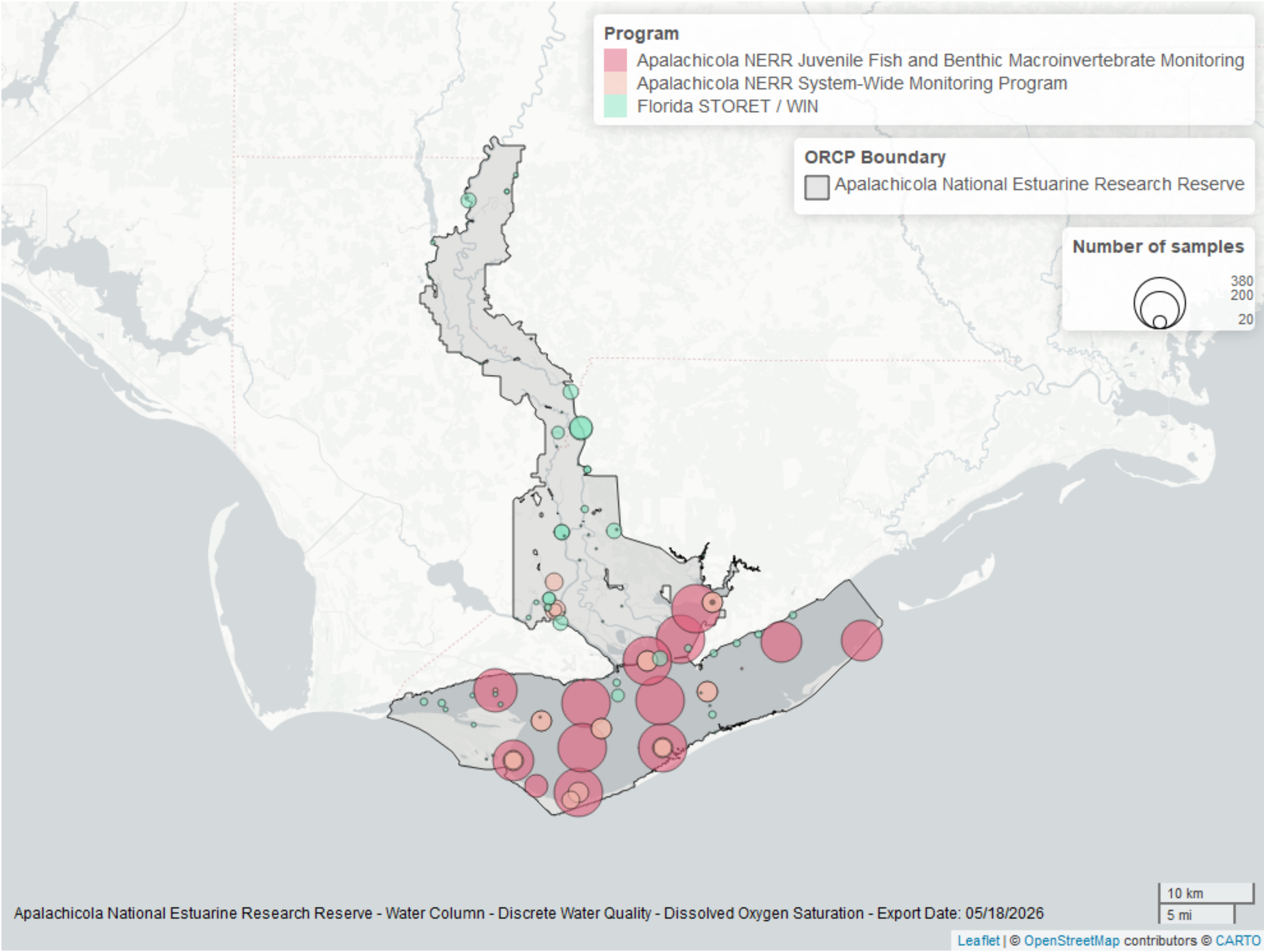

Figure 10: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 15: Programs contributing data for Dissolved Oxygen Saturation

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
129	4064	2000	2025
355	1197	2011	2023
5002	590	2003	2025

Program names:

129 - Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve Juvenile Fish and Benthic Macroinvertebrate Monitoring[8]
355 - Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve System-Wide Monitoring Program[1]
5002 - Florida STORET / WIN[2]

pH - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

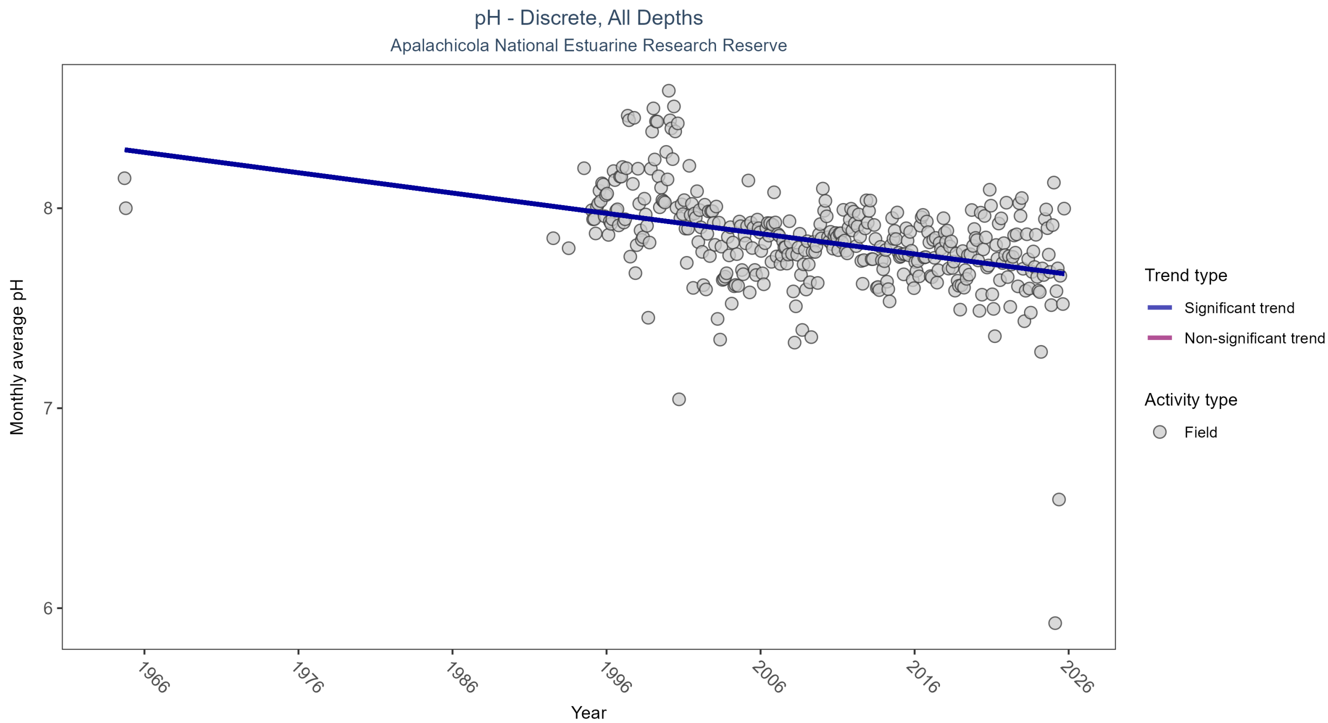

Figure 11: Scatter plot of monthly average pH over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only pH values measured in the field (circles) are included in the plot.

Table 16: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for pH

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Field	Decreasing trend	67283	35	1964 - 2025	7.98	-0.3409	8.2995	-0.0102	0

Monthly average pH decreased by 0.01 pH units per year.

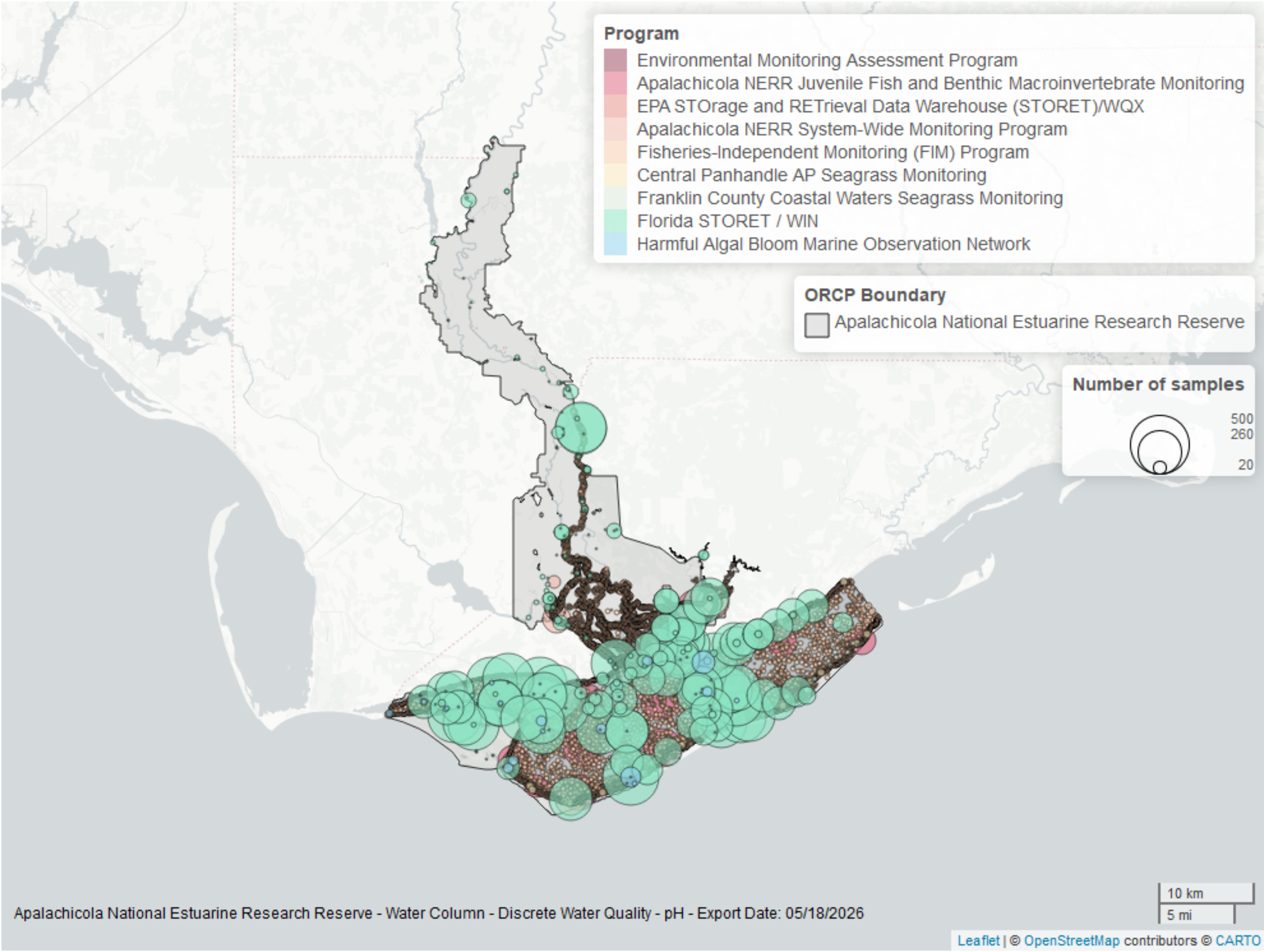

Figure 12: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 17: Programs contributing data for pH

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
69	44002	1998	2024
5002	19264	1995	2025
129	2375	2000	2025
355	2285	2011	2025
95	305	1964	2018
557	209	2006	2023
558	38	2008	2013
103	29	2014	2019
115	28	1992	2004

Program names:

69 - Fisheries-Independent Monitoring (FIM) Program[7]
5002 - Florida STORET / WIN[2]
129 - Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve Juvenile Fish and Benthic Macroinvertebrate Monitoring[8]

355 - Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve System-Wide Monitoring Program[1]
95 - Harmful Algal Bloom Marine Observation Network[9]
557 - Central Panhandle Aquatic Preserves Seagrass Monitoring[10]
558 - Franklin County Coastal Waters Seagrass Monitoring[13]
103 - EPA STOrage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX[4]
115 - Environmental Monitoring Assessment Program[6]

Salinity - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

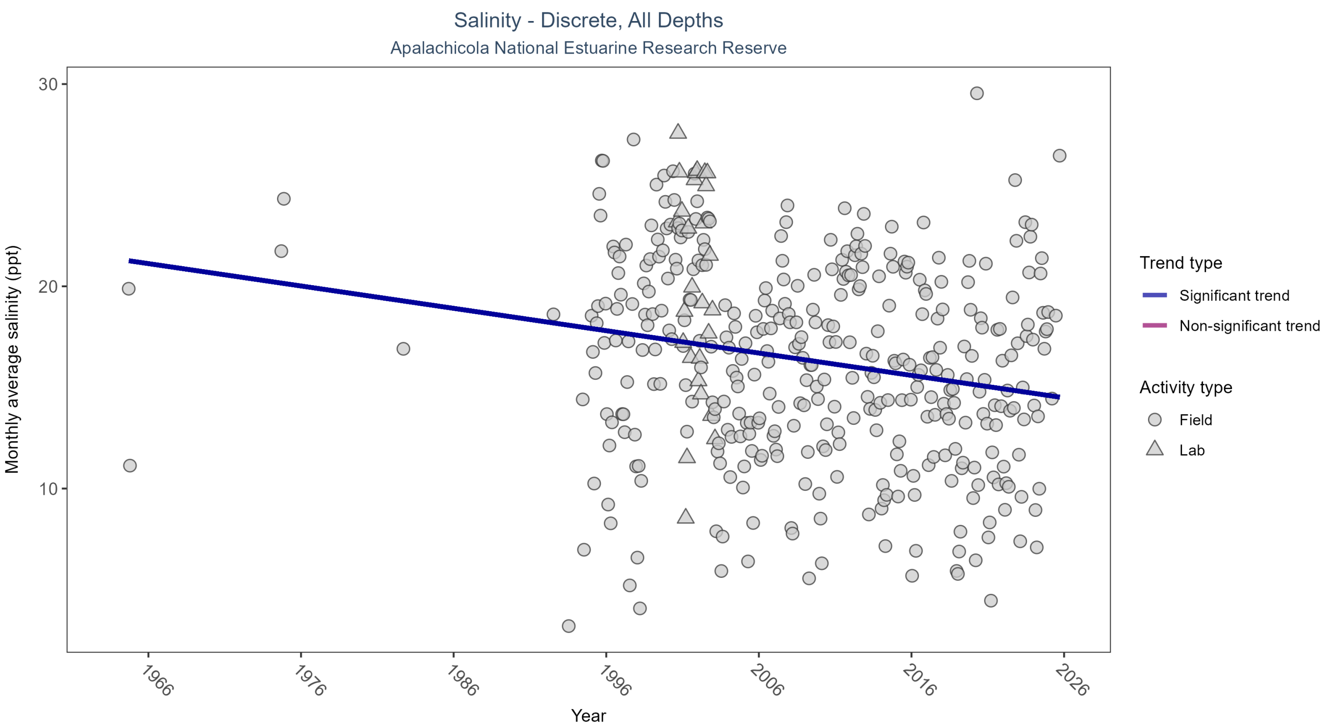

Figure 13: Scatter plot of monthly average salinity over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines are also shown. Discrete salinity values derived from grab samples analyzed in the field (circles) or the laboratory (triangles) are both included in the plot.

Table 18: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Salinity

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
All	Decreasing trend	94442	37	1964 - 2025	16.8	-0.1708	21.3432	-0.1105	0

Monthly average salinity decreased by 0.11 ppt per year.

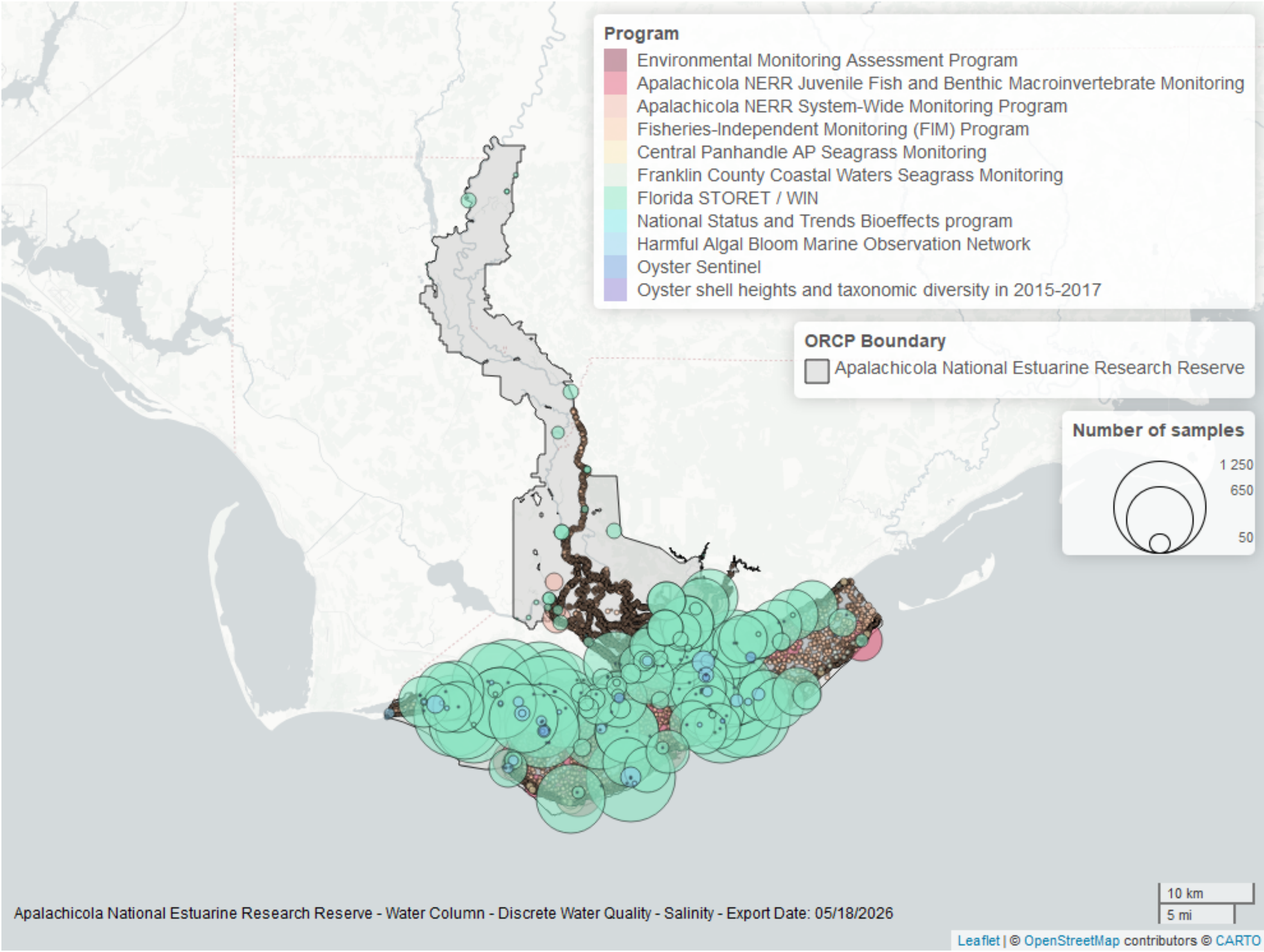

Figure 14: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 19: Programs contributing data for Salinity

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
69	44213	1998	2024
5002	43876	1995	2024
129	4094	2000	2025
355	2419	2011	2024
95	586	1964	2018
557	222	2006	2023
558	132	2008	2014
456	63	2005	2015
115	28	1992	2004
119	14	1994	1994
5071	4	2017	2017

Program names:

69 - Fisheries-Independent Monitoring (FIM) Program[7]

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN[2]
129 - Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve Juvenile Fish and Benthic Macroinvertebrate Monitoring[8]
355 - Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve System-Wide Monitoring Program[1]
95 - Harmful Algal Bloom Marine Observation Network[9]
557 - Central Panhandle Aquatic Preserves Seagrass Monitoring[10]
558 - Franklin County Coastal Waters Seagrass Monitoring[13]
456 - Oyster Sentinel[14]
115 - Environmental Monitoring Assessment Program[6]
119 - National Status and Trends Bioeffects program[11]
5071 - Oyster shell heights and taxonomic diversity in 2015-2017 among previously documented oiled and non-oiled reefs in Louisiana, Alabama, and the Florida panhandle[12]

Total Nitrogen - Discrete

Total Nitrogen Calculation:

The logic for calculated Total Nitrogen was provided by Kevin O'Donnell and colleagues at FDEP (with the help of Jay Silvanima, Watershed Monitoring Section). The following logic is used, in this order, based on the availability of specific nitrogen components.

1) TN = TKN + NO3O2;
2) TN = TKN + NO3 + NO2;
3) TN = ORGN + NH4 + NO3O2;
4) TN = ORGN + NH4 + NO2 + NO3;
5) TN = TKN + NO3;
6) TN = ORGN + NH4 + NO3;

Additional Information:

- Rules for use of sample fraction:
  - Florida Department of Environmental Protection (FDEP) report that if both "Total" and "Dissolved" components are reported, only "Total" is used. If the total is not reported, then the dissolved components are used as a best available replacement.
  - Total nitrogen calculations are done using nitrogen components with the same sample fraction, nitrogen components with mixed total/dissolved sample fractions are not used. In other words, total nitrogen can be calculated when TKN and NO3O2 are both total sample fractions, or when both are dissolved sample fractions. *Future calculations of total nitrogen values may be based on components with mixed sample fractions.*
- Values inserted into data:
  - ParameterName = "Total Nitrogen"
  - SEACAR_QAQCFlagCode = "1Q"
  - SEACAR_QAQC_Description = "SEACAR Calculated"

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

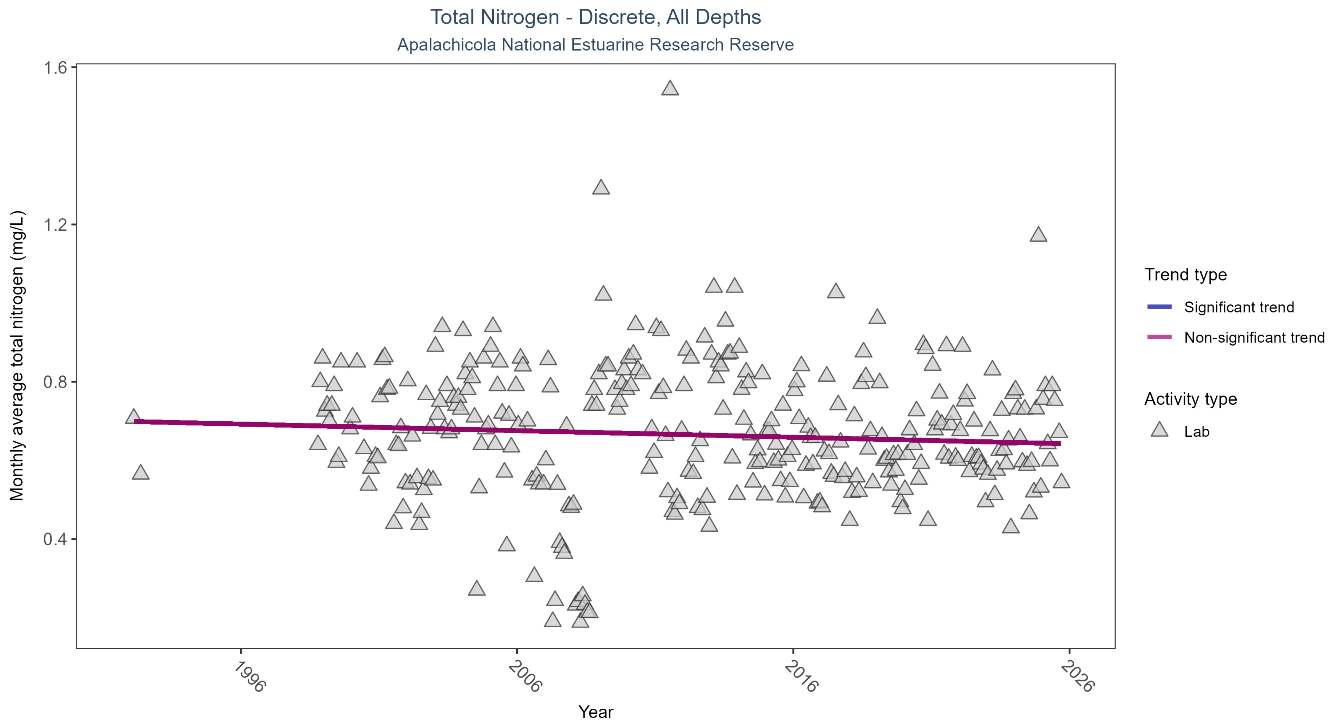

Figure 15: Scatter plot of monthly average total nitrogen over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only nitrogen values obtained from laboratory analyses (triangles) are included in the plot.

Table 20: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Total Nitrogen

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Lab	No detectable trend	3831	29	1992 - 2025	0.628	-0.0635	0.6991	-0.0017	0.1357

Total nitrogen showed no detectable trend between 1992 and 2025.

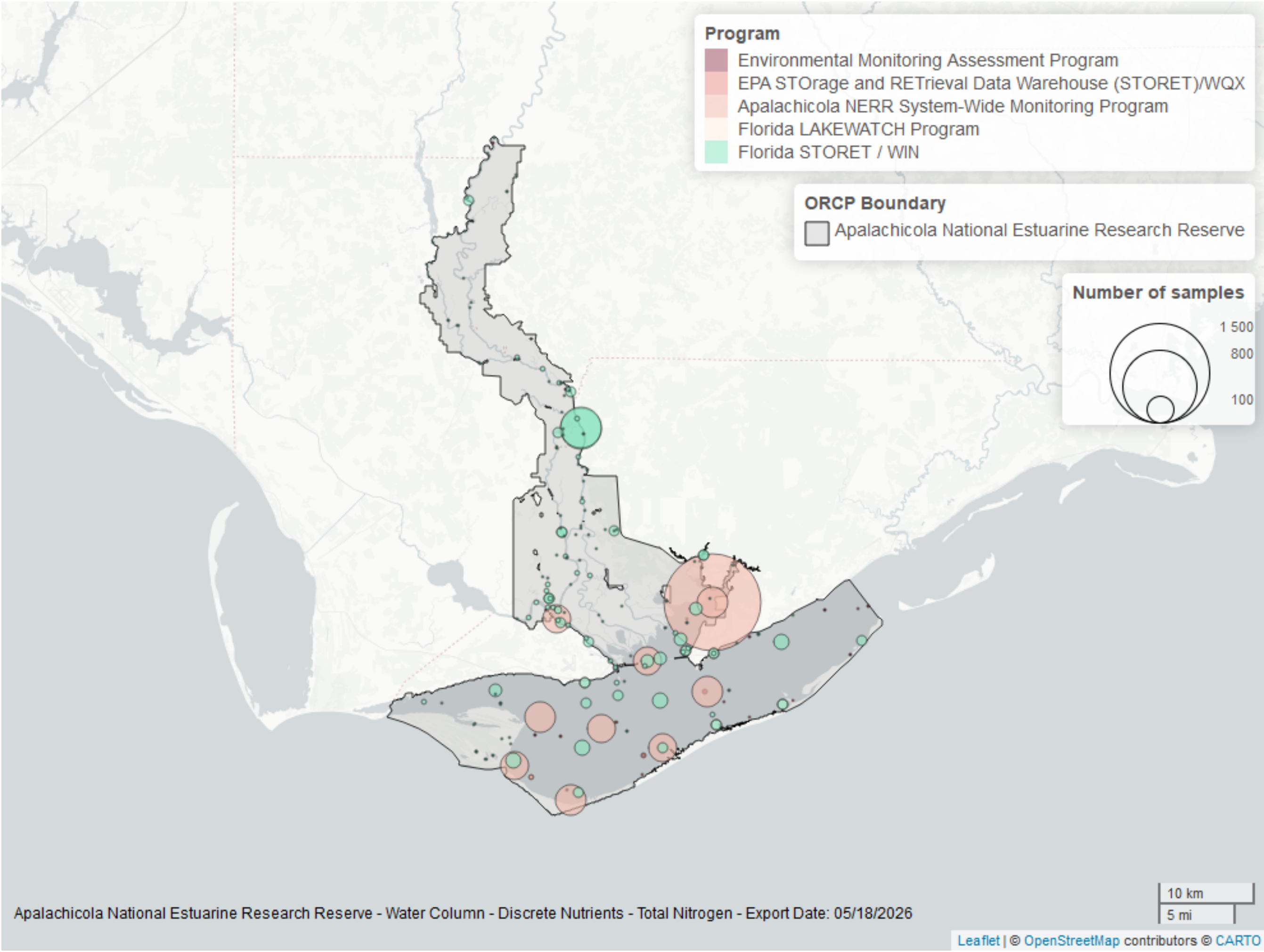

Figure 16: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 21: Programs contributing data for Total Nitrogen

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
355	2647	2013	2025
5002	1056	1992	2025
514	83	2007	2008
103	39	2000	2019
115	6	2000	2004

Program names:

355 - Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve System-Wide Monitoring Program[1]
5002 - Florida STORET / WIN[2]
514 - Florida LAKEWATCH Program[3]
103 - EPA STOrage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX[4]
115 - Environmental Monitoring Assessment Program[6]

Total Phosphorus - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

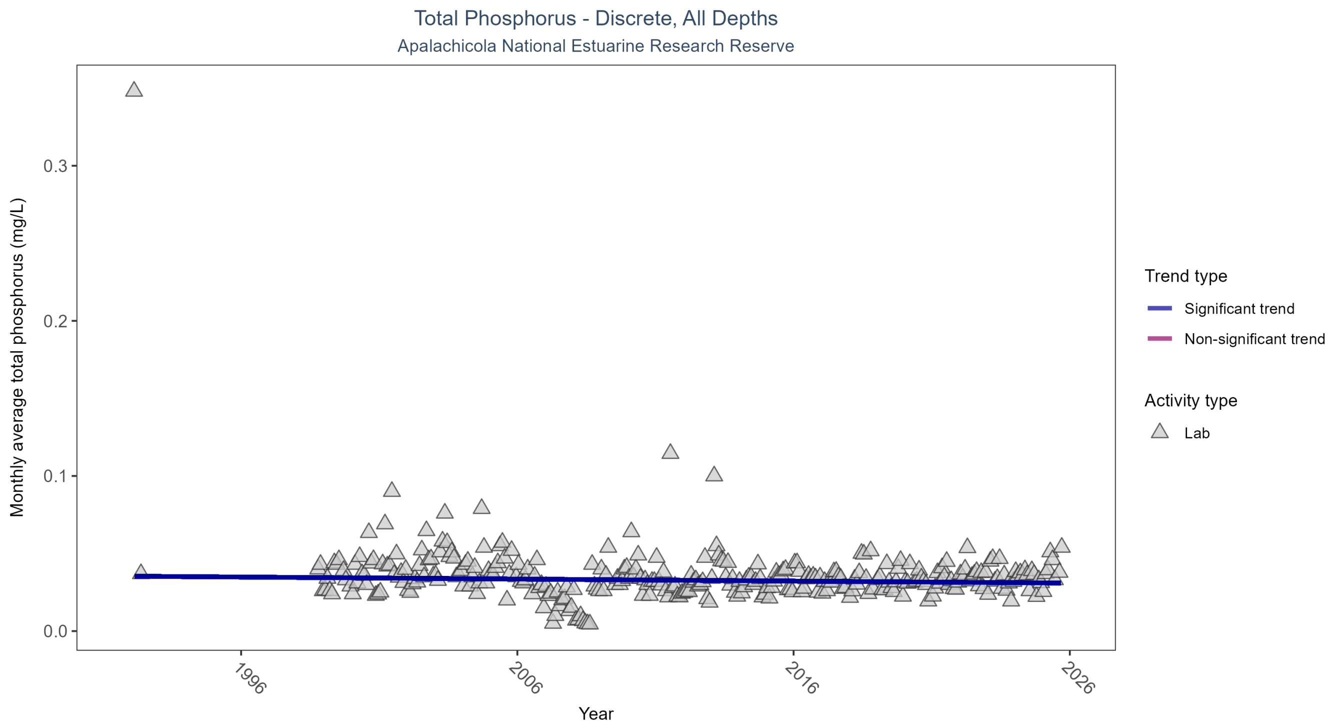

Figure 17: Scatter plot of monthly average total phosphorus over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only phosphorus values obtained from laboratory analyses (triangles) are included in the plot.

Table 22: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Total Phosphorus

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Lab	Decreasing trend	3970	29	1992 - 2025	0.031	-0.085	0.0354	-0.0001	0.0345

Monthly average total phosphorus decreased by less than 0.01 mg/L per year.

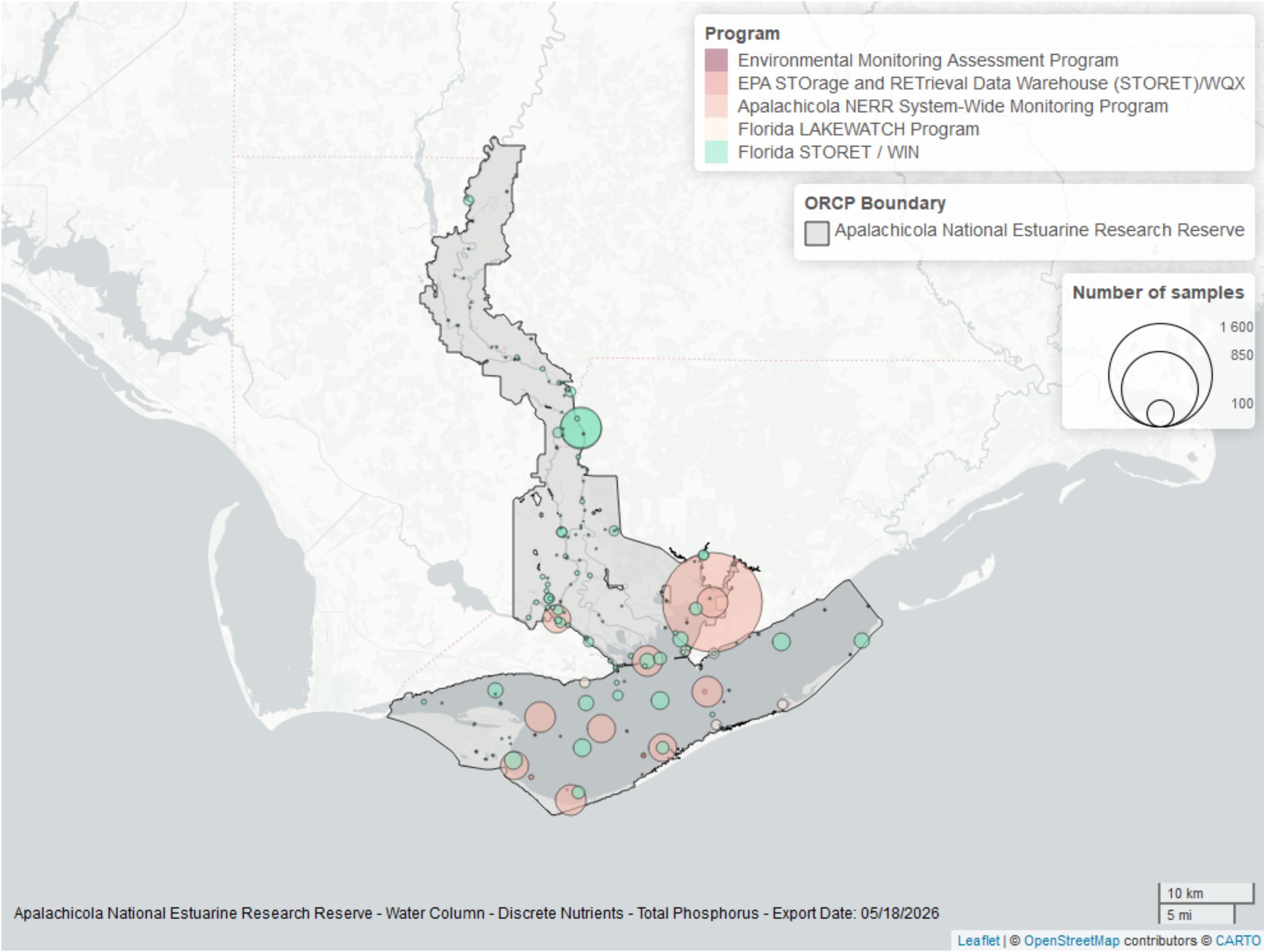

Figure 18: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 23: Programs contributing data for Total Phosphorus

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
355	2768	2013	2025
5002	1188	1992	2025
514	83	2007	2008
103	24	2000	2015
115	6	2000	2004

Program names:

355 - Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve System-Wide Monitoring Program[1]
5002 - Florida STORET / WIN[2]
514 - Florida LAKEWATCH Program[3]
103 - EPA STOrage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX[4]
115 - Environmental Monitoring Assessment Program[6]

Turbidity - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

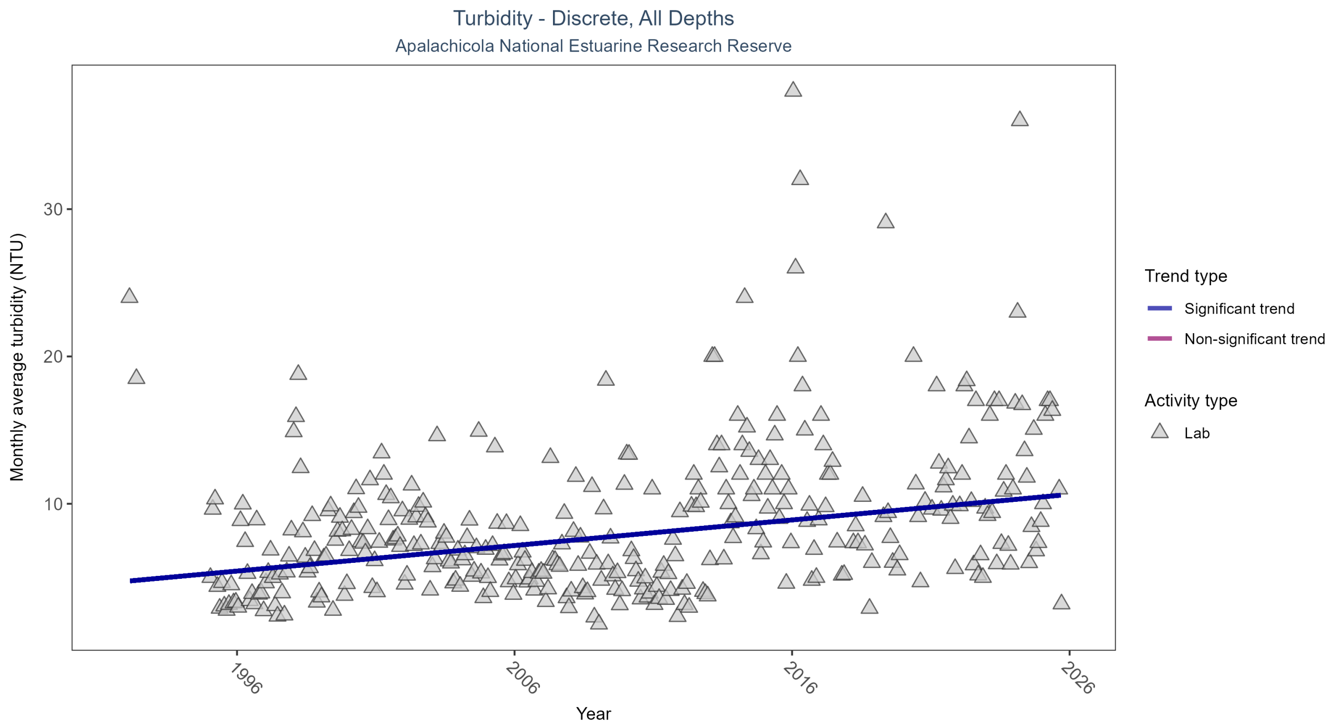

Figure 19: Scatter plot of monthly average turbidity over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only turbidity values measured in the laboratory (triangles) are included in the plot.

Table 24: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Turbidity

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Lab	Increasing trend	22996	32	1992 - 2025	5.1	0.2747	4.7375	0.1735	0

Monthly average turbidity increased by 0.17 NTU per year, indicating a decrease in water clarity.

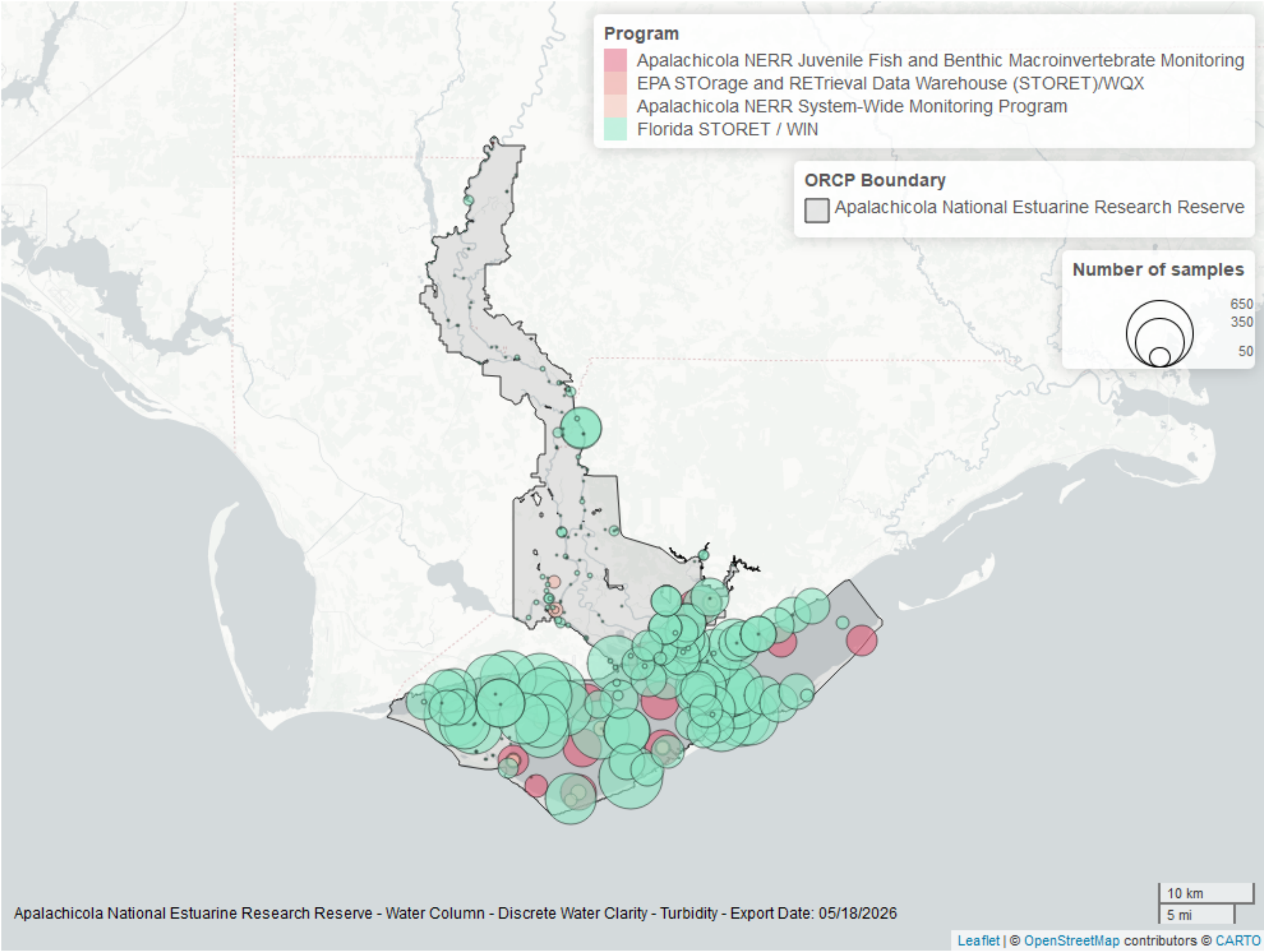

Figure 20: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 25: Programs contributing data for Turbidity

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
5002	22991	1992	2025
129	2379	2000	2025
355	662	2011	2019
103	10	2005	2019

Program names:

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN[2]
129 - Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve Juvenile Fish and Benthic Macroinvertebrate Monitoring[8]
355 - Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve System-Wide Monitoring Program[1]
103 - EPA STOrage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX[4]

Water Temperature - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

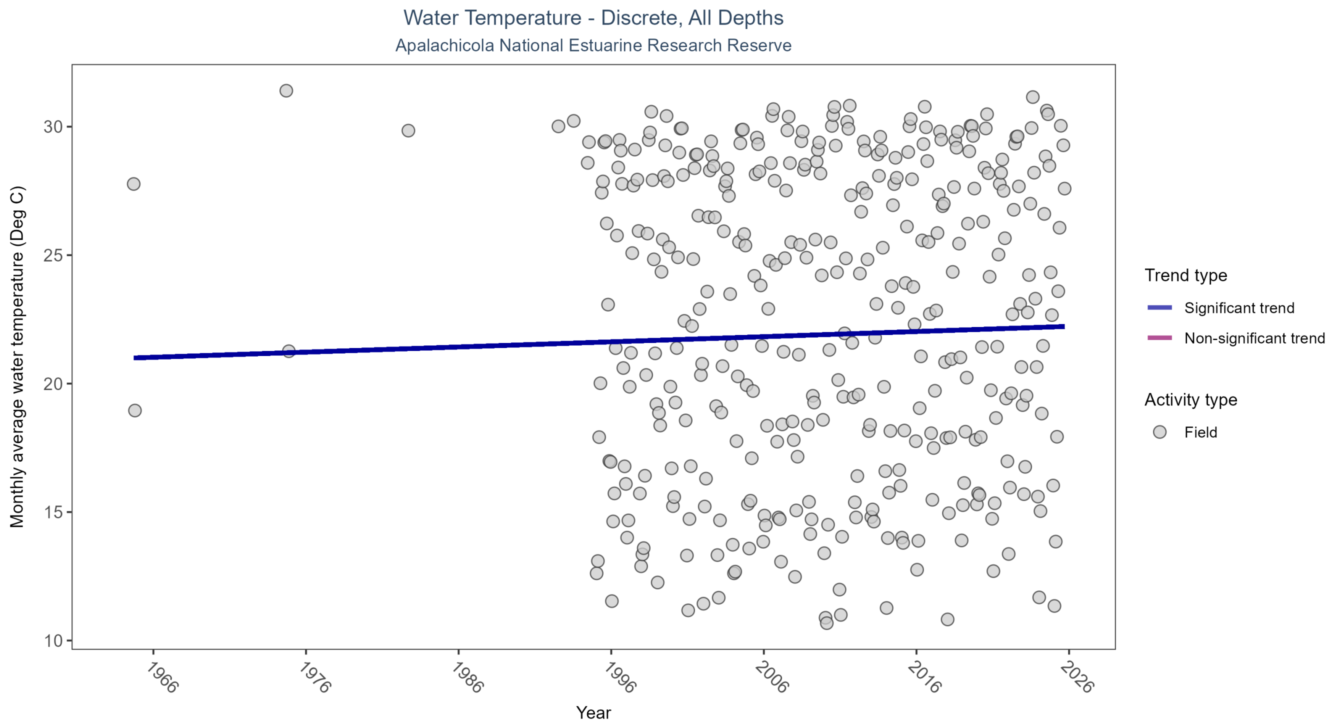

Figure 21: Scatter plot of monthly average water temperature over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only water temperature measurements taken in the field (circles) are included in the plot.

Table 26: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Water Temperature

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Field	Increasing trend	95140	37	1964 - 2025	23.4	0.1262	20.984	0.0201	0.0006

Monthly average water temperature increased by 0.02°C per year.

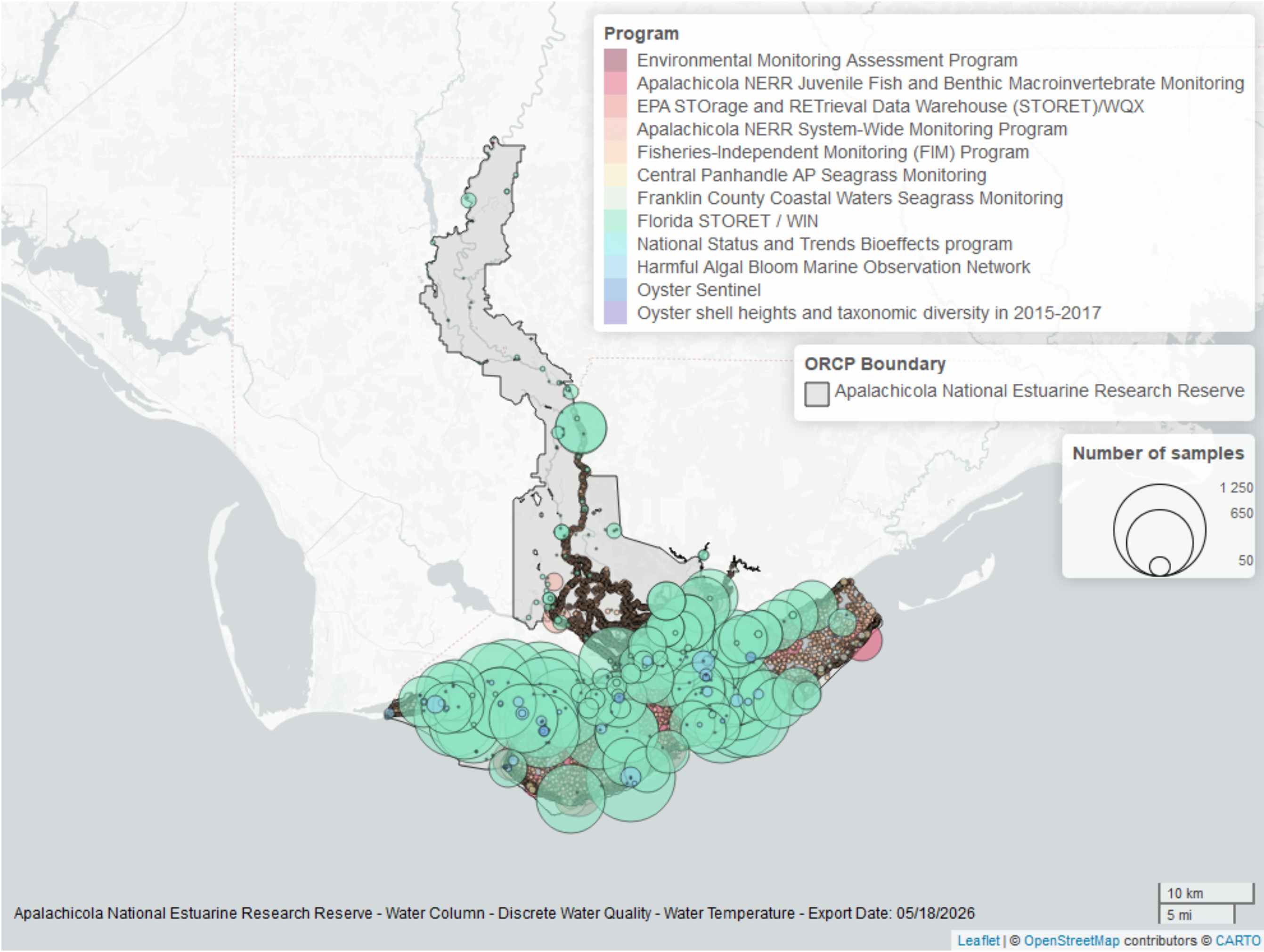

Figure 22: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 27: Programs contributing data for Water Temperature

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
5002	44395	1995	2025
69	44351	1998	2024
129	4087	2000	2025
355	2572	2011	2025
95	537	1964	2018
557	222	2006	2023
558	146	2008	2017
456	63	2005	2015
115	28	1992	2004
119	14	1994	1994
103	5	2014	2019
5071	4	2017	2017

Program names:

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN[2]
69 - Fisheries-Independent Monitoring (FIM) Program[7]
129 - Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve Juvenile Fish and Benthic Macroinvertebrate Monitoring[8]
355 - Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve System-Wide Monitoring Program[1]
95 - Harmful Algal Bloom Marine Observation Network[9]
557 - Central Panhandle Aquatic Preserves Seagrass Monitoring[10]
558 - Franklin County Coastal Waters Seagrass Monitoring[13]
456 - Oyster Sentinel[14]
115 - Environmental Monitoring Assessment Program[6]
119 - National Status and Trends Bioeffects program[11]
103 - EPA STOrage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX[4]
5071 - Oyster shell heights and taxonomic diversity in 2015-2017 among previously documented oiled and non-oiled reefs in Louisiana, Alabama, and the Florida panhandle[12]

Water Quality - Continuous

The following files were used in the continuous analysis:

- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Chlorophyll_a_Uncorrected_for_Pheophytin-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Dissolved_Oxygen-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Dissolved_Oxygen_Saturation-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Fluorescent_Dissolved_Organic_Matter-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_pH-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Salinity-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Specific_Conductivity-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Turbidity-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Water_Temperature-2026-Mar-06.txt*

Continuous monitoring locations in Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve

Table 28: Station overview for Continuous parameters by Program

ProgramID	*ProgramLocationID*	*Years of Data*	*Use in Analysis*	*Parameters*
5	APCF1	21	TRUE	Water Temperature
355	apabpwq	7	TRUE	pH , Dissolved Oxygen Saturation, Dissolved Oxygen , Turbidity , Water Temperature , Salinity , Specific Conductivity
355	apacpwq	25	TRUE	pH , Dissolved Oxygen Saturation, Dissolved Oxygen , Turbidity , Water Temperature , Salinity , Specific Conductivity
355	apadbwq	25	TRUE	pH , Dissolved Oxygen Saturation, Dissolved Oxygen , Turbidity , Water Temperature , Salinity , Specific Conductivity
355	apaebwq	30	TRUE	Turbidity
355	apaebwq	32	TRUE	pH , Dissolved Oxygen Saturation, Dissolved Oxygen , Water Temperature , Salinity , Specific Conductivity
355	apaeswq	31	TRUE	Turbidity
355	apaeswq	32	TRUE	pH , Dissolved Oxygen Saturation, Dissolved Oxygen , Water Temperature , Salinity , Specific Conductivity
355	apalmwq	11	TRUE	pH , Dissolved Oxygen Saturation, Dissolved Oxygen , Turbidity , Water Temperature , Salinity , Specific Conductivity
355	apapcwq	11	TRUE	pH , Dissolved Oxygen Saturation, Dissolved Oxygen , Turbidity , Water Temperature , Salinity , Specific Conductivity

Program names:

5 - National Data Buoy Center[15]
355 - Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve System-Wide Monitoring Program[1]

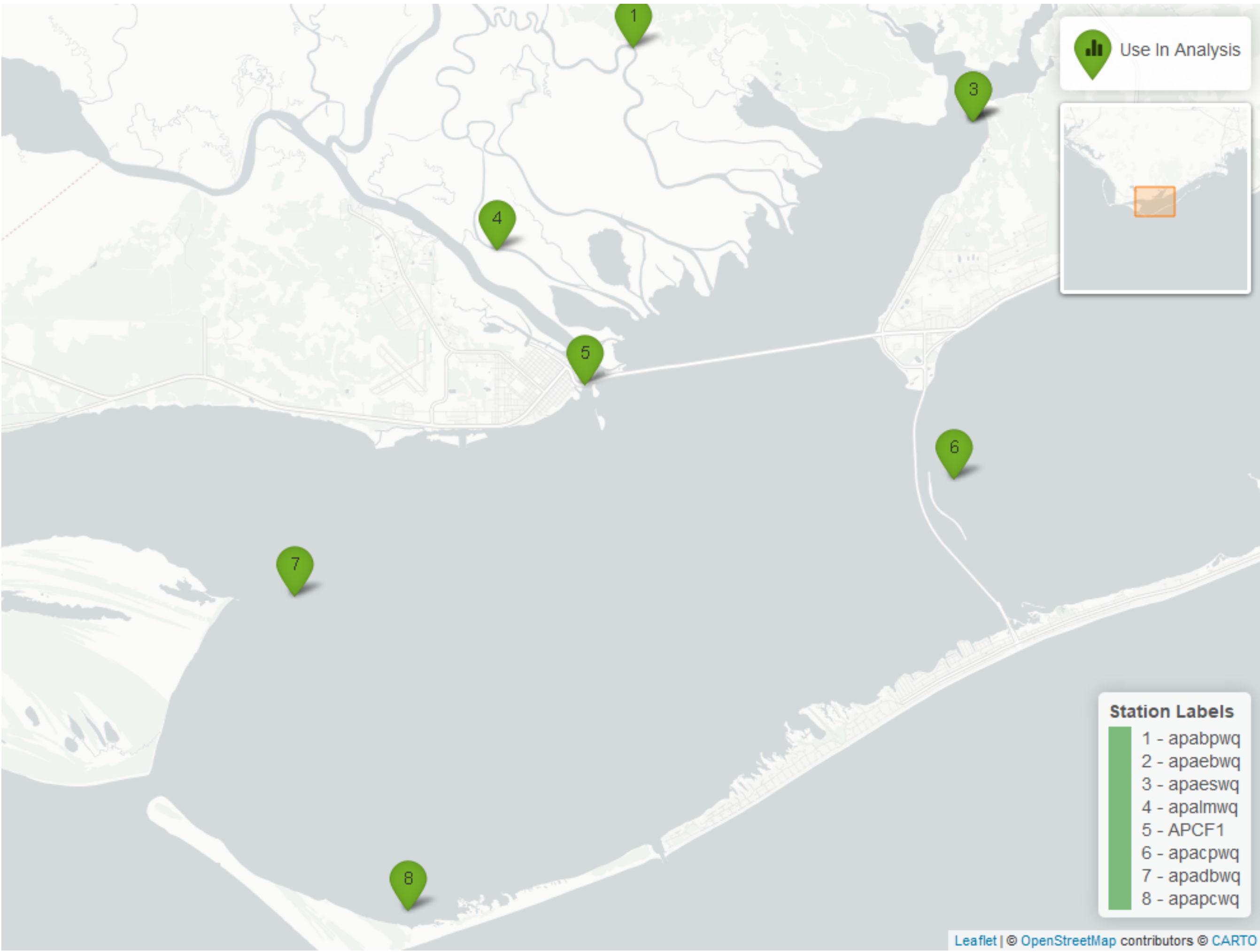

Figure 23: Map showing continuous water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve*. Sites marked as *Use In Analysis* (green) are featured in this report.

pH - Continuous

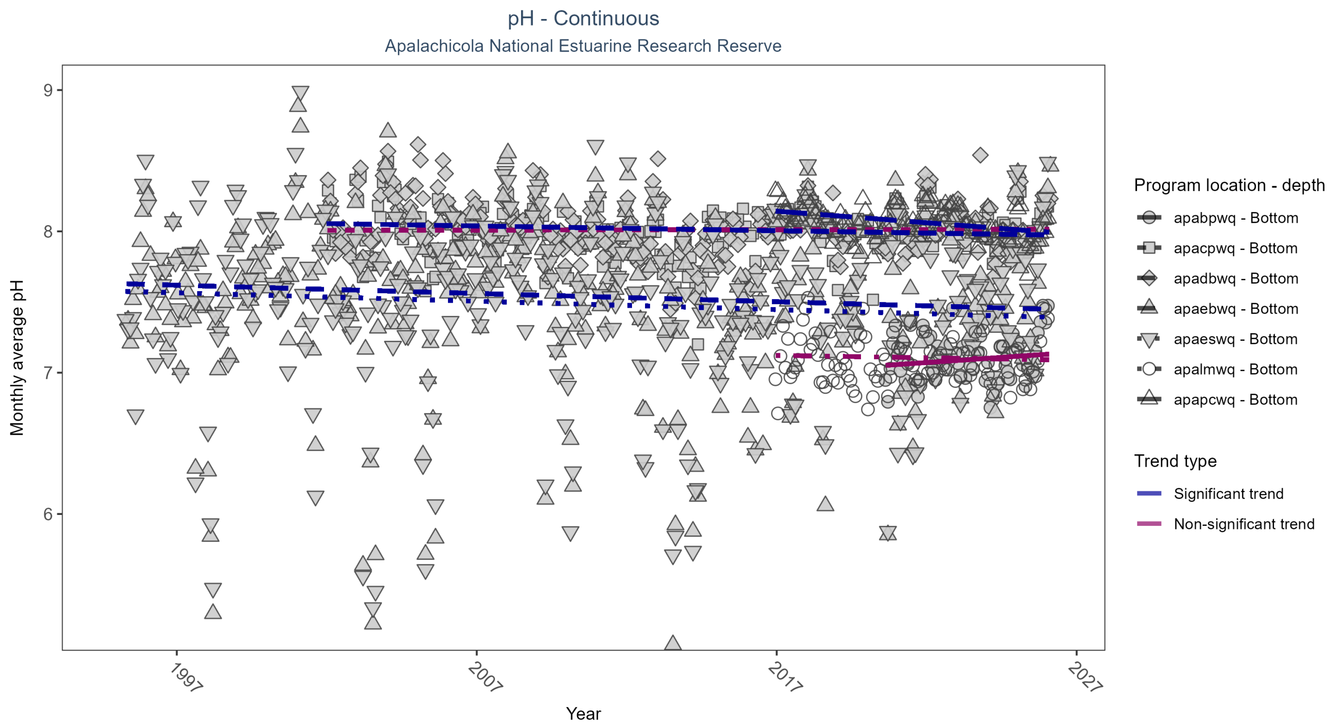

Figure 24: Scatter plot of monthly average pH over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 29: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for pH - All Stations

Program Location	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
apadbwq	Significantly decreasing trend	636788	25	2002 - 2026	8.0	-0.11	8.06	0.00	0.01
apaebwq	Significantly decreasing trend	754923	32	1995 - 2026	7.6	-0.11	7.63	-0.01	0.00
apaeswq	Significantly decreasing trend	745836	32	1995 - 2026	7.5	-0.10	7.58	-0.01	0.01
apalmwq	No significant trend	297196	11	2016 - 2026	7.1	-0.06	7.13	0.00	0.50
apapcwq	Significantly decreasing trend	302765	11	2016 - 2026	8.1	-0.35	8.16	-0.02	0.00
apabpwq	No significant trend	184904	7	2020 - 2026	7.1	0.09	7.04	0.01	0.30
apacpwq	No significant trend	649552	25	2002 - 2026	8.0	0.01	8.01	0.00	0.86

At four program locations, monthly average pH decreased between less than 0.01 and 0.02 pH units per year. No detectable change in monthly average pH was observed at three locations.

Dissolved Oxygen Saturation - Continuous

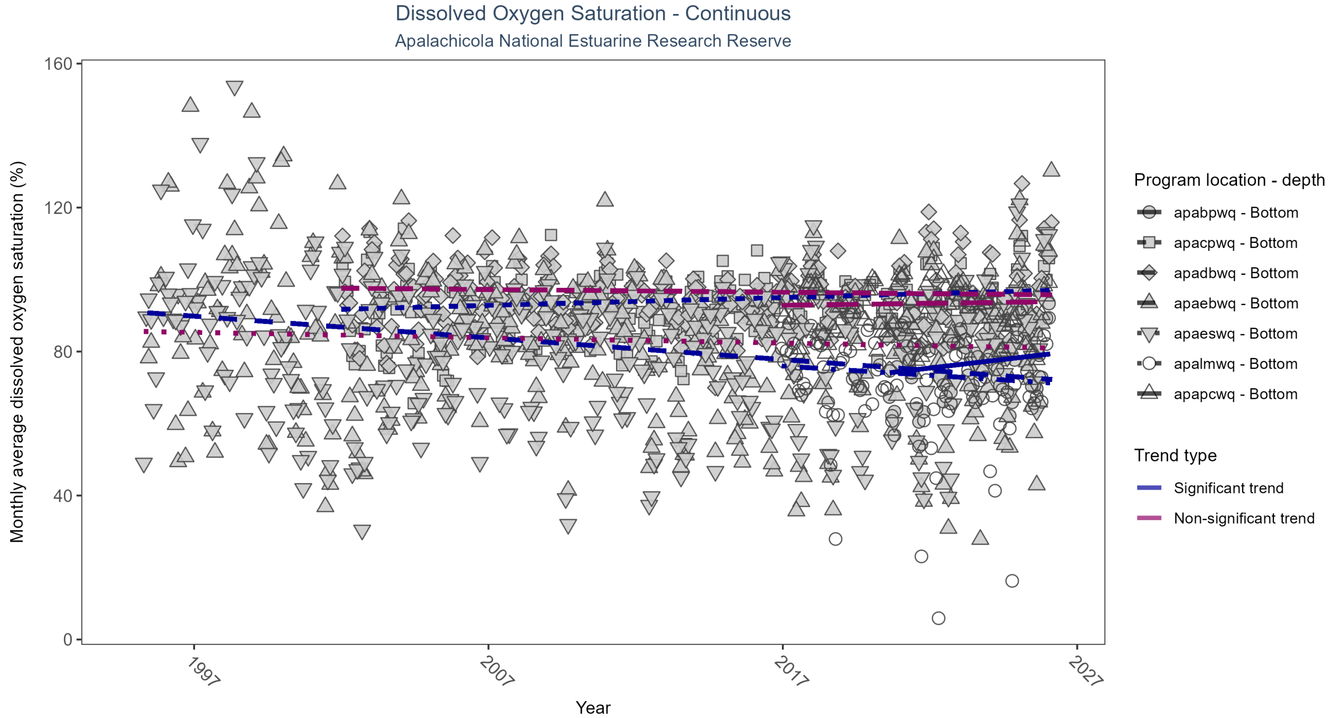

Figure 25: Scatter plot of monthly average dissolved oxygen saturation over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 30: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for Dissolved Oxygen Saturation - All Stations

Program Location	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
apadbwq	No significant trend	658527	25	2002 - 2026	94.9	-0.05	97.62	-0.08	0.27
apaebwq	Significantly decreasing trend	694367	32	1995 - 2026	84.9	-0.23	91.03	-0.60	0.00
apaeswq	No significant trend	746726	32	1995 - 2026	84.5	-0.06	85.63	-0.15	0.10
apalmwq	Significantly decreasing trend	289599	11	2016 - 2026	74.9	-0.16	76.47	-0.51	0.04
apapcwq	No significant trend	305661	11	2016 - 2026	94.0	0.04	92.74	0.11	0.54
apabpwq	Significantly increasing trend	184169	7	2020 - 2026	77.0	0.25	73.51	0.96	0.02
apacpwq	Significantly increasing trend	651534	25	2002 - 2026	94.3	0.18	91.75	0.22	0.00

At two program locations, monthly average dissolved oxygen saturation increased by 0.22% per year at one site and by 0.96% per year at the other. At two program locations, monthly average dissolved oxygen saturation decreased by 0.51% per year at one site and by 0.6% per year at the other. No detectable change in monthly average dissolved oxygen saturation was observed at three locations.

Dissolved Oxygen - Continuous

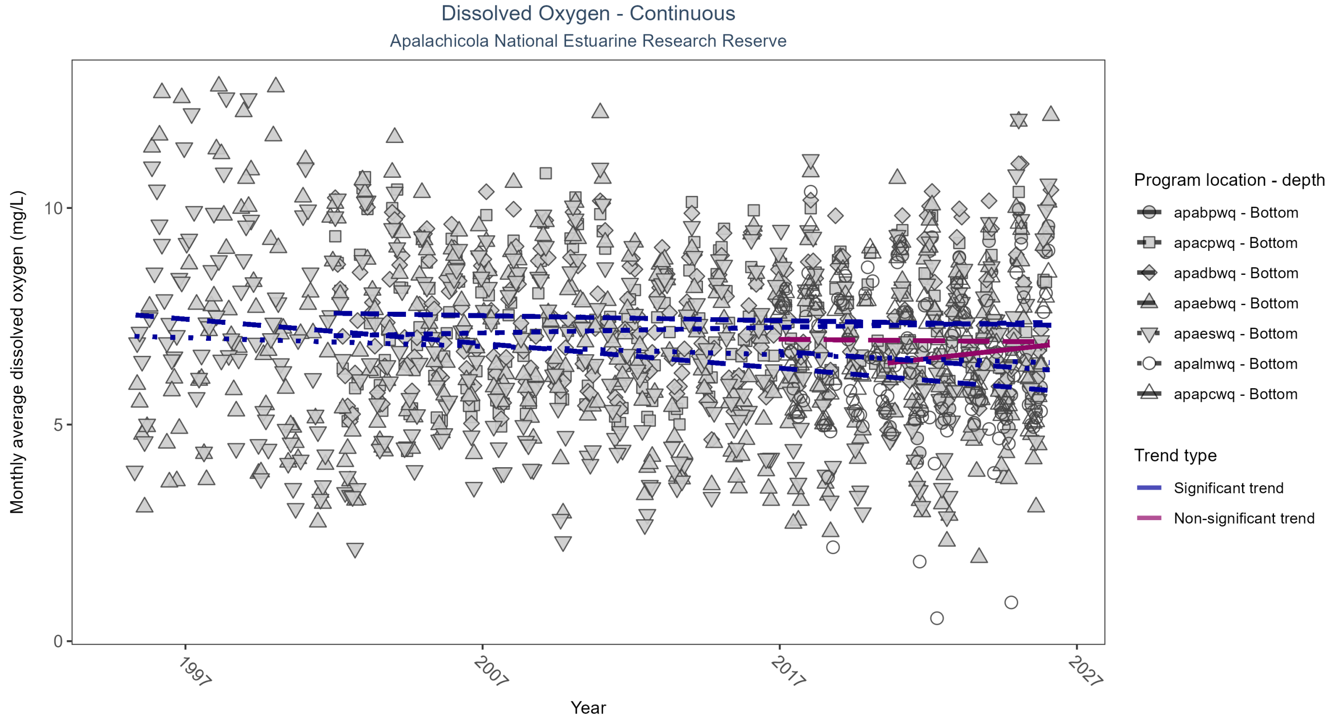

Figure 26: Scatter plot of monthly average dissolved oxygen over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 31: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for Dissolved Oxygen - All Stations

Program Location	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
apadbwq	Significantly decreasing trend	654044	25	2002 - 2026	7.3	-0.11	7.57	-0.01	0.01
apaebwq	Significantly decreasing trend	698115	32	1995 - 2026	6.8	-0.27	7.55	-0.06	0.00
apaeswq	Significantly decreasing trend	745989	32	1995 - 2026	6.8	-0.10	7.04	-0.02	0.01
apalmwq	Significantly decreasing trend	289063	11	2016 - 2026	6.3	-0.16	6.74	-0.05	0.04
apapcwq	No significant trend	302205	11	2016 - 2026	6.9	-0.03	6.98	-0.01	0.79
apabpwq	No significant trend	184169	7	2020 - 2026	6.5	0.14	6.37	0.08	0.16
apacpwq	Significantly increasing trend	650006	25	2002 - 2026	7.1	0.12	7.05	0.01	0.00

At one program location, monthly average dissolved oxygen increased by 0.01 mg/L per year. At four program locations, monthly average dissolved oxygen decreased between 0.01 and 0.06 mg/L per year. No detectable change in monthly average dissolved oxygen was observed at two locations.

Turbidity - Continuous

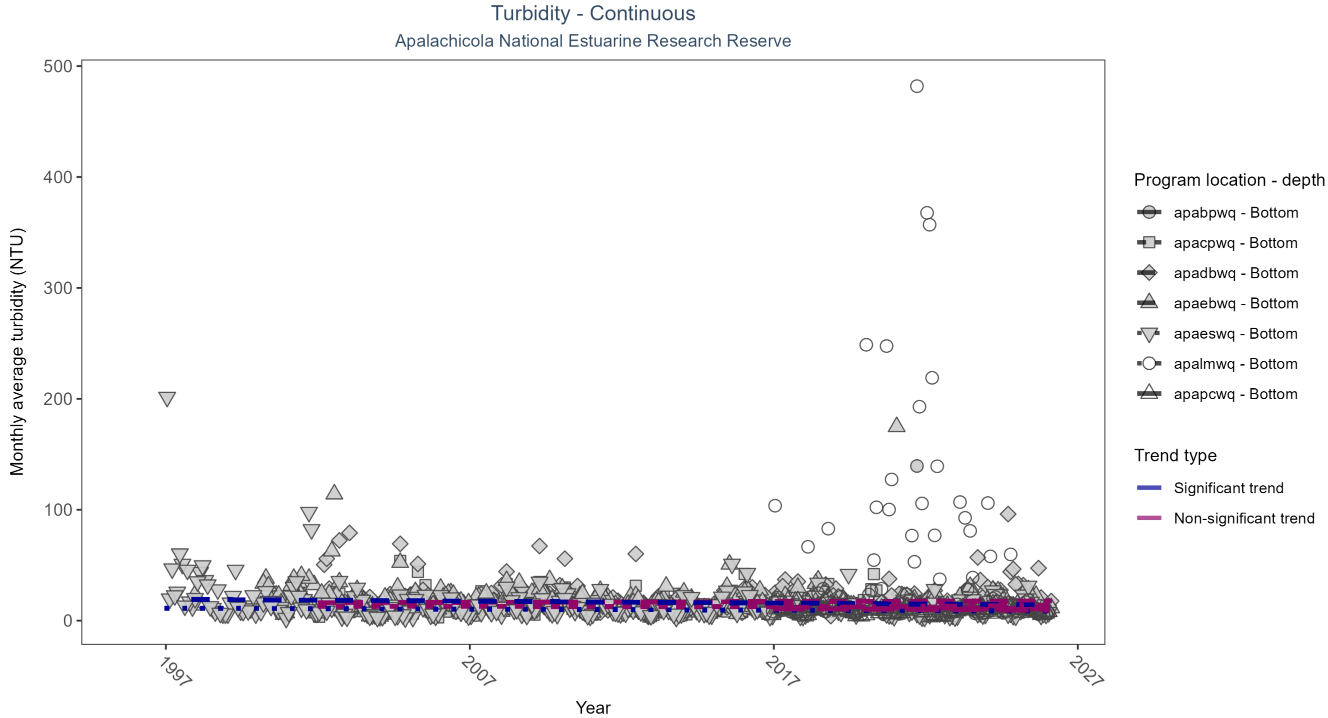

Figure 27: Scatter plot of monthly average turbidity over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 32: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for Turbidity - All Stations

Program Location	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
apadbwq	No significant trend	638719	25	2002 - 2026	10	0.05	16.21	0.06	0.23
apaebwq	Significantly decreasing trend	672490	28	1997 - 2026	13	-0.18	19.33	-0.18	0.00
apaeswq	Significantly decreasing trend	735494	31	1996 - 2026	9	-0.13	11.31	-0.09	0.00
apalmwq	No significant trend	275282	11	2016 - 2026	11	0.08	11.53	0.23	0.36
apapcwq	No significant trend	292616	11	2016 - 2026	7	-0.11	10.95	-0.15	0.15
apabpwq	No significant trend	186715	7	2020 - 2026	11	-0.07	11.82	-0.20	0.43
apacpwq	No significant trend	663199	25	2002 - 2026	8	-0.02	12.90	-0.02	0.59

At two program locations, monthly average turbidity decreased by 0.09 NTU per year at one site and by 0.18 NTU per year at the other. No detectable change in monthly average turbidity was observed at five locations.

Water Temperature - Continuous

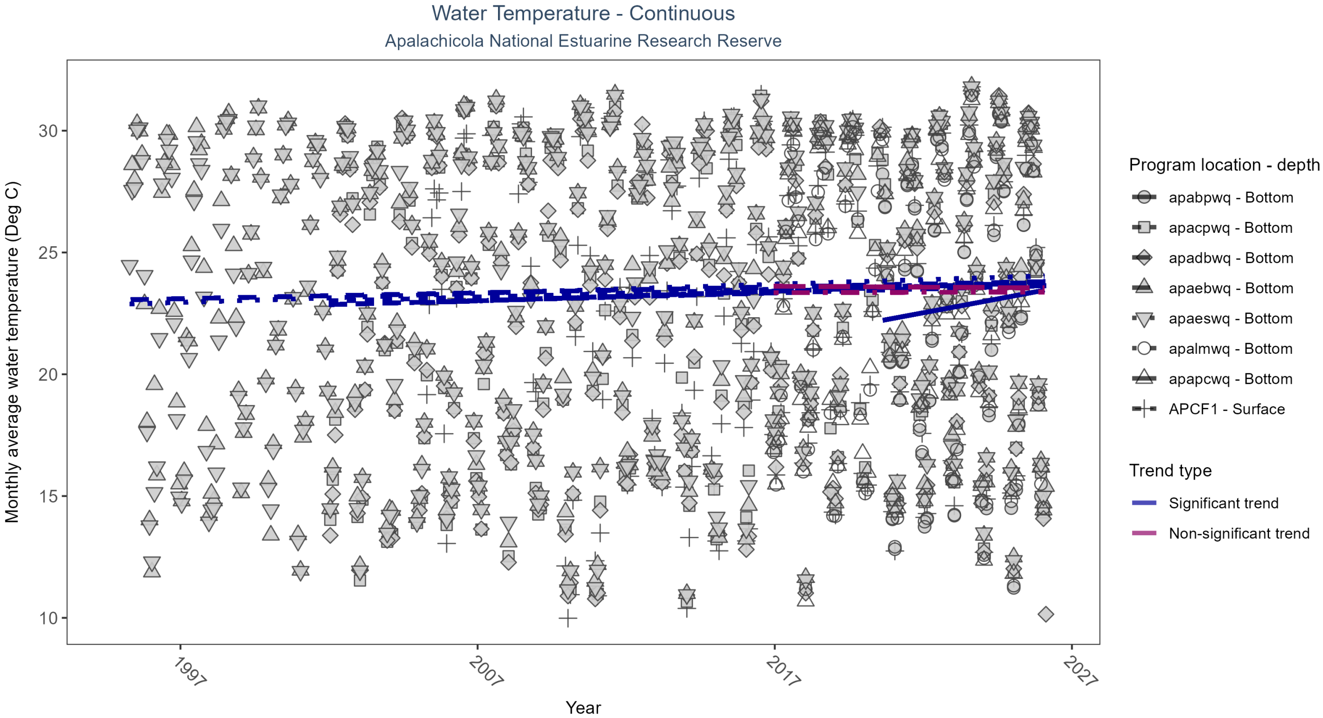

Figure 28: Scatter plot of monthly average water temperature over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 33: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for Water Temperature - All Stations

Program Location	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
apadbwq	Significantly increasing trend	679646	25	2002 - 2026	23.3	0.16	22.86	0.03	0.00
apaebwq	Significantly increasing trend	799283	32	1995 - 2026	24.1	0.16	23.05	0.02	0.00
apaeswq	Significantly increasing trend	800593	32	1995 - 2026	24.1	0.20	22.88	0.04	0.00
apalmwq	No significant trend	307034	11	2016 - 2026	22.7	0.01	23.35	0.00	0.93
apapcwq	No significant trend	308627	11	2016 - 2026	23.2	0.00	23.62	-0.01	0.98
APCF1	Significantly increasing trend	1433809	21	2005 - 2025	23.4	0.12	22.93	0.04	0.02
apabpwq	Significantly increasing trend	186721	7	2020 - 2026	22.6	0.23	22.07	0.23	0.04
apacpwq	Significantly increasing trend	705144	25	2002 - 2026	23.5	0.16	23.01	0.03	0.00

At six program locations, monthly average water temperature increased between 0.02 and 0.23°C per year. No detectable change in monthly average water temperature was observed at two locations.

Salinity - Continuous

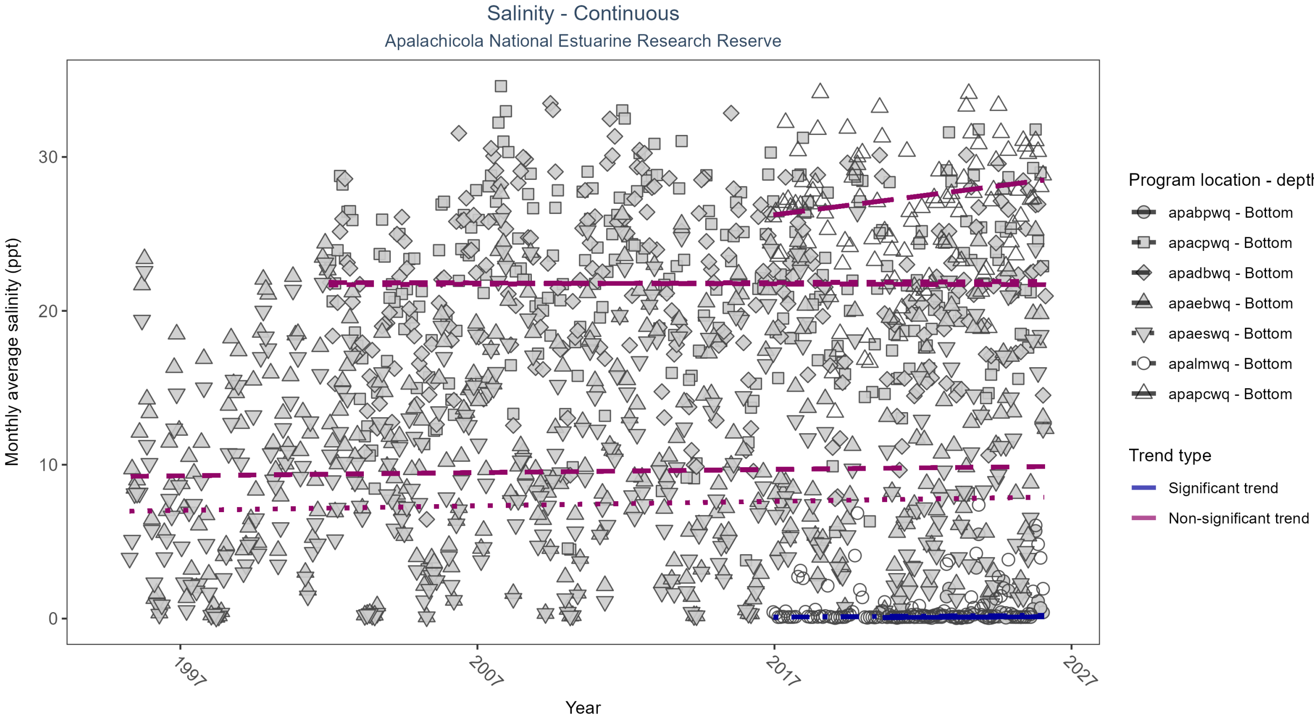

Figure 29: Scatter plot of monthly average salinity over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 34: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for Salinity - All Stations

Program Location	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
apadbwq	No significant trend	651798	25	2002 - 2026	22.3	0.00	21.84	-0.01	0.93
apaebwq	No significant trend	782974	32	1995 - 2026	10.0	0.04	9.24	0.02	0.32
apaeswq	No significant trend	792598	32	1995 - 2026	7.6	0.05	6.97	0.03	0.18
apalmwq	Significantly increasing trend	304777	11	2016 - 2026	0.1	0.24	0.08	0.01	0.00
apapcwq	No significant trend	303665	11	2016 - 2026	27.1	0.14	25.99	0.25	0.07
apabpwq	Significantly increasing trend	186721	7	2020 - 2026	0.1	0.34	0.06	0.01	0.00
apacpwq	No significant trend	666150	25	2002 - 2026	22.5	0.01	21.69	0.01	0.81

At two program locations, monthly average salinity increased by 0.01 ppt per year. No detectable change in monthly average salinity was observed at five locations.

Specific Conductivity - Continuous

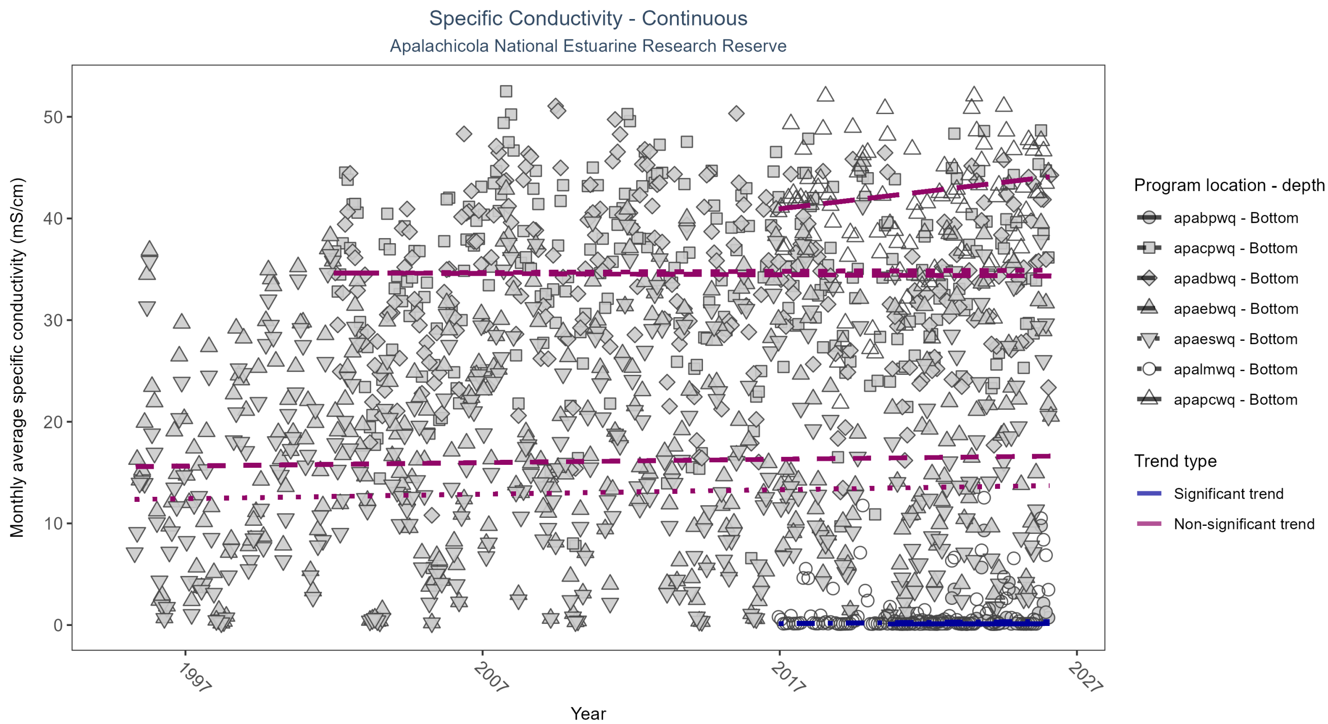

Figure 30: Scatter plot of monthly average specific conductivity over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 35: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for Specific Conductivity - All Stations

Program Location	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
apadbwq	No significant trend	651297	25	2002 - 2026	35.35	-0.01	34.64	-0.01	0.86
apaebwq	No significant trend	783182	32	1995 - 2026	16.97	0.04	15.57	0.03	0.32
apaeswq	No significant trend	792928	32	1995 - 2026	13.14	0.05	12.34	0.04	0.20
apalmwq	Significantly increasing trend	304777	11	2016 - 2026	0.15	0.24	0.12	0.02	0.00
apapcwq	No significant trend	303667	11	2016 - 2026	42.28	0.15	40.60	0.35	0.06
apabpwq	Significantly increasing trend	186713	7	2020 - 2026	0.12	0.27	0.10	0.01	0.01
apacpwq	No significant trend	666166	25	2002 - 2026	35.70	0.01	34.62	0.01	0.87

At two program locations, monthly average specific conductivity increased by 0.01 mS/cm per year at one site and by 0.02 mS/cm per year at the other. No detectable change in monthly average specific conductivity was observed at five locations.

Submerged Aquatic Vegetation

The data file used is: **All__SAV__Parameters-2026-Jun-04.txt**

Submerged aquatic vegetation (*SAV*) refers to plants and plant-like macroalgae species that live entirely underwater. The two primary categories of *SAV* inhabiting Florida estuaries are *benthic macroalgae* and *seagrasses*. They often grow together in dense beds or meadows that carpet the seafloor. *Macroalgae* include multicellular species of green, red and brown algae that often live attached to the substrate by a holdfast. They tend to grow quickly and can tolerate relatively high nutrient levels, making them a threat to seagrasses and other benthic habitats in areas with poor water quality. In contrast, *seagrasses* are grass-like, vascular, flowering plants that are attached to the seafloor by extensive root systems. *Seagrasses* occur throughout the coastal areas of Florida, including protected bays and lagoons as well as deeper offshore waters on the continental shelf. *Seagrasses* have taken advantage of the broad, shallow shelf and clear water to produce two of the most extensive seagrass beds anywhere in continental North America.

Parameters

Percent Cover measures the fraction of an area of seafloor that is covered by SAV, usually estimated by evaluating multiple small areas of seafloor. Percent cover is often estimated for total SAV, individual types of vegetation (seagrass, attached algae, drift algae) and individual species.

Frequency of Occurrence was calculated as the number of times a taxon was observed in a year divided by the number of sampling events, multiplied by 100. Analysis is conducted at the quadrat level and is inclusive of all quadrats (i.e., quadrats evaluated using Braun-Blanquet, modified Braun-Blanquet, and percent cover.”

Species

Turtle grass (*Thalassia testudinum*) is the largest of the Florida seagrasses, with longer, thicker blades and deeper root structures than any of the other seagrasses. It is considered a climax seagrass species.

Shoal grass (*Halodule wrightii*) is an early colonizer of vegetated areas and usually grows in water too shallow for other species except *widgeon grass*. It can often tolerate larger salinity ranges than other seagrass species. *Shoal grass* is characterized by thin, flat blades, that are narrower than *turtle grass* blades.

Manatee grass (*Syringodium filiforme*) is easily recognizable because its leaves are thin and cylindrical instead of the flat, ribbon-like form shared by many other seagrass species. The leaves can grow up to half a meter in length. *Manatee grass* is usually found in mixed seagrass beds or small, dense monospecific patches.

Widgeon grass (*Ruppia maritima*) grows in both fresh and salt water and is widely distributed throughout Florida’s estuaries in less saline areas, particularly in inlets along the east coast. This species resembles *shoal grass* in certain environments but can be identified by the pointed tips of its leaves.

Three species of *Halophila spp.* are found in Florida - **Star grass** (*Halophila engelmannii*), **Paddle grass** (*Halophila decipiens*), and **Johnson’s seagrass** (*Halophila johnsonii*). These are smaller, more fragile seagrasses than other Florida species and are considered ephemeral. They grow along a single long rhizome, with short blades. These species are not well-studied, although surveys are underway to define their ecological roles.

Notes

Star grass, *Paddle grass*, and *Johnson’s seagrass* will be grouped together and listed as **Halophila spp.** in the following managed areas. This is because several surveys did not specify to the species level:

- Banana River Aquatic Preserve
- Indian River-Malabar to Vero Beach Aquatic Preserve
- Indian River-Vero Beach to Ft. Pierce Aquatic Preserve
- Jensen Beach to Jupiter Inlet Aquatic Preserve
- Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve
- Mosquito Lagoon Aquatic Preserve

- Biscayne Bay Aquatic Preserve
- Florida Keys National Marine Sanctuary

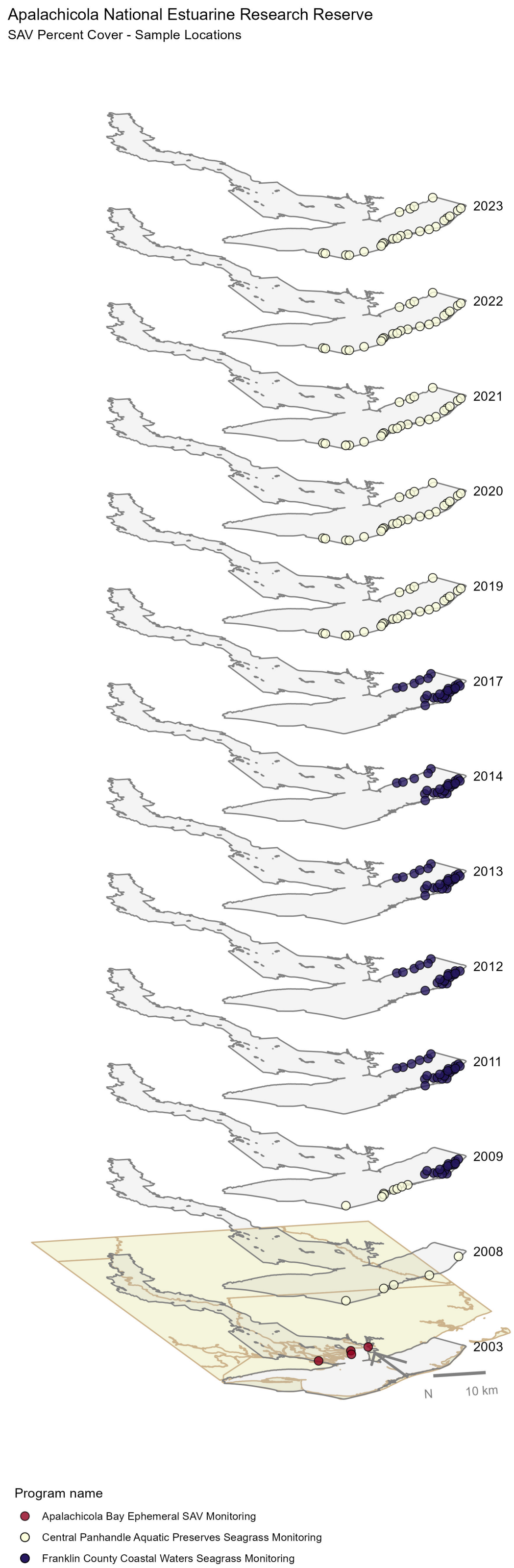

Figure 31: Maps showing the temporal scope of SAV sampling sites within the boundaries of *Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve* by program name.

Click here to view spatio-temporal plots on GitHub.

Sampling locations by Program:

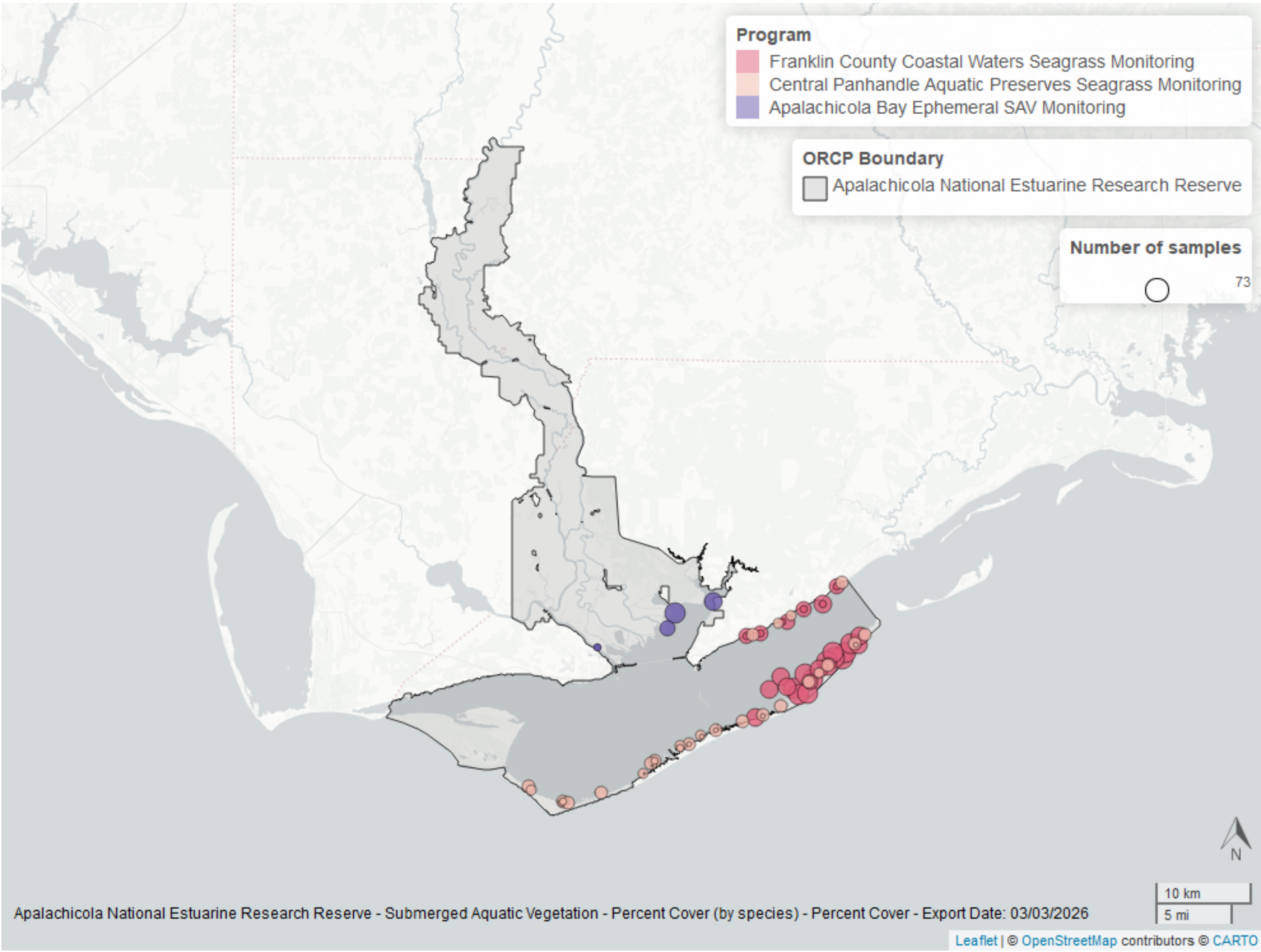

Figure 32: Map showing SAV sampling sites within the boundaries of *Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve*. The point size reflects the number of samples at a given sampling site.

Table 36: Program Information for Submerged Aquatic Vegetation

ProgramID	*N-Data*	*YearMin*	*YearMax*	*method*	*Sample Locations*
557	590	2008	2023	Braun Blanquet	35
997	79	2003	2003	Braun Blanquet	4
558	1402	2009	2017	Percent Cover	32
997	81	2003	2003	Percent Cover	4

Program names:

557 - Central Panhandle Aquatic Preserves Seagrass Monitoring[10]
558 - Franklin County Coastal Waters Seagrass Monitoring[13]
997 - Apalachicola Bay Ephemeral SAV Monitoring[16]

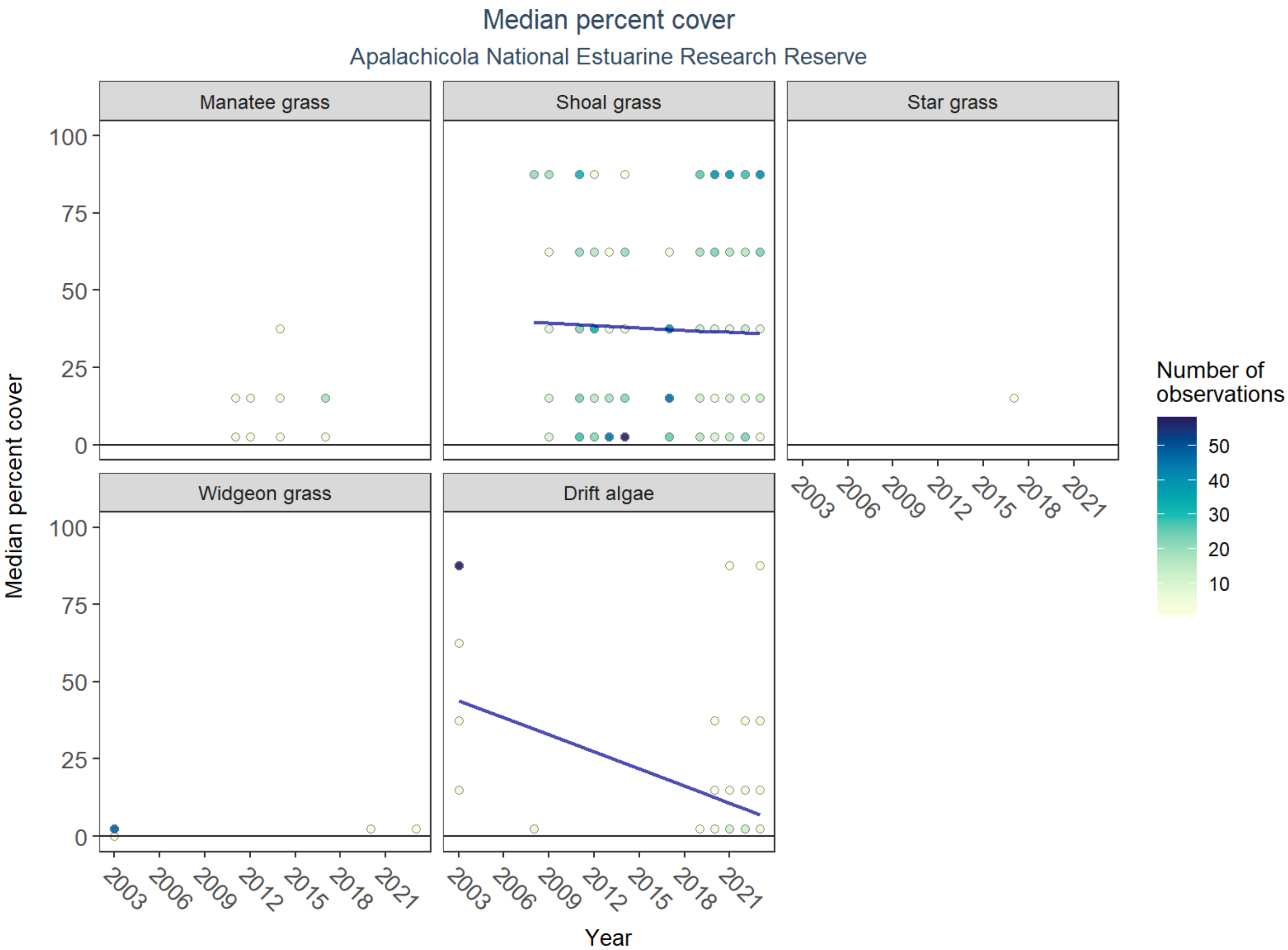

Figure 33: Scatter plots of median percent cover of submerged aquatic vegetation over time by group. Plots for time series that included five or more years of observations show the estimated trend as a blue line.

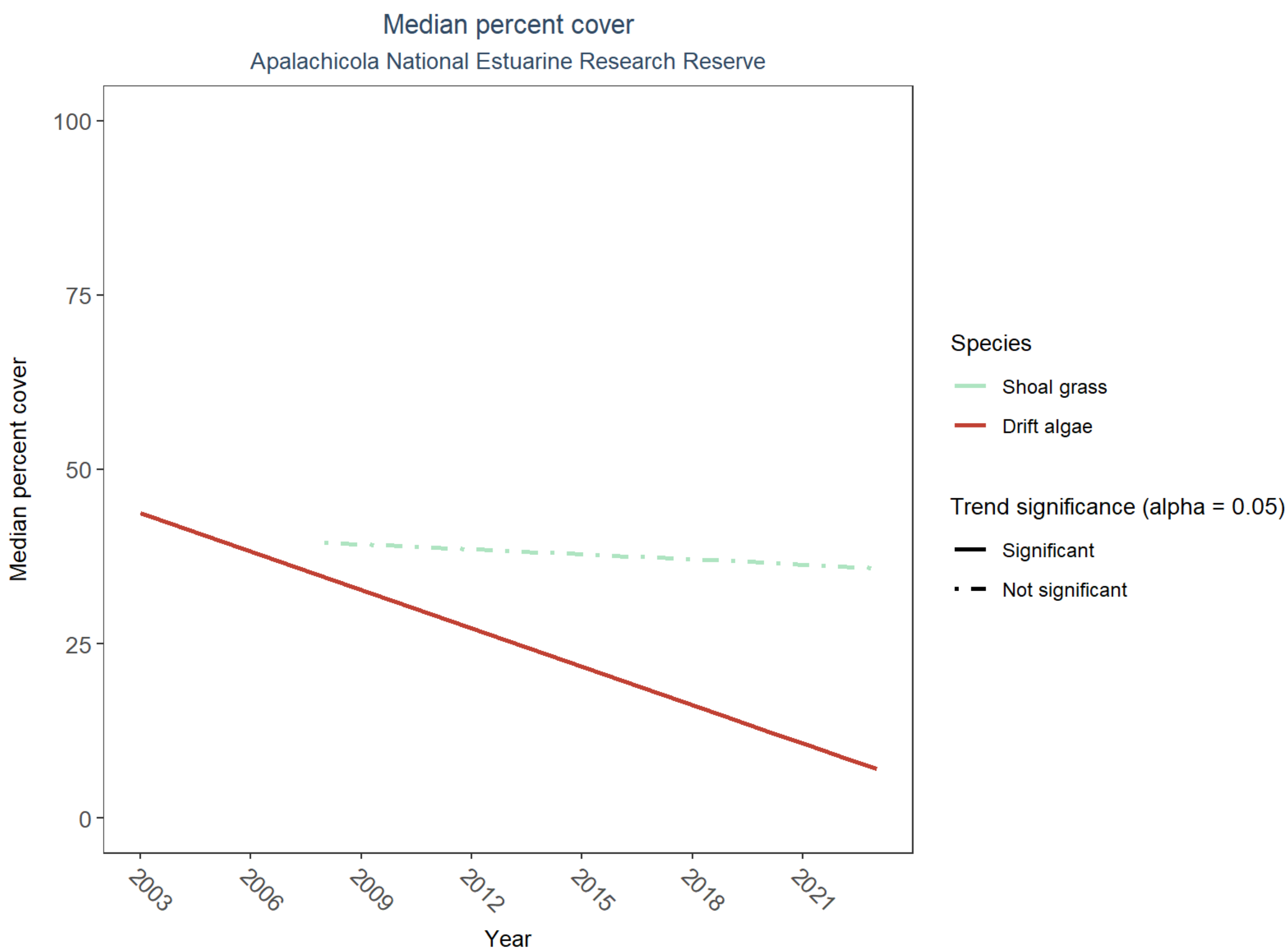

Figure 34: Trend lines of median percent cover of submerged aquatic vegetation over time for species that had five or more years of observations. Line type represents significance (solid) or non-significance (dashed) of the trends.

Table 37: Percent Cover Trend Analysis for Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve

Species	*Statistical Trend*	*Period of Record*	*LME Intercept*	*LME Slope*	*P*
Drift algae	Decreasing trend	2003 - 2023	60.30870	-1.8362960	0.0314623
Shoal grass	No detectable trend	2008 - 2023	42.98087	-0.2444921	0.7268445
Star grass	Insufficient data	-	-	-	-
Widgeon grass	Insufficient data	-	-	-	-
Manatee grass	Insufficient data	-	-	-	-

An annual decrease in percent cover was observed for drift algae (-1.84%). No detectable change in percent cover was observed for shoal grass. Trends in percent cover could not be evaluated for manatee grass, star grass, and widgeon grass due to insufficient data.

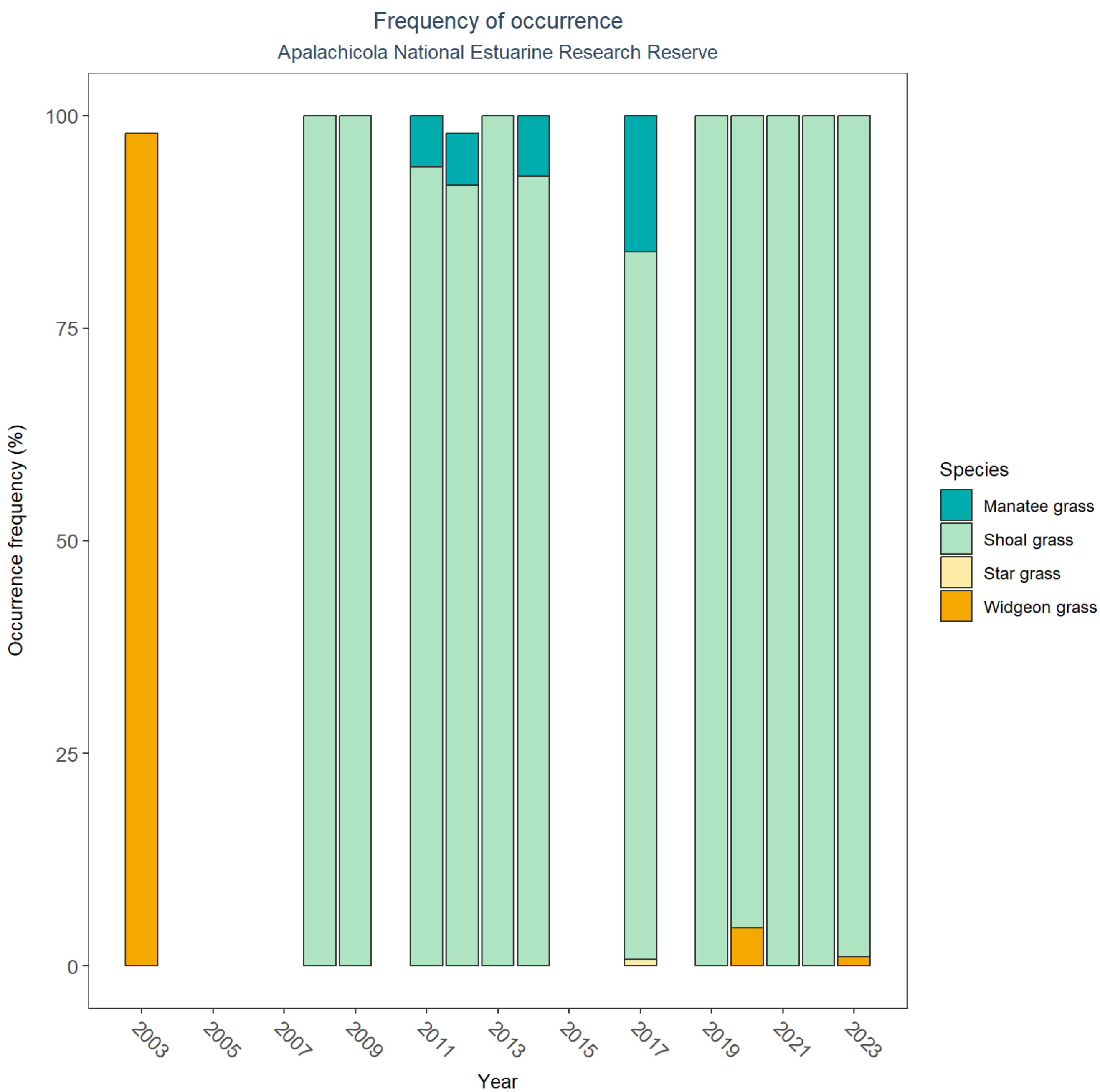

Figure 35: Bar plot of submerged aquatic vegetation species occurrence frequency over time by group.

SAV Water Column Analysis

The following parameters are available for Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve within the SAV_WC_Report:

- Colored Disolved Organic Matter
- Chlorophyll a
- Dissolved Oxygen
- Dissolved Oxygen Saturation
- pH

- Salinity
- Secchi Depth
- Water Temperature
- Total Nitrogen
- Total Suspended Solids
- Turbidity

Access the reports here: DRAFT_SAV_WC_Report.pdf

Nekton

The data file used is: **All_NEKTON_Parameters-2026-Jun-04.txt**

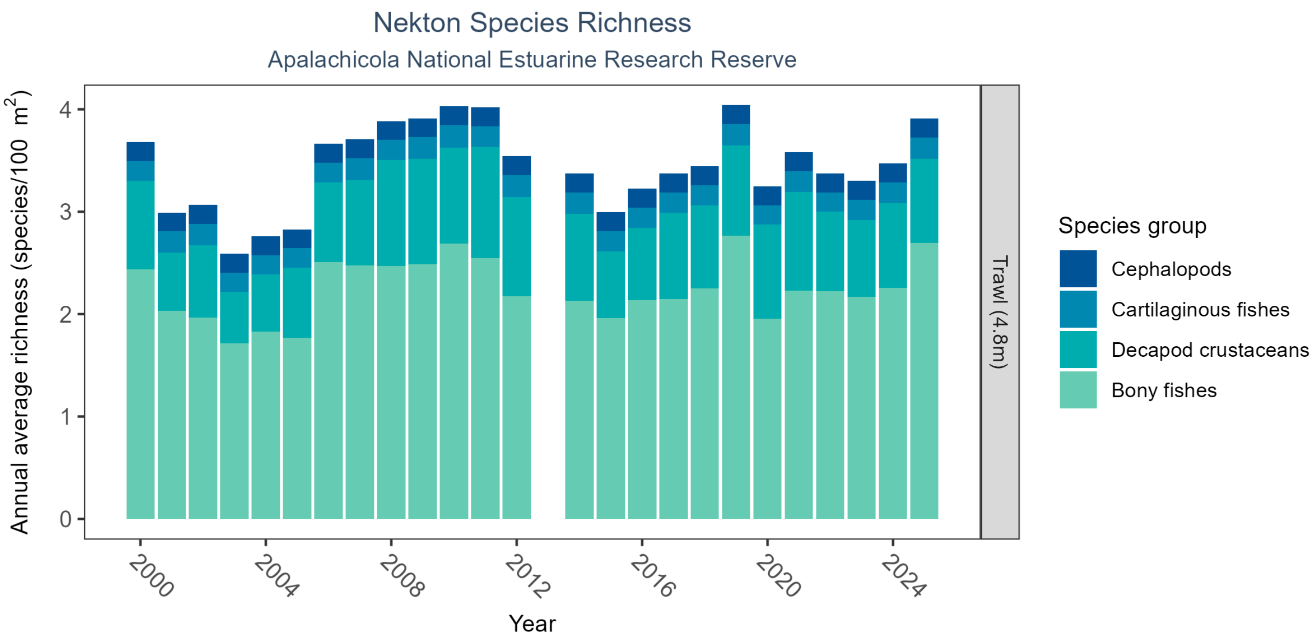

Figure 36: Bar graph(s) of annual average nekton richness over time for species groups occurring in at least 1% of samples. The bar colors represent species groups including bony fishes, cartilaginous fishes, decapod crustaceans (e.g., shrimps, crabs, and lobsters), and cephalopods (e.g., squid). Gear types and sizes are indicated in the panel label.

Table 38: Nekton Species Richness

Gear Type	*No. of Samples*	*No. of Years with Data*	*Period of Record*	*Median No. of Taxa*	*Mean No. of Taxa*
Trawl (4.8 m)	5772	25	2000 - 2025	0.74	1.13

The median annual number of taxa was 0.74 based on 5,772 observations collected by 4.8-meter trawl between 2000 and 2025.

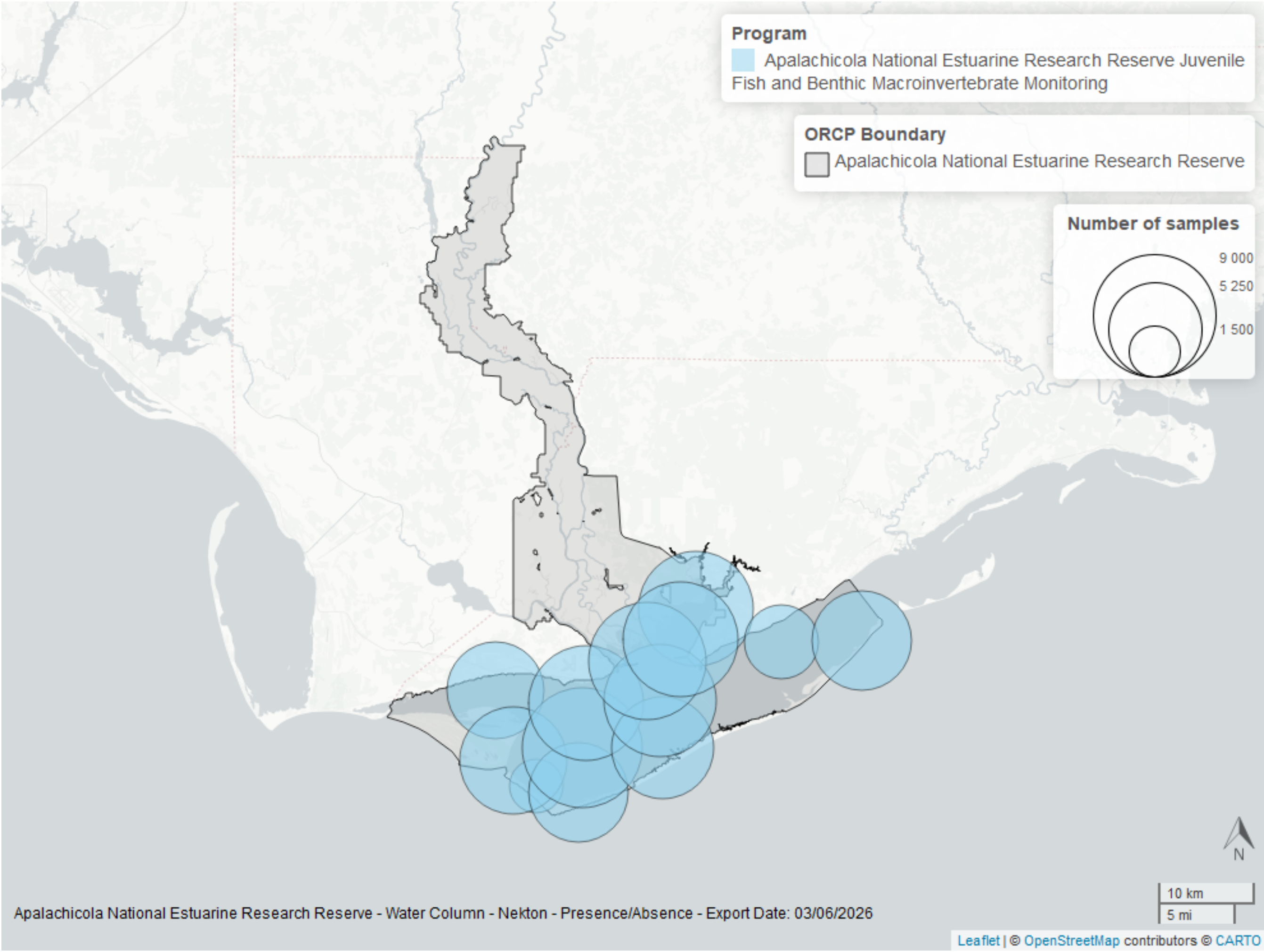

Figure 37: Map showing location of nekton sampling locations within the boundaries of *Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Coastal Wetlands

The data file used is: **All__CW__Parameters-2026-Jun-04.txt**

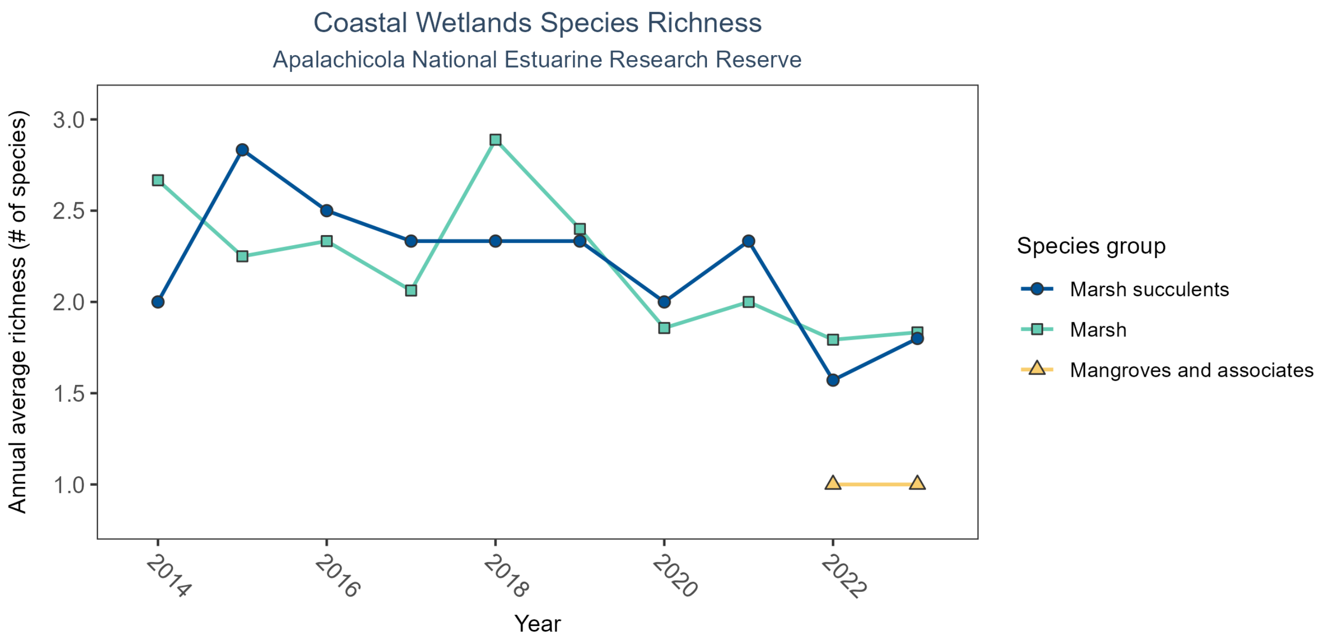

Figure 38: Line graph of annual average coastal wetlands species richness over time for mangroves and associates (triangles), marsh (squares), and marsh succulents (circles). If the time series by species group included more than one year of observations, a line connects data points for visualization.

Table 39: Coastal Wetlands Species Richness

Species Group	*No. of Samples*	*No. Years with Data*	*Period of Record*	*Median No. of Taxa*	*Mean No. of Taxa*
Mangroves and associates	4	2	2022 - 2023	1.0	1.00
Marsh	144	10	2014 - 2023	1.5	2.08
Marsh succulents	56	10	2014 - 2023	3.0	2.20

Between 2022 and 2023, the median annual number of species for mangroves and associates was 1 based on 4 observations. Between 2014 and 2023, the median annual number of species for marsh was 1.5 based on 144 observations. Between 2014 and 2023, the median annual number of species for marsh succulents was 3 based on 56 observations.

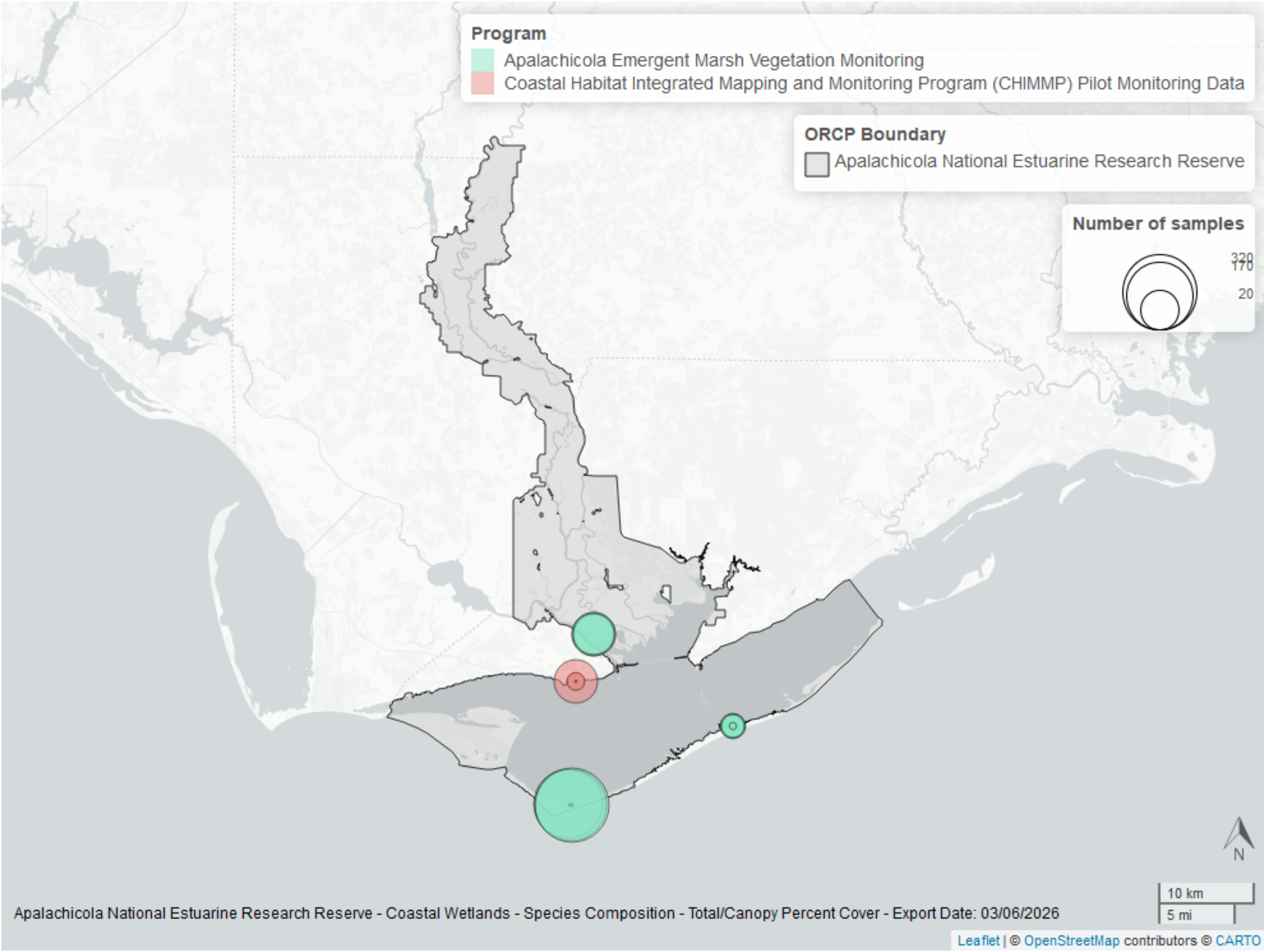

Figure 39: Map showing location of coastal wetlands sampling locations within the boundaries of *Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Oyster

The data file used is: **All_OYSTER_Parameters-2026-Jun-04.txt**

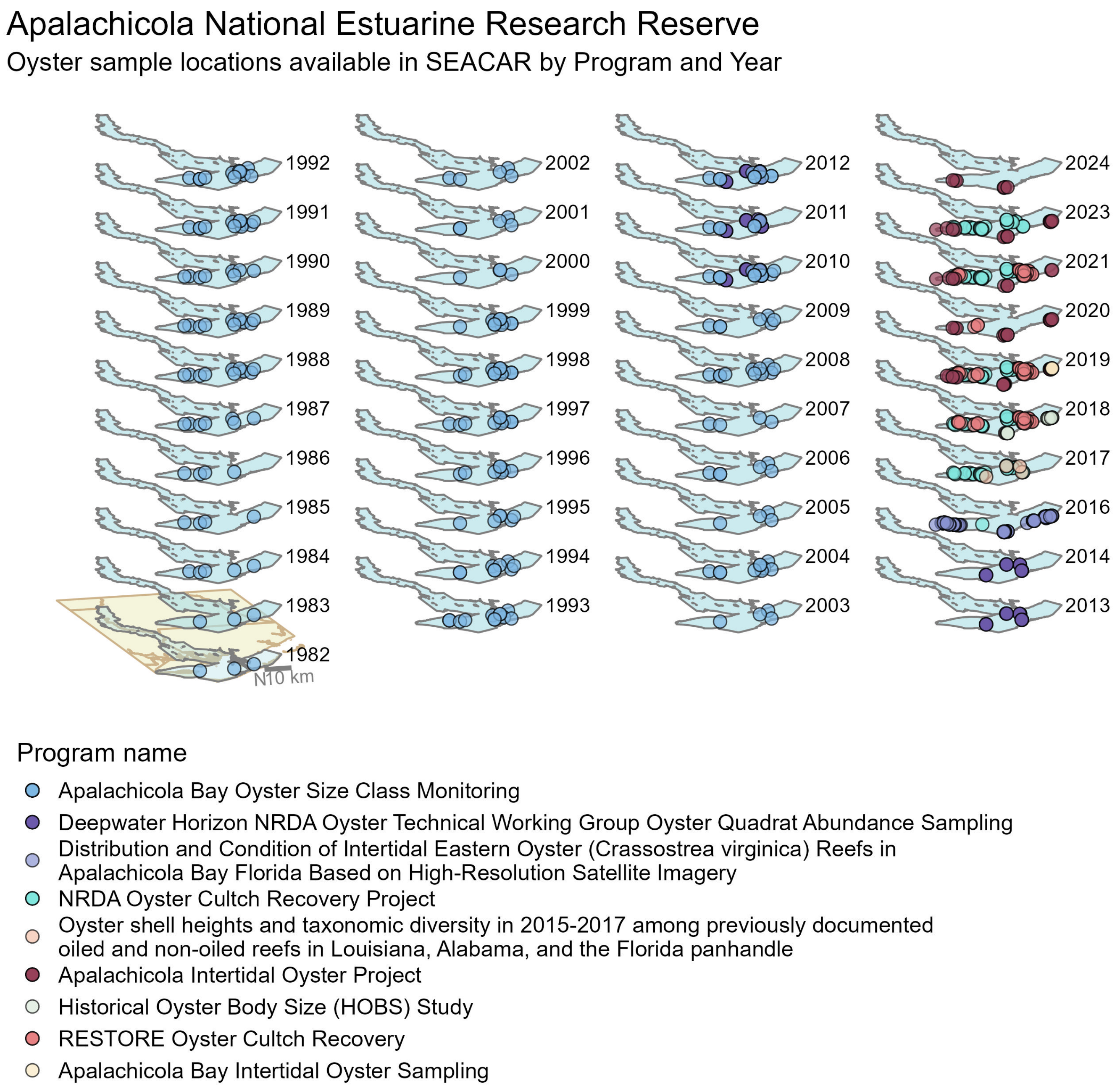

Figure 40: Maps showing the temporal scope of oyster sampling sites within the boundaries of *Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve* by program name.

Click here to view spatio-temporal plots on GitHub.

Density

For natural reefs, density showed no detectable trend between 2010 and 2019. For restored reefs, density showed no detectable trend between 2016 and 2023.

Natural

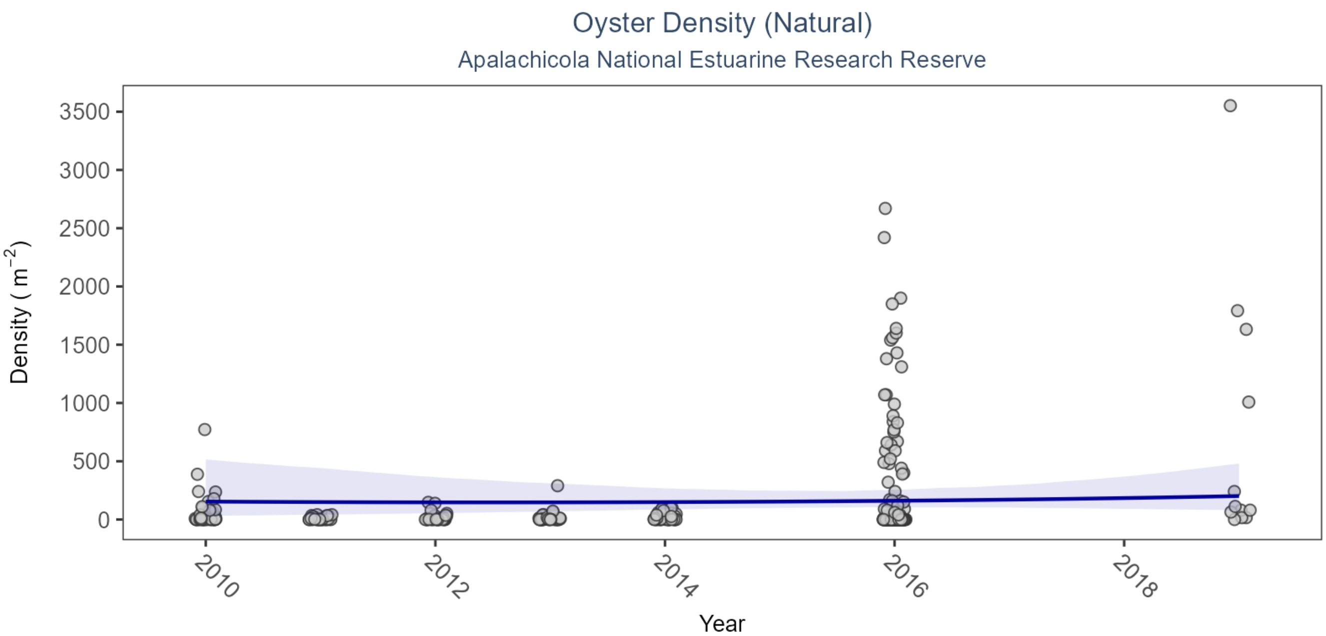

Figure 41: Scatter plot of oyster density over time. If the time series included five or more years with observations, an estimated trend (blue line) and a 95% credible interval (purple band) may also be plotted. Data points are jittered horizontally to reduce overlap.

Table 40: Model results for Oyster Density - Natural

Habitat Type	*Shell Type*	*Statistical Trend*	*Period of Record*	*Estimate*	*Standard Error*	*Credible Interval*
Natural	Live Oysters	No detectable trend	2010 - 2019	5.29	23.39	-46.41 to 47.11

Restored

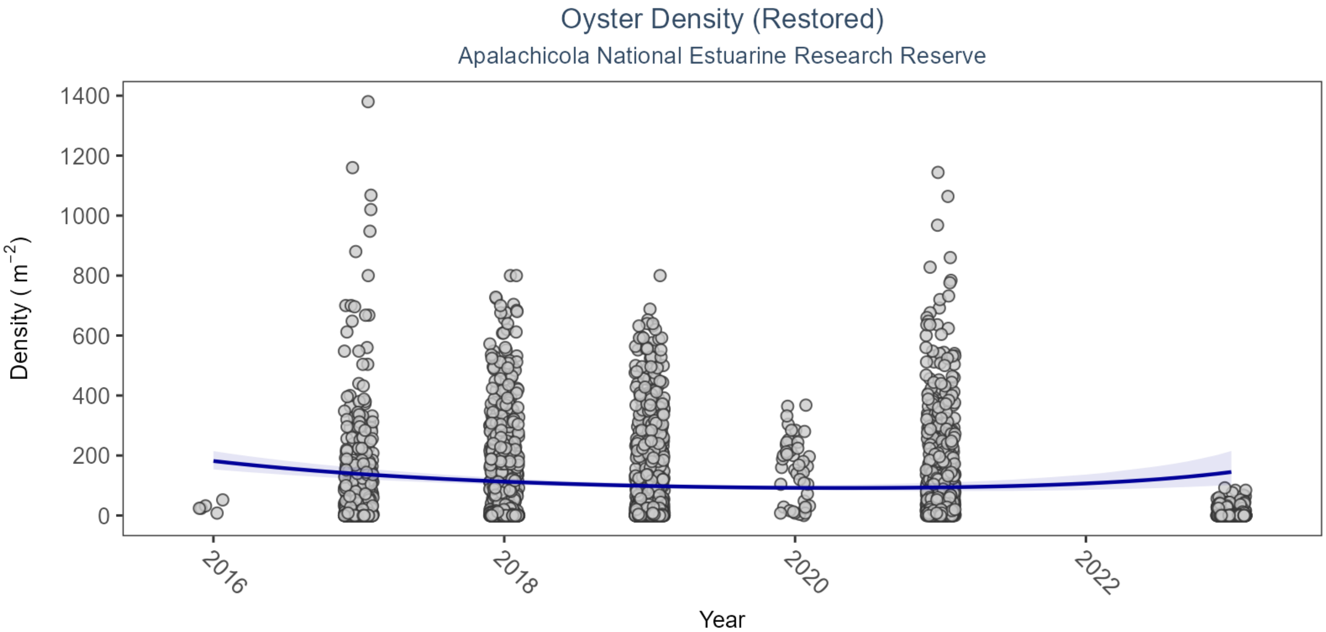

Figure 42: Scatter plot of oyster density over time. If the time series included five or more years with observations, an estimated trend (blue line) and a 95% credible interval (purple band) may also be plotted. Data points are jittered horizontally to reduce overlap.

Table 41: Model results for Oyster Density - Restored

Habitat Type	*Shell Type*	*Statistical Trend*	*Period of Record*	*Estimate*	*Standard Error*	*Credible Interval*
Restored	Live Oysters	No detectable trend	2016 - 2023	-5.24	5.24	-14.14 to 5.93

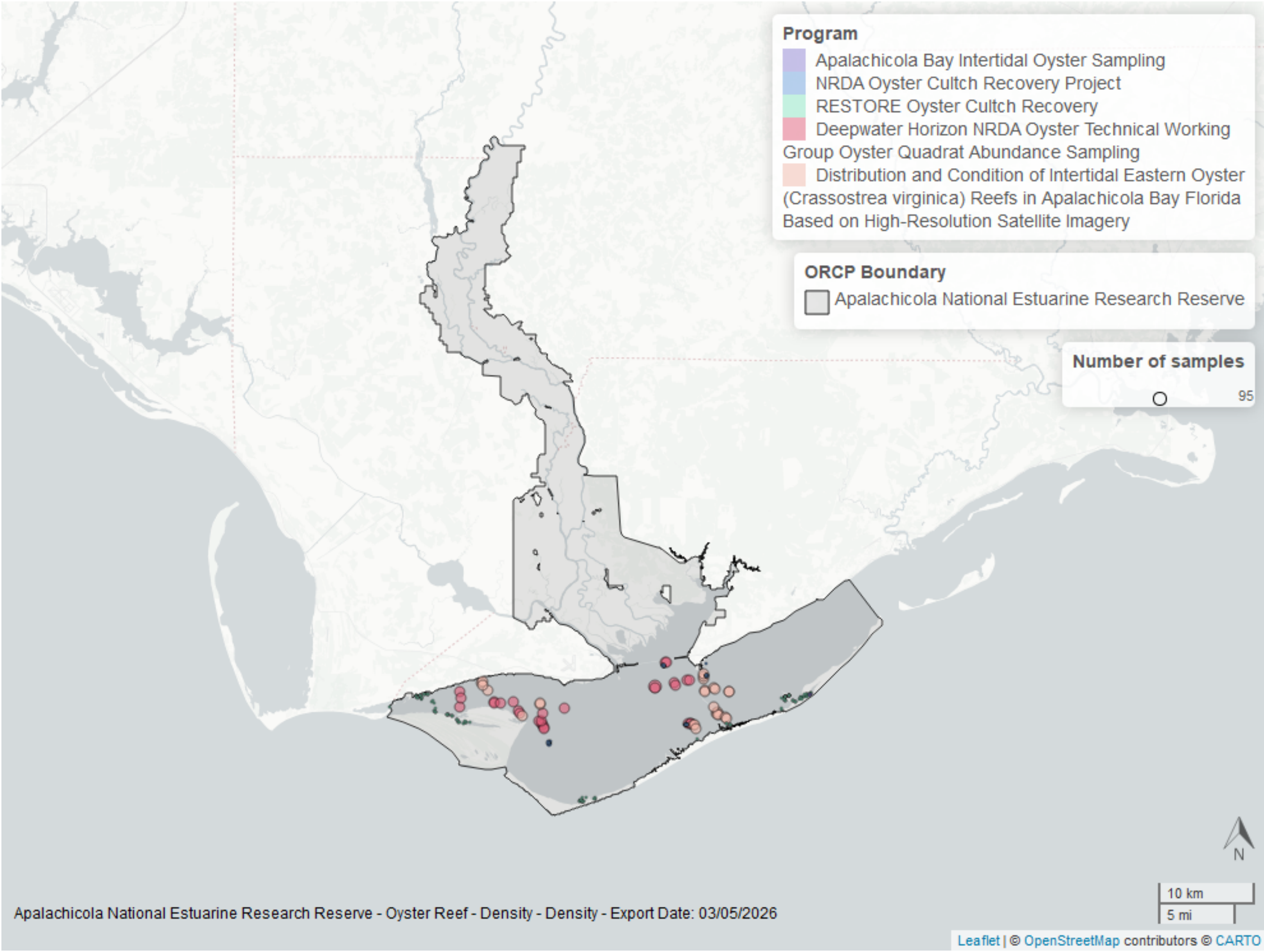

Figure 43: Map showing location of oyster density sampling locations within the boundaries of *Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Percent Live

For natural reefs, percent live cover increased by an average of 1.33% per year. For restored reefs, percent live cover decreased by an average of 1.4% per year.

Natural

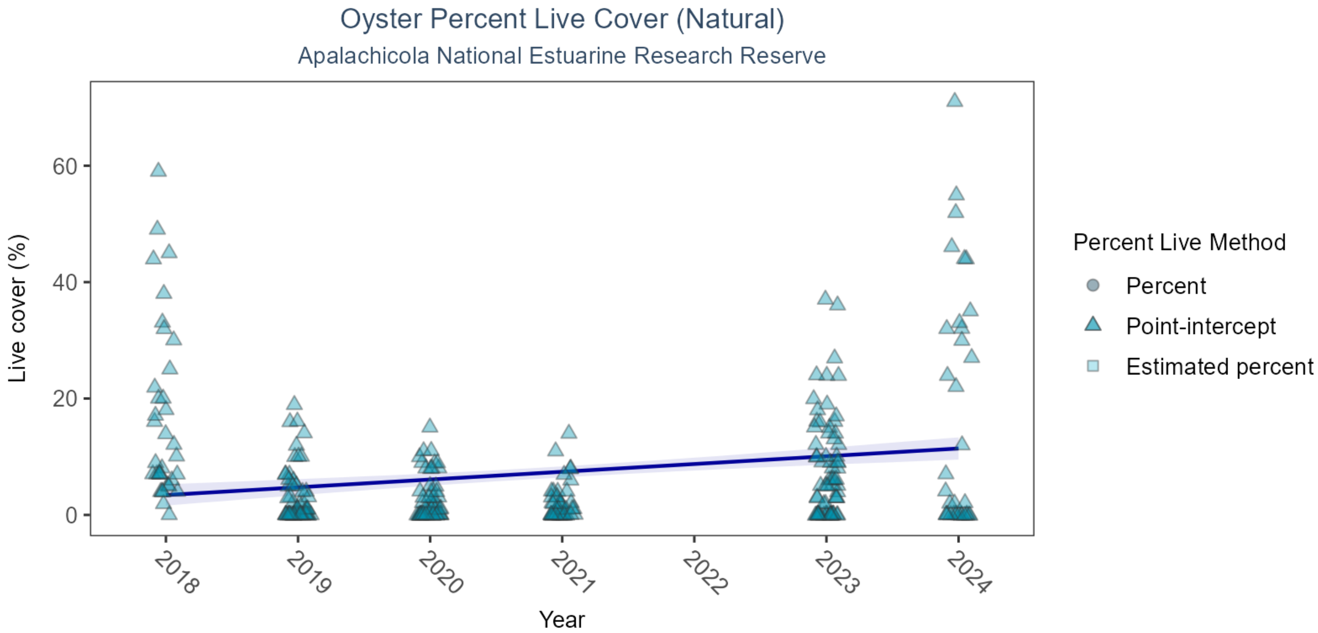

Figure 44: Scatter plot of percent live oysters over time. If the time series included five or more years with observations, an estimated trend (blue line) and a 95% credible interval (purple band) may also be plotted. Estimation method is represented as percent (circles), point-intercept (triangle), or estimated percent (square), with data points jittered horizontally to reduce overlap.

Table 42: Model results for Oyster Percent Live - Natural

Habitat Type	*Shell Type*	*Statistical Trend*	*Period of Record*	*Estimate*	*Standard Error*	*Credible Interval*
Natural	Live Oysters	Increasing trend	2018 - 2024	1.33	0.28	0.8 to 1.88

Restored

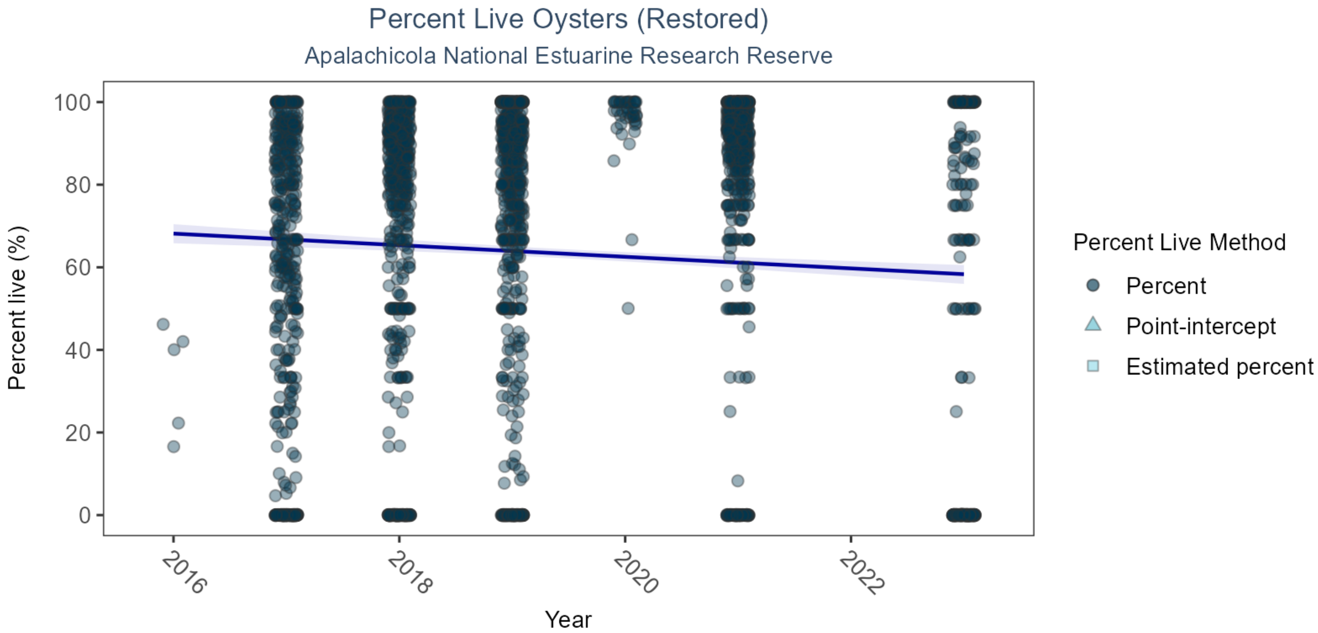

Figure 45: Scatter plot of percent live oysters over time. If the time series included five or more years with observations, an estimated trend (blue line) and a 95% credible interval (purple band) may also be plotted. Estimation method is represented as percent (circles), point-intercept (triangle), or estimated percent (square), with data points jittered horizontally to reduce overlap.

Table 43: Model results for Oyster Percent Live - Restored

Habitat Type	*Shell Type*	*Statistical Trend*	*Period of Record*	*Estimate*	*Standard Error*	*Credible Interval*
Restored	Live Oysters	Decreasing trend	2016 - 2023	-1.4	0.29	-1.97 to -0.84

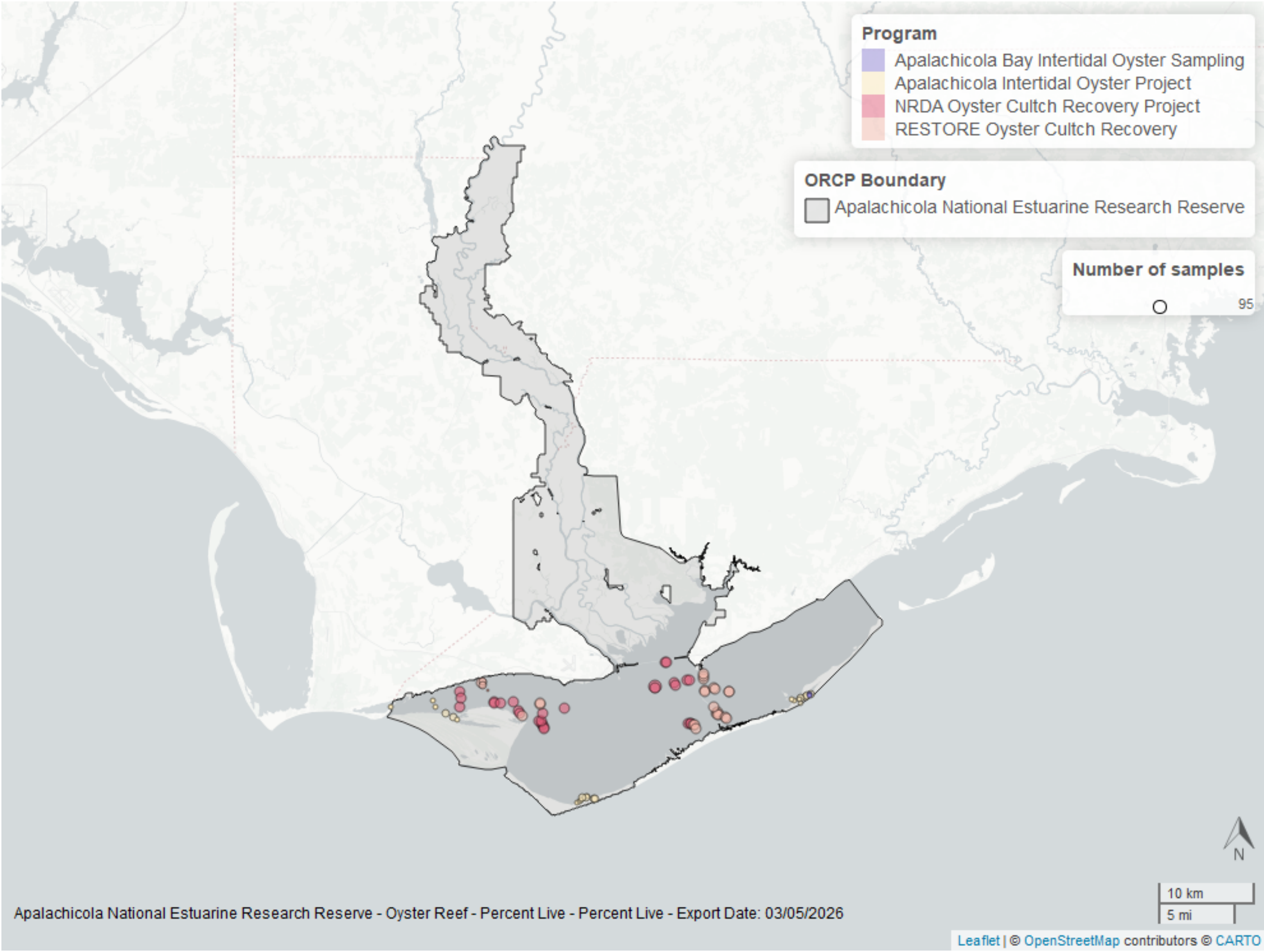

Figure 46: Map showing location of oyster percent live sampling locations within the boundaries of *Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Shell Height

For natural reefs, there was no detectable trend for live oysters in the 25-75mm size class, and there was insufficient data to calculate a trend for live oysters in the >=75mm size class. For restored reefs, there was no detectable trend for live oysters in either the 25-75mm or the >=75mm size class. Models are not run on dead oyster shell measurements.

Natural

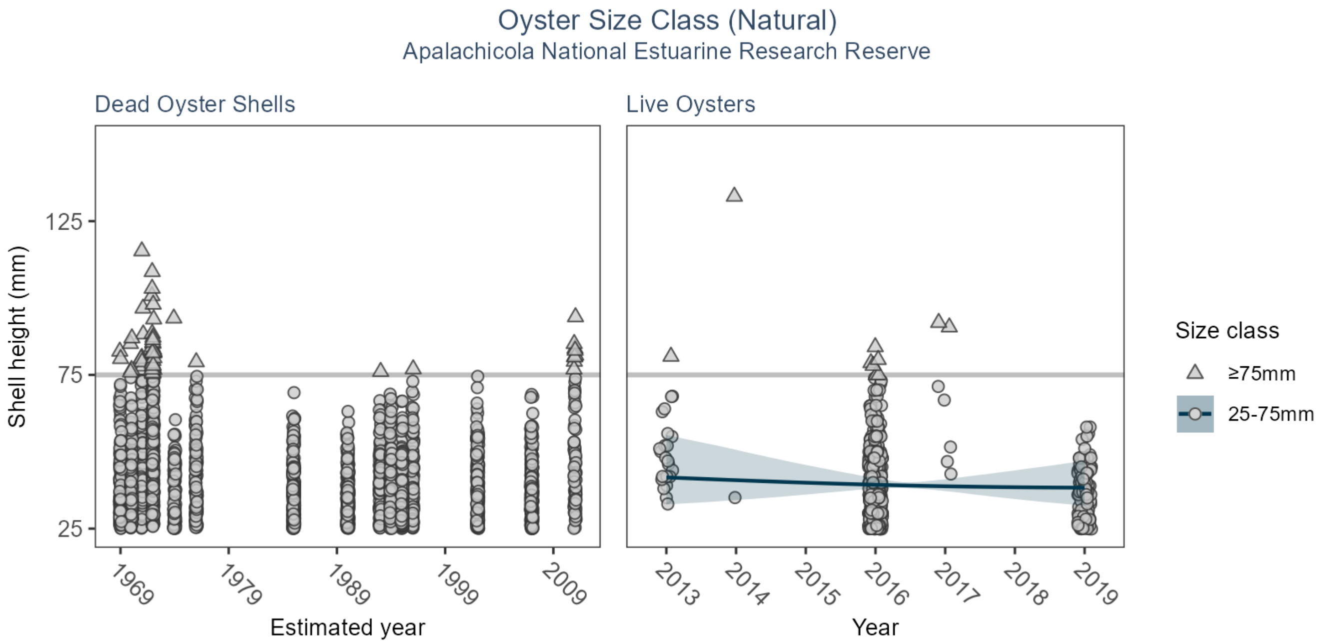

Table 44: Model results for Oyster Shell Height - Natural

Habitat Type	*Shell Type*	*SizeClass*	*Statistical Trend*	*Period of Record*	*No. of Samples*	*Estimate*	*Standard Error*	*Credible Interval*
Natural	Dead Oyster Shells	>75mm	Model not run on dead oyster shell	1581 - 2011	75	-	-	-
Natural	Dead Oyster Shells	25-75mm	Model not run on dead oyster shell	1581 - 2011	2788	-	-	-
Natural	Live Oysters	>75mm	Insufficient data	2013 - 2017	36	-	-	-
Natural	Live Oysters	25-75mm	No detectable trend	2013 - 2019	723	-0.56	1.61	-3.81 to 2.33

Restored

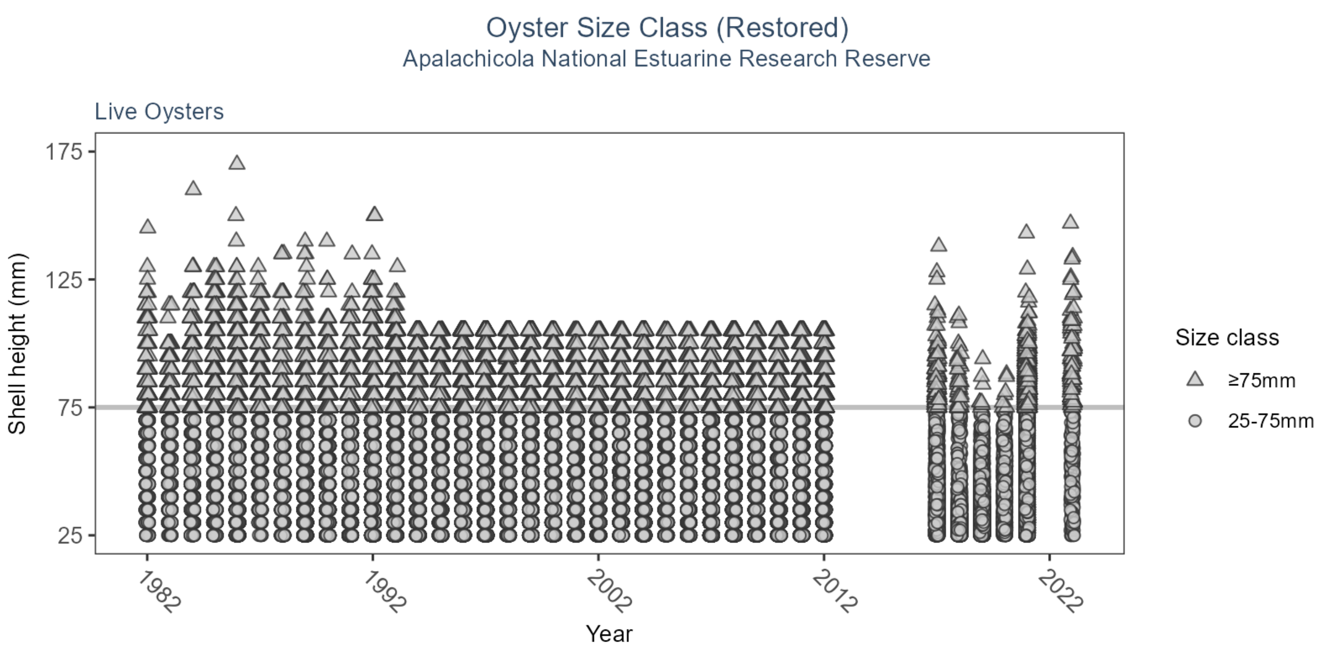

Table 45: Model results for Oyster Shell Height - Restored

Habitat Type	*Shell Type*	*SizeClass*	*Statistical Trend*	*Period of Record*	*No. of Samples*	*Estimate*	*Standard Error*	*Credible Interval*
Restored	Live Oysters	>75mm	Model did not fit the available data	1982 - 2023	36418	-	-	-
Restored	Live Oysters	25-75mm	Model did not fit the available data	1982 - 2023	247979	-	-	-

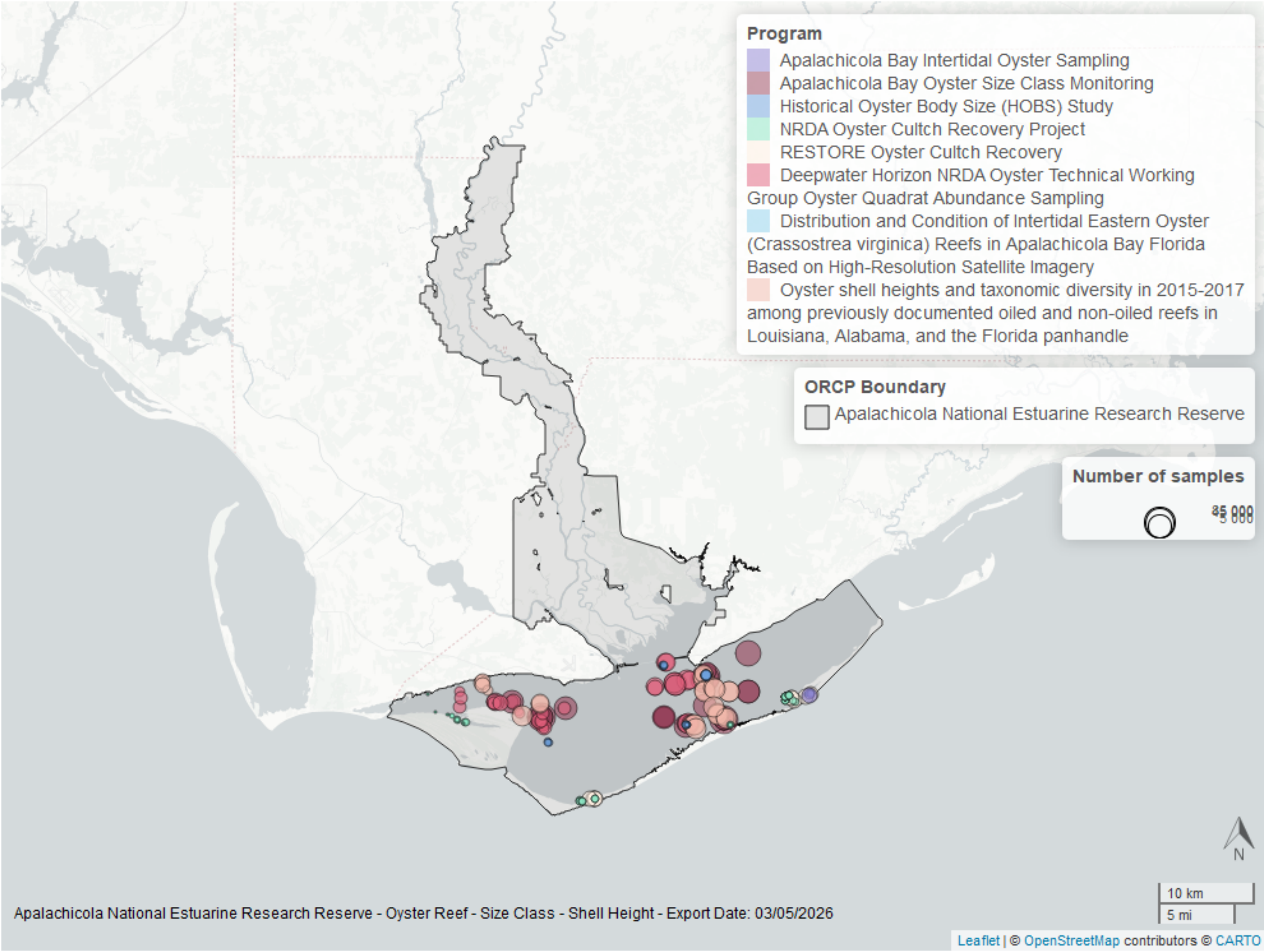

Figure 47: Map showing location of oyster shell height sampling locations within the boundaries of *Apalachicola National Estuarine Research Reserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Species list

Acanthostracion lactrophyrs[3]
Acanthostracion quadricornis[3]
Acer rubrum
Acetabularia crenulata[1]
Acetes americanus[3]
Achelous gibbesii[3]
Achelous spinimanus[3]
Achirus lineatus[3]
Acipenser oxyrinchus[3]
Agalinis maritima
Albula vulpes[3]
Alosa alabamae[3]
Alosa chrysochloris[3]
Alosa spp.[3]
Alpheus armillatus[3]
Alpheus estuariensis[3]
Alpheus heterochaelis[3]
Alpheus normanni[3]
Alpheus spp.[3]
Alternanthera philoxeroides
Aluterus heudelotii[3]
Aluterus schoepfii[3]
Aluterus scriptus[3]
Aluterus spp.[3]
Amaranthus cannabinus
Ambidexter symmetricus[3]
Ameiurus catus[3]
Ameiurus natalis[3]
Ameiurus nebulosus[3]
Ameiurus spp.[3]
Amia calva[3]
Ammocrypta bifascia[3]
Ampelaster carolinianus
Anarchopterus criniger[3]
Anchoa cubana[3]
Anchoa hepsetus[3]
Anchoa lyolepis[3]
Anchoa mitchilli[3]
Anchoa sp.[3]
Anchoa spp.[3]
Ancylopsetta quadrocellata[3]
Anguilla rostrata[3]
Anguilliformes spp.[3]
Aphredoderus sayanus[3]
Archosargus probatocephalus[3]
Ariopsis felis[3]
Aristida sp.
Astrapogon alutus[3]
Astropecten articulatus
Astroscopus ygraecum[3]
Baccharis halimifolia
Bagre marinus[3]
Bairdiella chrysoura[3]
Bare substrate
Fimbristylis spadicea
Fowlerichthys radiosus[3]
Fundulus grandis[3]
Fundulus similis[3]
Fundulus spp.[3]
Galium tinctorium
Gambusia holbrooki[3]
Gerres cinereus[3]
Gobiesox strumosus[3]
Gobiidae spp.[3]
Gobioides broussonnetii[3]
Gobionellus oceanicus[3]
Gobionellus spp.[3]
Gobiosoma bosc[3]
Gobiosoma longipala[3]
Gobiosoma robustum[3]
Gobiosoma spp.[3]
Gracilaria sp.[1]
Gunterichthys longipenis[3]
Gymnothorax saxicola[3]
Gymnura micrura[3]
Haemulon aurolineatum[3]
Haemulon plumierii[3]
Halichoeres bivittatus[3]
Halodule wrightii[1]
Halophila engelmannii[1]
Harengula jaguana[3]
Hemicaranx amblyrhynchus[3]
Hemipholis elongata
Hepatus epheliticus[3]
Heterandria formosa[3]
Hexapanopeus angustifrons[3]
Hippocampus erectus[3]
Hippocampus zosterae[3]
Hippolyte zostericola[3]
Hydrilla verticillata
Hydrocotyle umbellata
Hypanus americanus[3]
Hypanus sabinus[3]
Hypanus say[3]
Hypleurochilus caudovittatus[3]
Hypleurochilus geminatus[3]
Hypleurochilus spp.[3]
Hyporhamphus meeki[3]
Hyporhamphus spp.[3]
Hypsoblennius hentz[3]
Hypsoblennius ionthas[3]
Ictaluridae spp.[3]
Ictalurus furcatus[3]
Ictalurus punctatus[3]
Ictalurus spp.[3]
Ilex vomitoria
Ipomoea sagittata
Iris virginica
Pagurus longicarpus[3]
Pagurus pollicaris[3]
Pagurus spp.[3]
Palaemon floridanus[3]
Palaemon mundusnovus[3]
Palaemon pugio[3]
Palaemon spp.[3]
Palaemon vulgaris[3]
Panicum repens
Panicum virgatum
Panopeus herbstii[3]
Parablennius marmoreus[3]
Paraclinus marmoratus[3]
Paralichthyidae spp.[3]
Paralichthys albigutta[3]
Paralichthys lethostigma[3]
Paralichthys spp.[3]
Paralichthys squamilentus[3]
Parapenaeus politus[3]
Paspalum vaginatum[2]
Pattalias palustre
Penaeidae[3]
Penaeus aztecus[3]
Penaeus duorarum[3]
Penaeus setiferus[3]
Penaeus sp.[3]
Penaeus spp.[3]
Peprilus burti[3]
Peprilus paru[3]
Peprilus spp.[3]
Percidae spp.[3]
Percina nigrofasciata[3]
Persea palustris
Persephona mediterranea[3]
Persicaria hydropiperoides
Petrolisthes armatus[3]
Phragmites berlandieri
Physalis angustifolia
Physostegia leptophylla
Pilumnus sayi[3]
Pinnixa spp.[3]
Platybelone argalus[3]
Poaceae sp.
Pogonias cromis[3]
Polygonum hydropiperoides
Polypremum procumbens
Pomatomus saltatrix[3]
Pomoxis nigromaculatus[3]
Pontederia cordata
Porichthys plectrodon[3]
Portunidae spp.[3]
Portunus sayi[3]
Potamogeton pusillus
Prionotus alatus[3]

Bathygobius soporator[3]
Batis maritima[2]
Belonidae spp.[3]
Belzebub faxoni[3]
Bidens mitis
Blenniidae spp.[3]
Blutaparon vermiculare[2]
Bolboschoenus robustus
Borrichia frutescens
Bothidae spp.[3]
Brachyura[3]
Brevoortia spp.[3]
Brotula barbata[3]
Brown algae[1]
Busycon spp.
Calamus arctifrons[3]
Calamus leucosteus[3]
Calamus spp.[3]
Calappa ocellata[3]
Callinectes sapidus[3]
Callinectes similis[3]
Callinectes spp.[3]
Campsis radicans
Carangidae spp.[3]
Caranx crysos[3]
Caranx hippos[3]
Caranx latus[3]
Caranx ruber[3]
Caranx spp.[3]
Carcharhinus limbatus[3]
Carex hyalinolepis
Carex joorii
Carex sp.
Carpiodes carpio[3]
Carpiodes cyprinus[3]
Centella asiatica
Centrarchidae spp.[3]
Centrarchus macropterus[3]
Centropristis ocyurus[3]
Centropristis philadelphica[3]
Centropristis striata[3]
Cephalanthus occidentalis
Ceratophyllum demersum
Chaetodipterus faber[3]
Chara spp.[1]
Chasmodes saburrae[3]
Chilomycterus schoepfii[3]
Chloroscombrus chrysurus[3]
Cicuta maculata
Citharichthys macrops[3]
Citharichthys sp.[3]
Citharichthys spilopterus[3]
Citharichthys spp.[3]
Cladium mariscus
Clibanarius vittatus[3]
Crinum americanum
Ctenogobius boleosoma[3]
Iva frutescens
Juncus acuminatus[2]
Juncus roemerianus[2]
Juncus scirpoides[2]
Juncus spp.[2]
Juncus validus[2]
Kosteletzkya pentacarpos
Kyphosus sectatrix[3]
Lactophrys trigonus[3]
Lactophrys triqueter[3]
Lagocephalus laevigatus[3]
Lagodon rhomboides[3]
Larimus fasciatus[3]
Latreutes parvulus[3]
Leander tenuicornis[3]
Legume sp.
Leiostomus xanthurus[3]
Lepisosteus oculatus[3]
Lepisosteus osseus[3]
Lepomis auritus[3]
Lepomis gulosus[3]
Lepomis macrochirus[3]
Lepomis microlophus[3]
Lepomis punctatus[3]
Lepomis spp.[3]
Leptochela serratorbita[3]
Libinia dubia[3]
Libinia emarginata[3]
Limonium carolinianum[2]
Limulus polyphemus
Lithadia granulosa[3]
Lobotes surinamensis[3]
Lolliguncula brevis[3]
Lucania parva[3]
Ludwigia repens
Luidia alternata
Luidia clathrata
Lutjanus analis[3]
Lutjanus campechanus[3]
Lutjanus griseus[3]
Lutjanus sp.[3]
Lutjanus spp.[3]
Lutjanus synagris[3]
Lycopus virginicus
Lysmata wurdemanni[3]
Lythrum lineare
Macrobrachium ohione[3]
Megalops atlanticus[3]
Melongena corona
Membras martinica[3]
Menidia beryllina[3]
Menidia sp.[3]
Menidia spp.[3]
Menippe mercenaria[3]
Menticirrhus americanus[3]
Menticirrhus littoralis[3]
Menticirrhus saxatilis[3]
Prionotus longispinosus[3]
Prionotus rubio[3]
Prionotus scitulus[3]
Prionotus spp.[3]
Prionotus tribulus[3]
Processa hemphilli[3]
Ptilimnium capillaceum
Pylodictis olivaris[3]
Quercus marilandica
Quercus minima
Quercus muehlenbergii
Rachycentron canadum[3]
Raja eglanteria[3]
Remora remora[3]
Rhinoptera bonasus[3]
Rhithropanopeus harrisii[3]
Rhizophora mangle[2]
Rhizoprionodon terraenovae[3]
Rimapenaeus constrictus[3]
Rimapenaeus similis[3]
Rimapenaeus spp.[3]
Rumex verticillatus
Ruppia maritima[1]
Rypticus maculatus[3]
Sabal palmetto
Sagittaria graminea
Salicornia ambigua[2]
Salvinia spp.
Sardinella aurita[3]
Saururus cernuus
Scartella cristata[3]
Schoenoplectus americanus
Schoenoplectus californicus
Sciaenidae spp.[3]
Sciaenops ocellatus[3]
Scomberomorus maculatus[3]
Scorpaena brasiliensis[3]
Scorpaena sp.[3]
Selene setapinnis[3]
Selene vomer[3]
Serraniculus pumilio[3]
Serranidae spp.[3]
Serranus subligarius[3]
Sesbania punicea
Sesbania vesicaria
Sesuvium portulacastrum[2]
Setaria parviflora
Sicyonia brevirostris[3]
Sicyonia dorsalis[3]
Sicyonia laevigata[3]
Sicyonia typica[3]
Smilax auriculata
Smilax bona-nox
Smilax walteri
Solidago sempervirens
Sparidae spp.[3]
Spartina alterniflora[2]

Ctenogobius shufeldti[3]
Ctenogobius spp.[3]
Ctenogobius stigmaticus[3]
Ctenopharyngodon idella[3]
Cuapetes americanus[3]
Cynoscion arenarius[3]
Cynoscion nebulosus[3]
Cynoscion nothus[3]
Cynoscion spp.[3]
Cyperaceae sp.
Cyperus haspan
Cyperus sp.
Cyprinella venusta[3]
Cyprinidae spp.[3]
Cyprinodon variegatus[3]
Cyprinus carpio[3]
Dasyatis sp.[3]
Diapterus auratus[3]
Dichanthelium sp.
Diplectrum bivittatum[3]
Diplectrum formosum[3]
Diplectrum spp.[3]
Diplodus holbrookii[3]
Distichlis spicata[2]
Dormitator maculatus[3]
Dorosoma cepedianum[3]
Dorosoma petenense[3]
Dorosoma spp.[3]
Drift algae[1]
Dyspanopeus texanus[3]
Echeneis naucrates[3]
Echeneis neucratoides[3]
Echeneis spp.[3]
Echiophis punctifer[3]
Edrastima uniflora
Eleocharis fallax
Eleotris amblyopsis[3]
Elopidae[3]
Elopidae spp.[3]
Elops saurus[3]
Elops smithi[3]
Elops spp.[3]
Engraulidae spp.[3]
Enneacanthus gloriosus[3]
Epinephelus morio[3]
Epinephelus spp.[3]
Erotelis smaragdus[3]
Etheostoma fusiforme[3]
Etheostoma spp.[3]
Etheostoma swaini[3]
Etropus crossotus[3]
Etropus cyclosquamus[3]
Etropus microstomus[3]
Etropus rimosus[3]
Etropus spp.[3]
Eucinostomus argenteus[3]
Eucinostomus gula[3]
Menticirrhus spp.[3]
Metoporhaphis calcarata[3]
Microgobius carri[3]
Microgobius gulosus[3]
Microgobius microlepis[3]
Microgobius sp.[3]
Microgobius spp.[3]
Microgobius thalassinus[3]
Microphis brachyurus[3]
Micropogonias undulatus[3]
Micropterus salmoides[3]
Mikania scandens
Minytrema melanops[3]
Monacanthus ciliatus[3]
Moreiradromia antillensis[3]
Morone chrysops x saxatilis[3]
Morone hybrid[3]
Morone saxatilis[3]
Morone spp.[3]
Moxostoma spp.[3]
Mugil cephalus[3]
Mugil curema[3]
Mugil spp.[3]
Muhlenbergia capillaris
Mycteroperca microlepis[3]
Mycteroperca phenax[3]
Mycteroperca spp.[3]
Myrica cerifera
Myrophis punctatus[3]
Najas guadalupensis
Neopanope packardii[3]
Neverita duplicata
Nicholsina usta[3]
No fish
No grass in quadrat[1]
Notemigonus crysoleucas[3]
Notropis maculatus[3]
Notropis spp.[3]
Oenothera simulans
Ogcocephalus corniger[3]
Ogcocephalus cubifrons[3]
Ogcocephalus pantostictus[3]
Ogcocephalus radiatus[3]
Ogyrides alphaerostris[3]
Ogyrides hayi[3]
Ogyrides sp.[3]
Oligoplites saurus[3]
Ophichthidae[3]
Ophichthus gomesii[3]
Ophidion holbrookii[3]
Ophidion josephi[3]
Ophioderma spp.
Ophiothrix (Ophiothrix) angulata
Opisthonema oglinum[3]
Opsanus beta[3]
Opsopoeodus emiliae[3]
Orthopristis chrysoptera[3]
Spartina cynosuroides[2]
Spartina patens[2]
Sphoeroides nephelus[3]
Sphoeroides parvus[3]
Sphoeroides spengleri[3]
Sphoeroides spp.[3]
Sphyraena barracuda[3]
Sphyraena borealis[3]
Sphyraena guachancho[3]
Sphyraena spp.[3]
Sphyrna tiburo[3]
Sporobolus virginicus[2]
Squilla empusa
Stellifer lanceolatus[3]
Stenotomus caprinus[3]
Stephanolepis hispida[3]
Strongylura marina[3]
Strongylura notata[3]
Strongylura spp.[3]
Strongylura timucu[3]
Suaeda linearis[2]
Syacium papillosum[3]
Symphurus parvus[3]
Symphurus plagiusa[3]
Symphyotrichum tenuifolium
Syngnathidae spp.[3]
Syngnathus floridae[3]
Syngnathus louisianae[3]
Syngnathus scovelli[3]
Syngnathus spp.[3]
Syngnathus springeri[3]
Synodus foetens[3]
Synodus spp.[3]
Syringodium filiforme[1]
Taxodium distichum
Thor spp.[3]
Toxicodendron radicans
Tozeuma carolinense[3]
Trachinotus carolinus[3]
Trachinotus falcatus[3]
Trichiurus lepturus[3]
Trinectes maculatus[3]
Tylosurus crocodilus[3]
Tylosurus spp.[3]
Typha latifolia
Typha sp.
Typhaceae
Unidentified fish[3]
Unidentified shrimp[3]
Urocaris longicaudata[3]
Urophycis floridana[3]
Urophycis regia[3]
Vallisneria americana
Vigna luteola
Vitta usnea
Vokesinotus perrugatus
Woody debris

Eucinostomus harengulus[3]	Osmundastrum cinnamomeum	Xanthidae sp.[3]
Eucinostomus spp.[3]	Ovalipes floridanus[3]	Xanthidae spp.[3]
Eurypanopeus depressus[3]	Ovalipes ocellatus[3]	Xiphopenaeus kroyeri[3]
Eustachys petraea	Ovalipes spp.[3]	Zannichellia palustris
Filamentous algae[1]	Pagurus annulipes[3]	Acanthostracion lactrophyrs[3]

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